

BRAND IDENTITY GUIDELINES

Capture with **intention.**

Cap-IT Screen Recorder — the native Windows recorder for tutorials, demos and bug reports. One book, two complete themes: **Midnight** and **Arctic**.



CONTENTS

Twenty chapters, two themes.

Every chapter shows Midnight (dark) and Arctic (light) with equal care. Chapter 04 is the dedicated dual-theme chapter; chapters 10 and 13 present every component and every screen in both.

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HOW TO READ THIS BOOK

Every claim is labelled.

This book describes a brand that already exists, and recommends how it could grow. The two are never mixed on the same line without a label.

• EXISTING

Verified in the repository: the logo artwork, the shipped colour, type, spacing, radius and motion tokens, the screenshots, the README, the capture code. Values are parsed from source, not retyped.

• DERIVED

Produced mechanically from existing artwork — a crop, a recolour, a plate behind the symbol. Nothing is redrawn.

• PROPOSED

A recommendation, with its reasoning and measured contrast. Not applied to the application. Includes the Midnight / Arctic palettes and the horizontal lockup.

• CONCEPT

An exploratory visual (marketing mock-ups, graphic-language studies). Illustrative, not a promise of a feature.

Source of truth

`src/CapIT.Desktop/Styles/` (Colors, Tokens, Typography, Motion, Icons), `assets/Logo-CapIT.png`, `docs/screenshots`, README v3.13.1.

Screenshots

All Dark and Light application screens are real renders of the implemented themes, produced by the app's own snapshot harness with a clean demo configuration. UI specimens elsewhere are drawn from tokens and labelled.

Tokens

Every colour in this PDF is generated from `Cap-IT-Dark-Theme.json` and `Cap-IT-Light-Theme.json`. A build gate fails if a claimed pair misses WCAG 2.2 AA.

Out of scope

This book changes no application code. The recording pipeline and its separate technical report are untouched.

01

Brand introduction

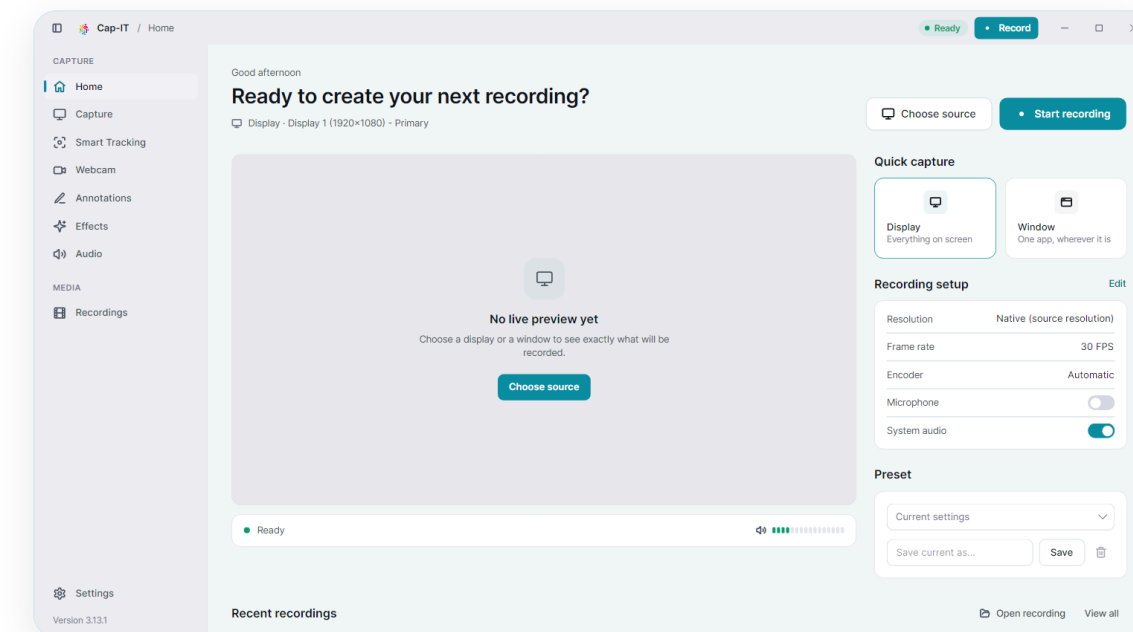
Why Cap-IT exists, who it is for, and what it believes.



BRAND OVERVIEW

The recording should be easy. The result should look intentional.

Cap-IT is a focused, GPU-assisted Windows screen recorder for polished tutorials, demos, bug reports and social clips. It keeps source selection, live preview, recording, audio monitoring, effects, annotations, editing and export in one native place.



Home — the real Arctic theme, v3.13.1.

PURPOSE

To remove the distance between doing something on screen and showing it well. People should spend their effort on what they are demonstrating, not on assembling the video.

VISION

Every tutorial, bug report and walkthrough made on Windows can be captured, refined and shared in a single sitting — without a second tool and without a result that looks accidental.

MISSION

Build the most considered native recorder on Windows: precise capture, a camera that follows the action, and a review workspace that keeps the original safe.

Native Windows

Smart Tracking zoom

Capture + edit in one app

MP4 & GIF

Cursor & click effects

POSITIONING STATEMENT

For people who teach, demonstrate and report on Windows, Cap-IT is the **native screen recorder** that follows the action and hands back a finished-looking result — **without leaving the app.**

Unlike general-purpose broadcasting suites, Cap-IT is built around the short, explanatory recording rather than the live stream. Unlike a bare capture tool, it does not stop at the raw file.

TAGLINE

**Capture
with
intention.**

• PROPOSED

Supporting lines: Capture beautifully · Make every recording count · From screen to story · Record. Refine. Share.

Value proposition

- **Capture the right thing** — display or single window, with live thumbnails.
- **Look intentional** — camera, cursor and click effects built in.
- **Finish in place** — trim, compose, add text, export.

Brand philosophy

“The recording should be easy, while the result should look intentional.” — the line already in the README, and the test every design decision has to pass.

Five principles

Precision

Motion

Clarity

Creativity

Control

Used as a checklist for layout, motion and copy.

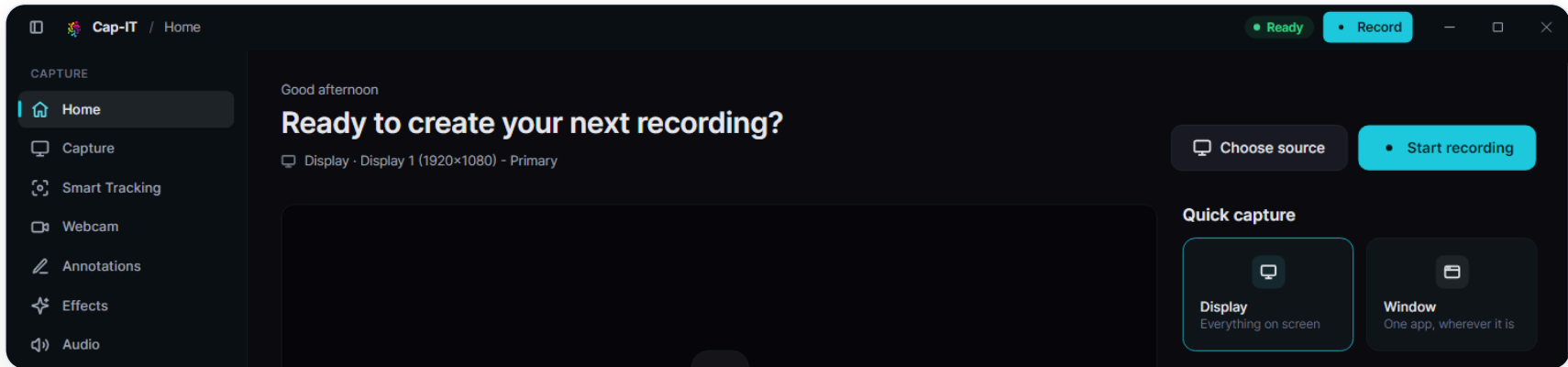
BRAND STORY

Made by someone who got tired of the tape and string.

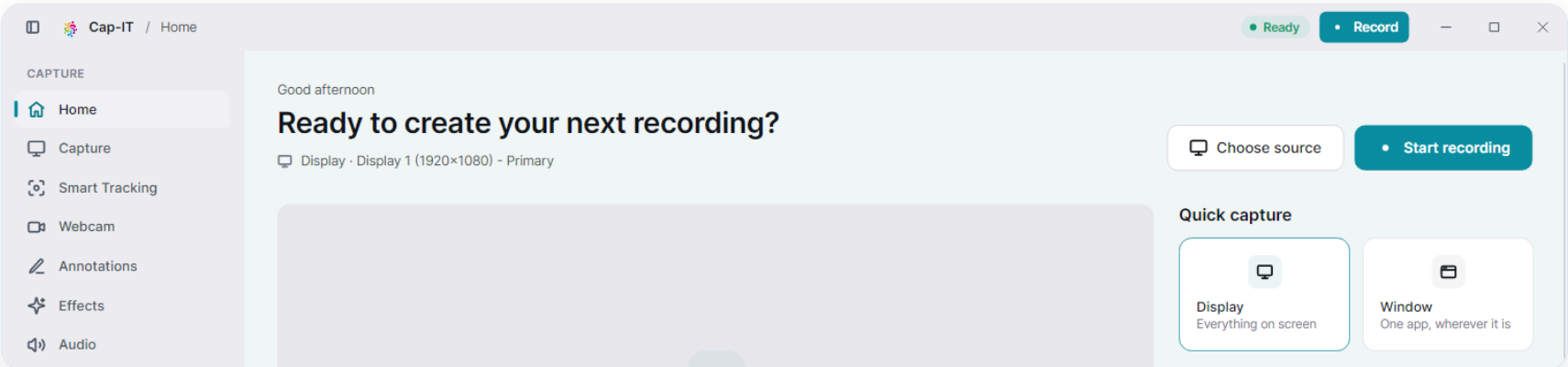
Cap-IT began as a way to make tutorials without juggling a recorder, a zoom plug-in, a webcam tool, an annotation overlay and a video editor. Each release since has pulled one more of those into the same window: DXGI capture, a camera that eases toward the cursor, a floating controller that never appears in the recording, a library, a review workspace.

The result is deliberately a **craft tool**, not a platform: native, quick to open, quiet in use, and honest about what it does.

3.13 1
current release line window from capture to export



Midnight · Home



Arctic · Home

WHO IT IS FOR

- Educators & tutorial creators**
Need a camera that follows the lesson.
- Developers & QA engineers**
Need reproducible bug reports and quick GIFs.
- Product teams & SaaS founders**
Need walkthroughs and demos that look finished.
- Designers, freelancers & marketers**
Need backgrounds, frames and text without another editor.

Audience list from the product brief. No usage numbers are claimed.

ARCHETYPE & PERSONALITY

The Craftsperson with a **steady** **hand.**

Cap-IT is not the entertainer or the rebel. It is the skilled assistant who frames the shot for you and then gets out of the way: **exact**, **calm**, **helpful** and quietly **proud** of a clean result.

Precise

Calm

Helpful

Modern

Dependable

Quietly creative

Trust attributes

Native, not a web wrapper. Original recording preserved. No account wall in the shipped build.

Core promises

You will see what is being recorded.
Your original is never overwritten.
Effects can change while you record.

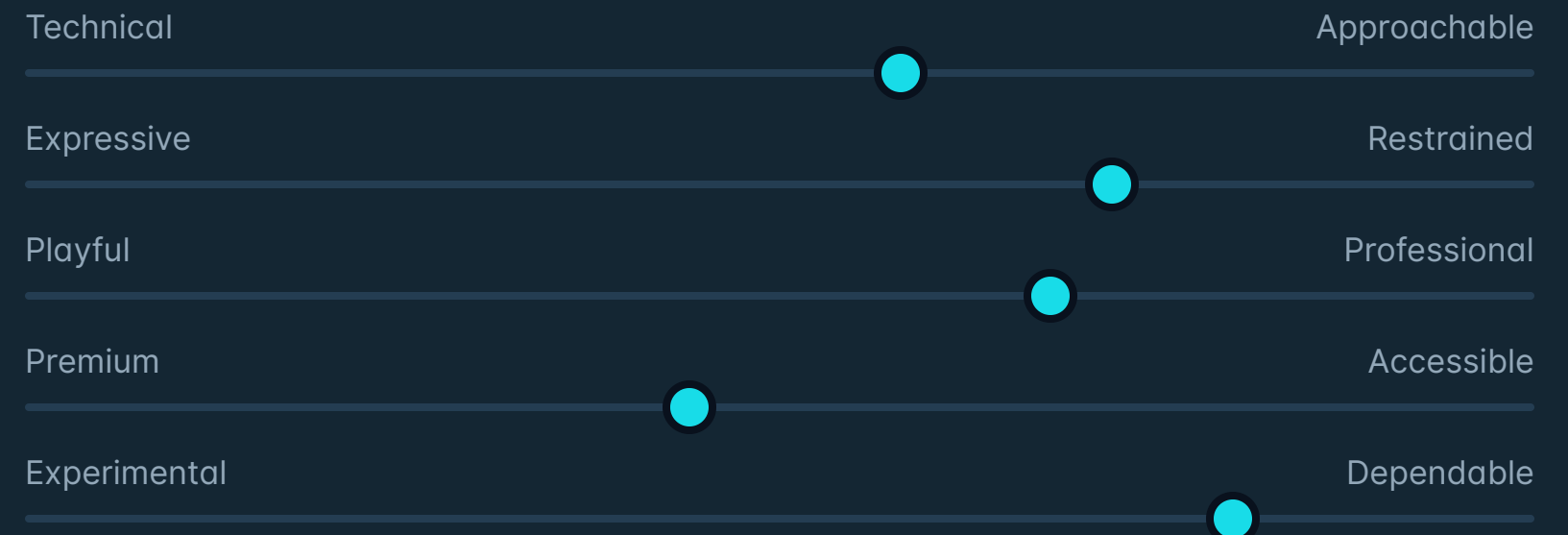
Perception goals

“Considered.” “Fast to learn.” “My videos look better than I expected.”

Not

Hype, gamer neon, enterprise stiffness, or a feature checklist shouted at the user.

PERSONALITY SPECTRUM



Position = where the brand should sit when two qualities pull against each other. Leans professional, restrained and dependable; close to the middle on premium vs accessible, because the product is free to try and demonstrably polished.

PAIN POINTS → BENEFITS → DIFFERENTIATORS

What people struggle with, and the plain answer to each.

CUSTOMER PAIN POINT	BENEFIT CAP-IT DELIVERS	EVIDENCE IN THE PRODUCT
Recordings look amateur: static, hard to follow.	Smart Tracking camera follows cursor and text caret and eases back out.	Interaction-triggered zoom; critically damped motion
Too many tools for one tutorial.	Capture, effects, webcam, annotations, trim, compose and export in one window.	One native app, one library
Unsure what is actually being recorded.	Live source thumbnails and a live preview before you press record.	DXGI + Windows Graphics Capture previews
Edits risk the original footage.	Edits are metadata beside the video; the original stays untouched.	“Original recording preserved”
Heavy recorders slow the machine.	GPU-assisted processing and hardware encoder support with software fallback.	NVENC · AMF · QSV · x264
Sharing needs another conversion.	MP4 and two-pass GIF export from the same workspace.	Review & Export

- 1 Native Windows workflow

2 GPU-assisted processing

3 Smart Tracking zoom

4 Smooth, controlled camera

5 Capture + edit together

6 Cursor enhancements

7 Backgrounds & composition

8 Hardware encoding

9 Audio monitoring

10 MP4 & GIF delivery

The ten differentiators come from the product brief and are all described in the v3.13.1 README. No benchmark or performance figure is claimed here.

HOW THE BRAND SHOULD FEEL

Four moments. One temperament.

01

Onboarding

Welcoming, unhurried

“Ready to create your next recording?”

One obvious action. No setup wall. Show the source before asking for anything.

02

Recording

Quiet and certain

“Ready · ● Record”

Disappear. A small controller that never appears in the video, a clear REC state, nothing that competes.

03

Editing

Precise and generous

“Original recording preserved · edits save automatically”

Dense controls, but reassuring. Every change is reversible and says so.

04

Exporting

Satisfying, honest

“Export video · Export GIF 720px / 12 fps”

Determinate progress, a clear finish, and the file one click away.

● EXISTING

The quoted strings are the application's own microcopy (Home, status bar, Review & Export).

THE EXISTING MARK • EXISTING

Five arcs, one centre, in motion.

The Cap-IT symbol is five rounded arcs, each ending in a detached round terminal, turning around a shared centre. Five hues sit around the circle; none repeats. The turn suggests a camera iris and a handover between the five stages of a recording.

HUE	HEX	RGB
 Orange	#FFAA21	255, 170, 33
 Magenta	#EA0B7F	234, 11, 127
 Purple	#971A8D	151, 26, 141
 Blue	#1AABE3	26, 171, 227
 Green	#85C536	133, 197, 54
 Wordmark grey	#3A3939	58, 57, 57

Sampled from assets/Logo-CapIT.png (2000×2000, transparent).



LOGO SYSTEM

Lockups and variants

Stacked lockup • EXISTING

The shipped artwork. Wordmark is 2.4% of the symbol height: use the symbol alone below 200 px.

Stacked, reversed • DERIVED

Wordmark recoloured #3A3939 → #F5F9FC. Symbol pixels untouched.

Symbol only • EXISTING

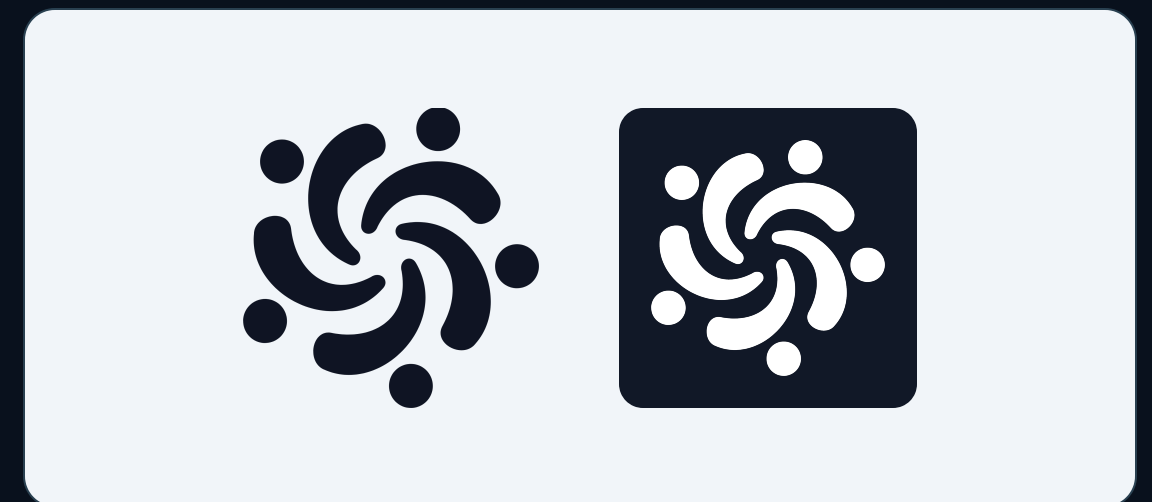
Preferred mark for the app, icons and anywhere ≤ 200 px.

Horizontal lockup · Midnight • PROPOSED

Symbol + “Cap-IT” in Inter SemiBold. New: the repository defines no horizontal lockup.

Horizontal lockup · Arctic • PROPOSED

Same construction for light surfaces. Cap-height = 38% of symbol height.

Monochrome • DERIVED

Single-colour for stamps, engraving and one-colour print. Brand-cyan variants are included in the asset pack.

CLEAR SPACE & SIZE

Room to breathe.

Keep clear space equal to **X** on every side of the symbol, where X is the diameter of the largest round terminal (the magenta dot). Nothing — text, edge, image or another logo — enters that margin.

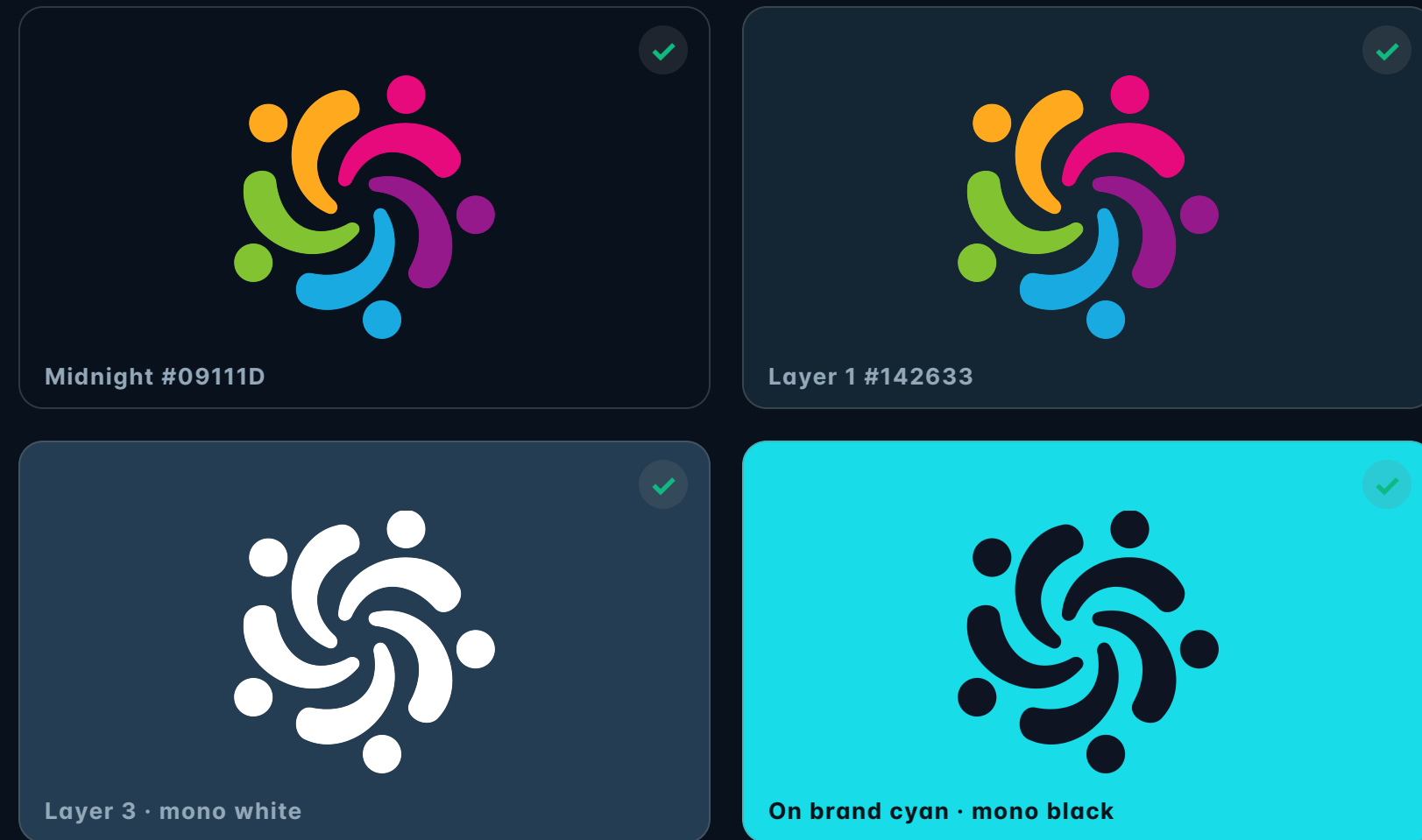
USE	MINIMUM
Symbol, screen	16 px (favicon, tray) — optimised app icon below
Symbol, print	8 mm
Stacked lockup, screen	200 px symbol height (wordmark stays legible)
Horizontal lockup	24 px symbol height
Optical alignment	Centre on the circle's centre, not on the bounding box

Aspect ratio of the symbol artwork is 0.989 : 1 (1375 × 1391). Never stretch; scale proportionally.



MIDNIGHT SURFACES

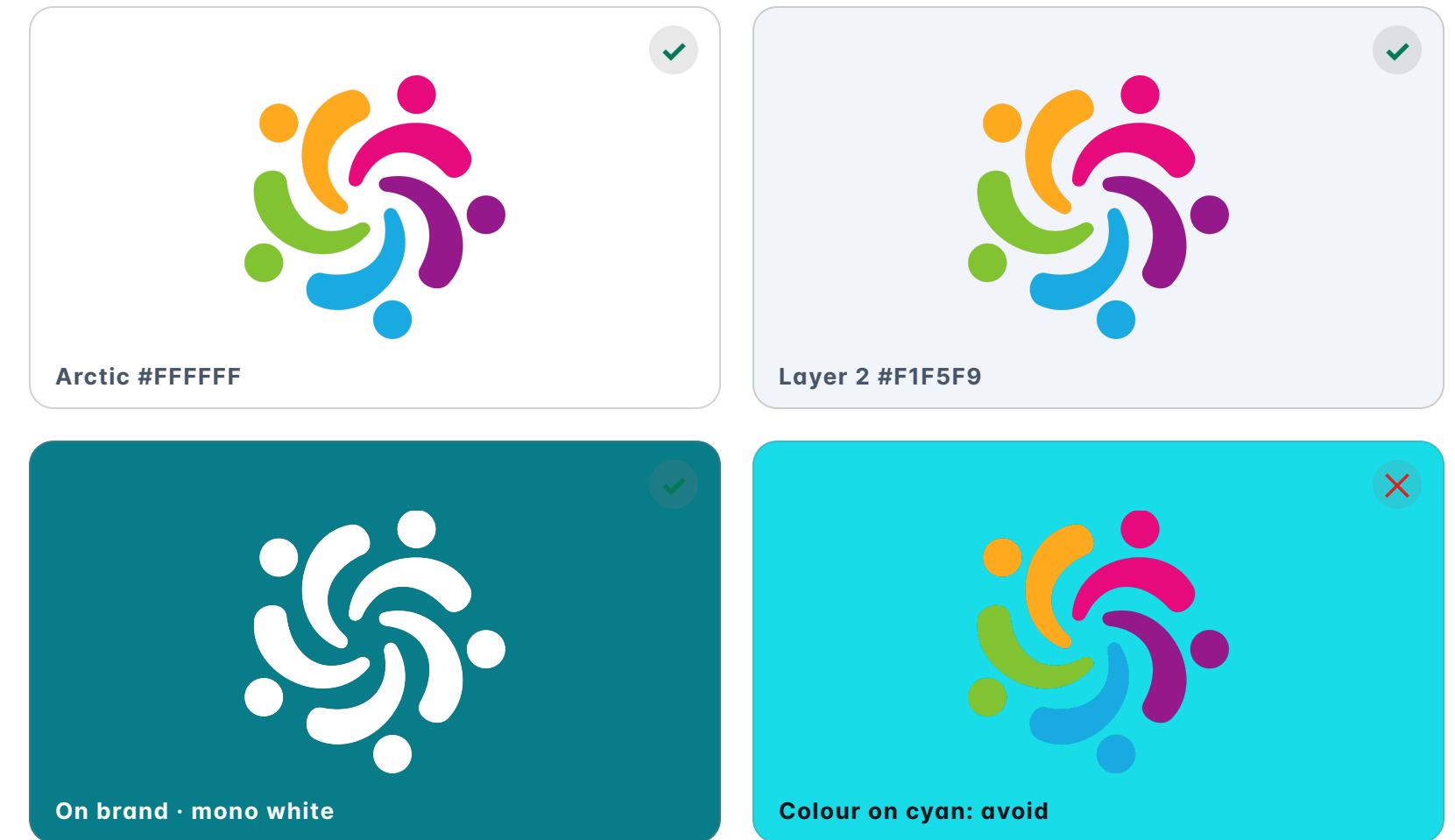
Colour symbol on dark



Use the reversed stacked lockup (wordmark #F5F9FC) whenever the wordmark is shown.

ARCTIC SURFACES

Colour symbol on light



The colour symbol never sits on a saturated brand field: use mono white or mono black there.

INCORRECT USAGE

Eight ways not to use the mark



Do not stretch or squash



Do not rotate



Do not recolour the hues



Do not add shadows or glows



Do not outline



Do not reduce opacity



Do not crop the symbol



Do not place on busy imagery

Accessibility

The multi-colour symbol is decorative next to the name “Cap-IT”; give it empty alt text there, and “Cap-IT logo” when it stands alone.

Background restrictions

Place on Midnight or Arctic surfaces and on photographs only where the symbol sits on a flat, calm area at $\geq 4.5:1$ average contrast.

IDENTITY IN CONTEXT

App icon, taskbar, installer, avatar

Application icon

• PROPOSED



A rounded plate (22.4%) holds the existing symbol at 64% of the plate. Midnight is the default; Arctic for light shells. The shipped AppIcon.ico (transparent symbol) stays until this is adopted.

Windows taskbar & Start

• CONCEPT



Favicon & avatars

• PROPOSED



Round 512 px for GitHub, X, LinkedIn and YouTube. 32 and 16 px use the plate for contrast on browser tabs.

Installer

• CONCEPT



Inno Setup “modern” wizard (existing). Side-panel artwork is a concept; the script today uses only SetupIconFile.

GitHub repository identity

• PROPOSED



Social preview (1280×640) templates are in the asset pack for both themes.

THEME ONE

Midnight

Precision after dark: deep navy surfaces, restrained cyan, a violet whisper.

- Backgrounds #09111D → #1B3042
- Cyan #18DCE8 on every action
- Text 17.9 : 1 on Midnight



THEME TWO

Arctic

Precision in daylight: crisp white, calibrated teal, ink-navy type.

- Backgrounds #FFFFFF → #F1F5F9
- Teal #087C88, tuned for 4.5 : 1
- Text 17.7 : 1 on Arctic

WHAT SHIPS TODAY

Both themes already exist in the app.

Cap-IT v3.13.1 implements a Dark and a Light theme in `Styles/Colors.xaml`, switched by `RequestedThemeVariant` (System · Light · Dark). Views only reference semantic `Brush.*` keys — the system this book builds on, rather than replaces.

Dark (flagship) — implemented • EXISTING

Background #0B0D11	Title bar #0E1015	Surface #13161C	Raised #191D24
Border #272D36	Text #E7EAEF	Text 2 #A1A9B6	Muted #6C7583
Accent #22CBDD	Success #3DD68C	Warning #F5B83D	Error #F26D6D
Info #6AA8FF	Recording #F2555A		

Light — implemented • EXISTING

Background #F4F5F7	Title bar #ECEE1	Surface #FFFFFF	Raised #FFFFFF
Border #D5DAE1	Text #12161C	Text 2 #4D5664	Muted #78818F
Accent #0A8FA0	Success #0E9F6E	Warning #B7740B	Error #D23B3B
Info #2F6FDB	Recording #E5383E		

Values are parsed from the source file at build time. Accent: Dark #22CBDD · Light #0A8FA0. The five-colour logo is not used as a UI colour source in either theme.

MEASURED, NOT GUESSED

An accessibility audit of the shipped themes

Every pair below was computed from the implemented token values (WCAG 2.x relative luminance). Pairs that fail are the reason the proposed palette in this chapter changes some values.

Dark — implemented

PAIR	RATIO	NEEDS	RESULT
TextPrimary on BackgroundPrimary	16.13	text 4.5:1	AAA
TextSecondary on BackgroundPrimary	8.21	text 4.5:1	AAA
TextSecondary on Surface	7.65	text 4.5:1	AAA
TextMuted on BackgroundPrimary	4.18	text 4.5:1	FAIL
TextMuted on Surface	3.89	text 4.5:1	FAIL
AccentText on Surface	11.13	text 4.5:1	AAA
TextOnAccent on Accent	9.19	text 4.5:1	AAA
Success on Surface	9.66	text 4.5:1	AAA
Warning on Surface	10.18	text 4.5:1	AAA
Error on Surface	6.20	text 4.5:1	AA
Info on Surface	7.47	text 4.5:1	AAA
Recording on Surface	5.37	text 4.5:1	AA
BorderNormal on Surface	1.31	UI 3:1	FAIL
BorderStrong on Surface	1.73	UI 3:1	FAIL

Light — implemented

PAIR	RATIO	NEEDS	RESULT
TextPrimary on BackgroundPrimary	16.63	text 4.5:1	AAA
TextSecondary on BackgroundPrimary	6.80	text 4.5:1	AA
TextSecondary on Surface	7.42	text 4.5:1	AAA
TextMuted on BackgroundPrimary	3.61	text 4.5:1	FAIL
TextMuted on Surface	3.94	text 4.5:1	FAIL
AccentText on Surface	5.17	text 4.5:1	AA
TextOnAccent on Accent	3.85	text 4.5:1	FAIL
Success on Surface	3.39	text 4.5:1	FAIL
Warning on Surface	3.81	text 4.5:1	FAIL
Error on Surface	4.74	text 4.5:1	AA
Info on Surface	4.75	text 4.5:1	AA
Recording on Surface	4.23	text 4.5:1	FAIL
BorderNormal on Surface	1.41	UI 3:1	FAIL
BorderStrong on Surface	1.88	UI 3:1	FAIL

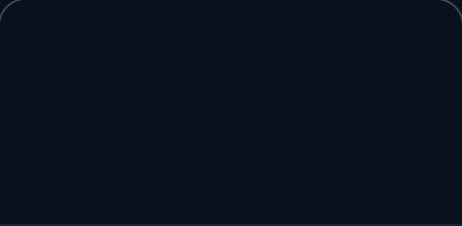
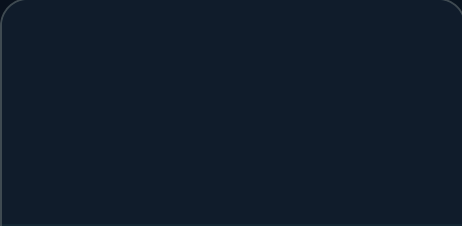
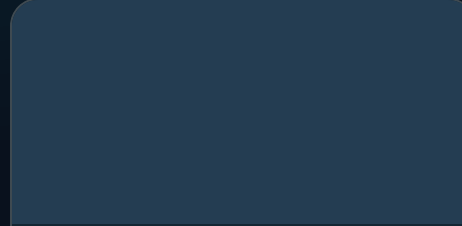
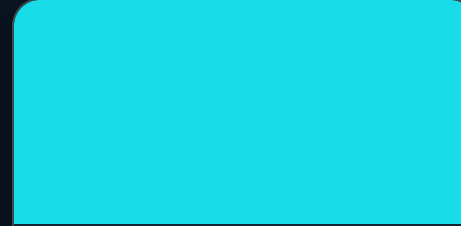
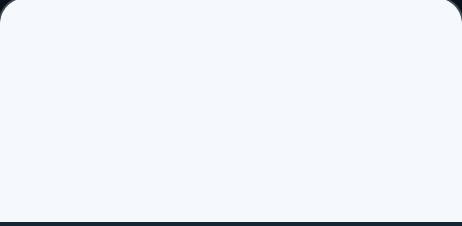
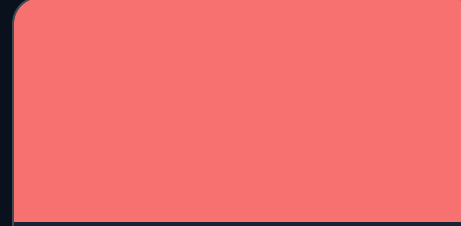
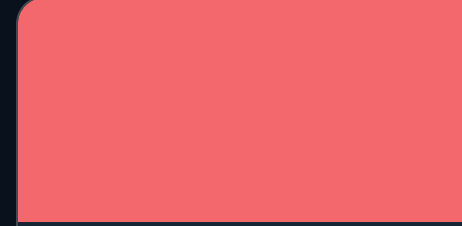
Findings. Light: the white label on the accent button is **3.85 : 1** (needs 4.5 for 13 px semibold), and Success, Warning and Recording text on white are 3.4–4.2 : 1. Dark: Muted text is 3.9–4.2 : 1. Input and card borders in both themes are 1.4–1.9 : 1, acceptable for decorative card outlines but not for identifying an input (SC 1.4.11 asks 3 : 1). Disabled text is exempt. Nothing here was changed in the application.

MIDNIGHT PRECISION

Deep, calm, exact.

• PROPOSED

Navy-tinted surfaces replace the near-neutral charcoal; the cyan brightens slightly, and violet appears only as a creative accent.

 Background #09111D · 9, 17, 29	 Canvas #101C2B · 16, 28, 43	 Layer 1 #142633 · 20, 38, 51	 Layer 2 #1B3042 · 27, 48, 66	 Layer 3 #243D52 · 36, 61, 82	 Brand primary #18DCE8 · 24, 220, 232	 Brand secondary #7C5CFF · 124, 92, 255
 Text #F5F9FC · 245, 249, 252	 Text 2 #93A8B9 · 147, 168, 185	 Muted #8398A7 · 131, 152, 167 adjusted from #6F8799	 Success #10B981 · 16, 185, 129	 Warning #F59E0B · 245, 158, 11	 Error #F87171 · 248, 113, 113	 Recording #F3686C · 243, 104, 108 adjusted from #F2555A

Not a simple inversion

Light-on-dark text is slightly cool (#F5F9FC), never pure white, to reduce glare on long sessions.

Where it starts from

The initial palette in the brief. Values marked “adjusted” missed WCAG 2.2 AA when measured and moved the shortest distance that passes.

Logo relationship

The five-colour symbol is unchanged and sits on these surfaces as-is; only the interface accent is cyan.

ARCTIC PRECISION

Crisp, clear, composed.

• PROPOSED

A white-first palette: white cards on a cool-white canvas, ink-navy type, and a teal tuned down just far enough to carry white labels at 4.5 : 1.

Background #FFFFFF · 255, 255, 255	Canvas #F6F8FB · 246, 248, 251	Layer 1 #FFFFFF · 255, 255, 255	Layer 2 #F1F5F9 · 241, 245, 249	Layer 3 #E8EEF4 · 232, 238, 244	Brand primary #087C88 · 8, 124, 136 adjusted from #087F8C	Brand secondary #6941C6 · 105, 65, 198
Text #111827 · 17, 24, 39	Text 2 #475569 · 71, 85, 105	Muted #667182 · 102, 113, 130 adjusted from #7B8798	Success #047857 · 4, 120, 87	Warning #B45309 · 180, 83, 9	Error #DA2323 · 218, 35, 35 adjusted from #DC2626	Recording #DC1D23 · 220, 29, 35 adjusted from #E5383E

Not a simple inversion

The accent is darker, not just desaturated, because a bright cyan has too little contrast on white.

Where it starts from

The initial palette in the brief. Values marked “adjusted” missed WCAG 2.2 AA when measured and moved the shortest distance that passes.

Logo relationship

The five-colour symbol is unchanged and sits on these surfaces as-is; only the interface accent is cyan.

MIDNIGHT SEMANTIC TOKENS · SURFACES · FOREGROUND · BRAND

● PROPOSED

Surfaces & foreground

TOKEN	HEX	RGB	HSL	AA	USAGE
bg.app	#09111D	9, 17, 29	216, 53%, 7%	—	Window background, sidebar and title bar; marketing and document canvas.
bg.secondary	#101C2B	16, 28, 43	213, 46%, 12%	—	Page canvas behind cards inside the application.
surface.layer1	#142633	20, 38, 51	205, 44%, 14%	—	Cards, panels and the default container surface.
surface.layer2	#1B3042	27, 48, 66	208, 42%, 18%	—	Raised or inset wells: inputs, segmented tracks, hovered rows.
surface.layer3	#243D52	36, 61, 82	207, 39%, 23%	—	Tracks, meters and skeletons.
surface.overlay	#1B3042	27, 48, 66	208, 42%, 18%	—	Popovers, menus, tooltips and dialogs.
surface.scrim	#050B14 α0.72	5, 11, 20	216, 60%, 5%	—	Dim layer behind modal dialogs.
fg.primary	#F5F9FC	245, 249, 252	206, 54%, 97%	12.8	Headlines, body copy, values and any text that carries meaning.
fg.secondary	#93A8B9	147, 168, 185	207, 21%, 65%	5.5	Descriptions, labels, secondary values.
fg.muted	#8398A7	131, 152, 167	205, 17%, 58%	4.5	Captions, placeholders, timestamps and helper text.
fg.disabled	#4F6578	79, 101, 120	208, 21%, 39%	—	Disabled text and icons.

Brand

TOKEN	HEX	RGB	HSL	AA	USAGE
brand.primary	#18DCE8	24, 220, 232	183, 82%, 50%	8.0	The Cap-IT accent: primary button fill, switch and slider fill, active navigation, links, focus ring.
brand.primary.hover	#4BE6EE	75, 230, 238	183, 83%, 61%	—	Hover state of brand.
brand.primary.pressed	#12B7C2	18, 183, 194	184, 83%, 42%	—	Pressed state of brand.
brand.on-primary	#04141A	4, 20, 26	196, 73%, 6%	—	Label and icon colour placed on a brand.
brand.secondary	#7C5CFF	124, 92, 255	252, 100%, 68%	—	Creative accent for graphics, gradients, illustrations and non-text indicators.
brand.secondary.text	#9B82FF	155, 130, 255	252, 100%, 75%	4.5	Violet as text or small icon on any text-bearing surface.
brand.secondary.solid	#7958FF	121, 88, 255	252, 100%, 67%	4.5	Violet as a solid fill that carries a label.
brand.secondary.on-solid	FFFFFF	255, 255, 255	0, 0%, 100%	—	Label colour on brand.

“AA” = lowest measured contrast of the token against every text-bearing layer (4.5 : 1; borders 3 : 1; “on” colours against their fill). CMYK approximations, full usage text and the Avalonia keys are in the JSON and the Markdown guide.

MIDNIGHT SEMANTIC TOKENS · BORDERS · STATE · STATUS · RECORDING

● PROPOSED

Borders & state

TOKEN	HEX	RGB	HSL	AA	USAGE
border.subtle	 #294050	41, 64, 80	205, 32%, 24%	—	Decorative card and panel outlines.
divider	 #203443	32, 52, 67	206, 35%, 19%	—	Hairlines between rows and sections.
border.control	 #527188	82, 113, 136	206, 25%, 43%	3.0	Outline of inputs, dropdowns, checkboxes and sliders: meets the 3:1 non-text rule (SC 1).
state.hover	 #FFFFFF a0.06	255, 255, 255	0, 0%, 100%	—	Hover wash over any surface.
state.pressed	 #FFFFFF a0.1	255, 255, 255	0, 0%, 100%	—	Pressed wash over any surface.
state.selected	 #18DCE8 a0.16	24, 220, 232	183, 82%, 50%	—	Selected row, tab or navigation item background.
state.focus-ring	 #18DCE8	24, 220, 232	183, 82%, 50%	8.0	2px focus ring with a 2px offset on every focusable control.
state.selection-text	 #18DCE8 a0.3	24, 220, 232	183, 82%, 50%	—	Selected text highlight.
state.disabled-fill	 #FFFFFF a0.04	255, 255, 255	0, 0%, 100%	—	Disabled control fill.

Status & recording

TOKEN	HEX	RGB	HSL	AA	USAGE
status.info	 #6AA8FF	106, 168, 255	215, 100%, 71%	5.6	Informational messages and neutral highlights.
status.success	 #10B981	16, 185, 129	160, 84%, 39%	5.3	Success feedback and completed states.
status.warning	 #F59E0B	245, 158, 11	38, 92%, 50%	6.3	Warnings and paused or at-risk states.
status.error	 #F87171	248, 113, 113	0, 91%, 71%	4.9	Errors and destructive confirmations.
rec.active	 #F3686C	243, 104, 108	358, 85%, 68%	4.5	The live recording indicator, timer dot and record state.
rec.paused	 #F59E0B	245, 158, 11	38, 92%, 50%	6.3	Paused recording indicator.
rec.exporting	 #9B82FF	155, 130, 255	252, 100%, 75%	4.5	Export in progress.
rec.export-complete	 #10B981	16, 185, 129	160, 84%, 39%	5.3	Export finished successfully.

“AA” = lowest measured contrast of the token against every text-bearing layer (4.5 : 1; borders 3 : 1; “on” colours against their fill). CMYK approximations, full usage text and the Avalonia keys are in the JSON and the Markdown guide.

ARCTIC SEMANTIC TOKENS · SURFACES · FOREGROUND · BRAND

● PROPOSED

Surfaces & foreground

TOKEN	HEX	RGB	HSL	AA	USAGE
bg.app	 #FFFFFF	255, 255, 255	0, 0%, 100%	—	Window background, sidebar and title bar; marketing and document canvas.
bg.secondary	 #F6F8FB	246, 248, 251	216, 38%, 97%	—	Page canvas behind cards inside the application.
surface.layer1	 #FFFFFF	255, 255, 255	0, 0%, 100%	—	Cards, panels and the default container surface.
surface.layer2	 #F1F5F9	241, 245, 249	210, 40%, 96%	—	Raised or inset wells: inputs, segmented tracks, hovered rows.
surface.layer3	 #E8EEF4	232, 238, 244	210, 35%, 93%	—	Tracks, meters and skeletons.
surface.overlay	 #FFFFFF	255, 255, 255	0, 0%, 100%	—	Popovers, menus, tooltips and dialogs.
surface.scrim	 #09111D α0.4	9, 17, 29	216, 53%, 7%	—	Dim layer behind modal dialogs.
fg.primary	 #111827	17, 24, 39	221, 39%, 11%	16.2	Headlines, body copy, values and any text that carries meaning.
fg.secondary	 #475569	71, 85, 105	215, 19%, 35%	6.9	Descriptions, labels, secondary values.
fg.muted	 #667182	102, 113, 130	216, 12%, 45%	4.5	Captions, placeholders, timestamps and helper text.
fg.disabled	 #A9B4C2	169, 180, 194	214, 17%, 71%	—	Disabled text and icons.

Brand

TOKEN	HEX	RGB	HSL	AA	USAGE
brand.primary	 #087C88	8, 124, 136	186, 89%, 28%	4.5	The Cap-IT accent: primary button fill, switch and slider fill, active navigation, links, focus ring.
brand.primary.hover	 #066A76	6, 106, 118	186, 90%, 24%	—	Hover state of brand.
brand.primary.pressed	 #055C66	5, 92, 102	186, 91%, 21%	—	Pressed state of brand.
brand.on-primary	 #FFFFFF	255, 255, 255	0, 0%, 100%	—	Label and icon colour placed on a brand.
brand.secondary	 #6941C6	105, 65, 198	258, 54%, 52%	—	Creative accent for graphics, gradients, illustrations and non-text indicators.
brand.secondary.text	 #6941C6	105, 65, 198	258, 54%, 52%	6.0	Violet as text or small icon on any text-bearing surface.
brand.secondary.solid	 #6941C6	105, 65, 198	258, 54%, 52%	6.6	Violet as a solid fill that carries a label.
brand.secondary.on-solid	 #FFFFFF	255, 255, 255	0, 0%, 100%	—	Label colour on brand.

“AA” = lowest measured contrast of the token against every text-bearing layer (4.5 : 1; borders 3 : 1; “on” colours against their fill). CMYK approximations, full usage text and the Avalonia keys are in the JSON and the Markdown guide.

ARCTIC SEMANTIC TOKENS · BORDERS · STATE · STATUS · RECORDING

● PROPOSED

Borders & state

TOKEN	HEX	RGB	HSL	AA	USAGE
border.subtle	 #E2E8F0	226, 232, 240	214, 32%, 91%	—	Decorative card and panel outlines.
divider	 #E9EEF3	233, 238, 243	210, 29%, 93%	—	Hairlines between rows and sections.
border.control	 #8191A8	129, 145, 168	215, 18%, 58%	3.0	Outline of inputs, dropdowns, checkboxes and sliders: meets the 3:1 non-text rule (SC 1).
state.hover	 #09111D a0.05	9, 17, 29	216, 53%, 7%	—	Hover wash over any surface.
state.pressed	 #09111D a0.09	9, 17, 29	216, 53%, 7%	—	Pressed wash over any surface.
state.selected	 #087C88 a0.1	8, 124, 136	186, 89%, 28%	—	Selected row, tab or navigation item background.
state.focus-ring	 #087C88	8, 124, 136	186, 89%, 28%	4.5	2px focus ring with a 2px offset on every focusable control.
state.selection-text	 #087C88 a0.22	8, 124, 136	186, 89%, 28%	—	Selected text highlight.
state.disabled-fill	 #09111D a0.04	9, 17, 29	216, 53%, 7%	—	Disabled control fill.

Status & recording

TOKEN	HEX	RGB	HSL	AA	USAGE
status.info	 #2A6BDA	42, 107, 218	218, 70%, 51%	4.5	Informational messages and neutral highlights.
status.success	 #047857	4, 120, 87	163, 94%, 24%	5.0	Success feedback and completed states.
status.warning	 #B45309	180, 83, 9	26, 90%, 37%	4.6	Warnings and paused or at-risk states.
status.error	 #DA2323	218, 35, 35	0, 72%, 50%	4.5	Errors and destructive confirmations.
rec.active	 #DC1D23	220, 29, 35	358, 77%, 49%	4.5	The live recording indicator, timer dot and record state.
rec.paused	 #B45309	180, 83, 9	26, 90%, 37%	4.6	Paused recording indicator.
rec.exporting	 #6941C6	105, 65, 198	258, 54%, 52%	6.0	Export in progress.
rec.export-complete	 #047857	4, 120, 87	163, 94%, 24%	5.0	Export finished successfully.

“AA” = lowest measured contrast of the token against every text-bearing layer (4.5 : 1; borders 3 : 1; “on” colours against their fill). CMYK approximations, full usage text and the Avalonia keys are in the JSON and the Markdown guide.

VERIFICATION

Every foreground against every layer it can meet

Midnight • PROPOSED

FOREGROUND	 #09111D	 #101C2B	 #142633	 #1B3042
 fg.primary	17.88	16.22	14.64	12.82
 fg.secondary	7.70	6.98	6.31	5.52
 fg.muted	6.32	5.74	5.18	4.53
 brand.primary	11.21	10.17	9.18	8.04
 brand.secondary.text	6.34	5.75	5.19	4.54
 status.info	7.80	7.08	6.39	5.59
 status.success	7.46	6.77	6.11	5.35
 status.warning	8.81	8.00	7.22	6.32
 status.error	6.84	6.21	5.60	4.90
 rec.active	6.32	5.73	5.17	4.53

Arctic • PROPOSED

FOREGROUND	 #FFFFFF	 #F6F8FB	 #F1F5F9
 fg.primary	17.74	16.67	16.19
 fg.secondary	7.58	7.12	6.92
 fg.muted	4.94	4.65	4.51
 brand.primary	4.94	4.65	4.51
 brand.secondary.text	6.62	6.22	6.04
 status.info	4.98	4.68	4.55
 status.success	5.48	5.15	5.01
 status.warning	5.02	4.72	4.58
 status.error	4.95	4.65	4.51
 rec.active	4.95	4.65	4.52

What changed from the brief's starting palette — shortest move that passes

Midnight fg.muted

 #6F8799 →  #8398A7

Midnight brand.secondary.text

 #7C5CFF →  #9B82FF

Midnight rec.active

 #F2555A →  #F3686C

Midnight rec.exporting

 #7C5CFF →  #9B82FF

Arctic border.control

 #B0BAC8 →  #8191A8

Arctic status.info

 #2F6FDB →  #2A6BDA

Midnight brand.secondary.solid

 #7C5CFF →  #7958FF

Arctic fg.muted

 #7B8798 →  #667182

Arctic status.error

 #DC2626 →  #DA2323

Midnight border.control

 #41596B →  #527188

Arctic brand.primary

 #087F8C →  #087C88

Arctic rec.active

 #E5383E →  #DC1D23

Reading the numbers. WCAG 2.2 AA asks 4.5 : 1 for normal text, 3 : 1 for large text and for the boundary of a control. Layer 3 is excluded because no text is placed on it. Colour is never the only carrier of status: every state also has an icon or label (chapter 19).

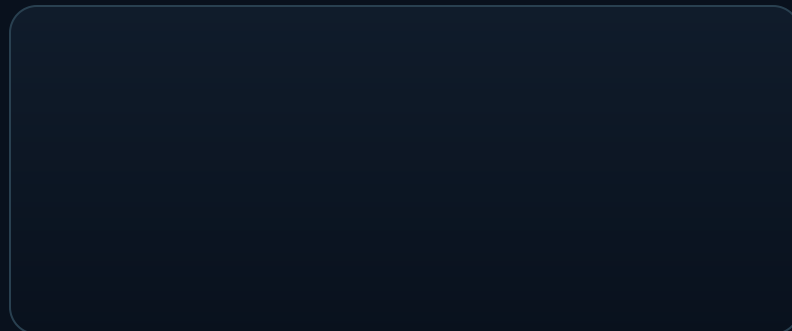
MIDNIGHT · GRADIENTS & ELEVATION



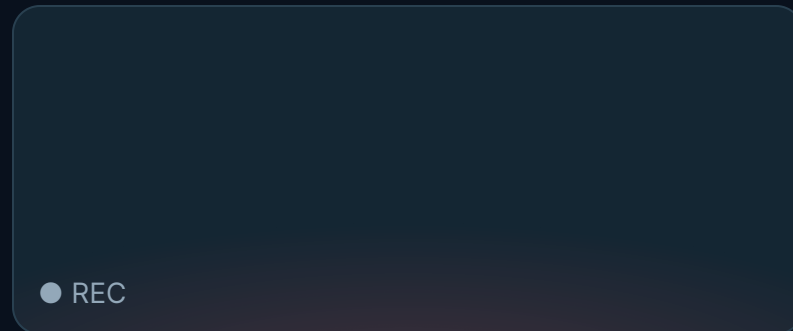
Identity · cyan → violet



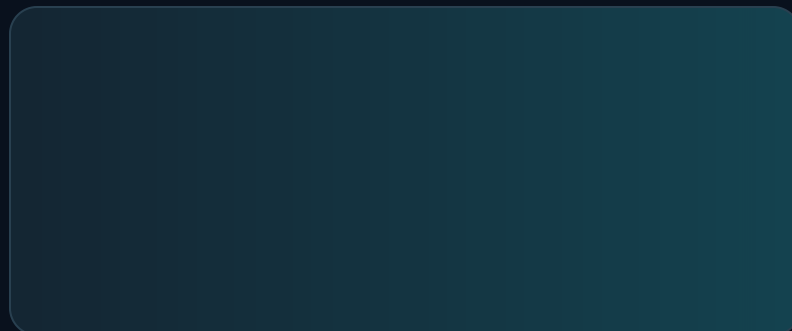
Spotlight



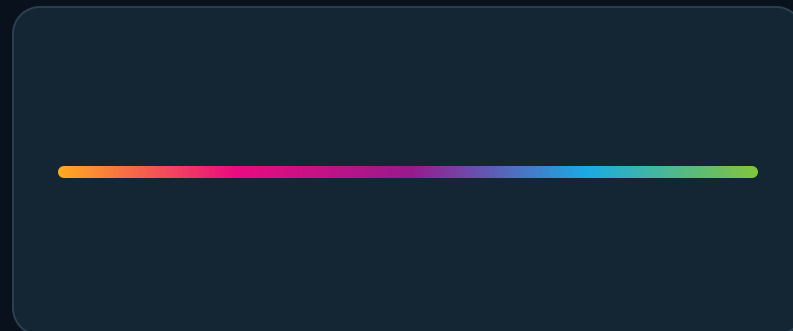
Surface



Recording edge glow



Accent subtle



Spectrum · the five logo hues, ≤ 6 px



e1 · cards



e2 · raised



overlay · menus, dialogs

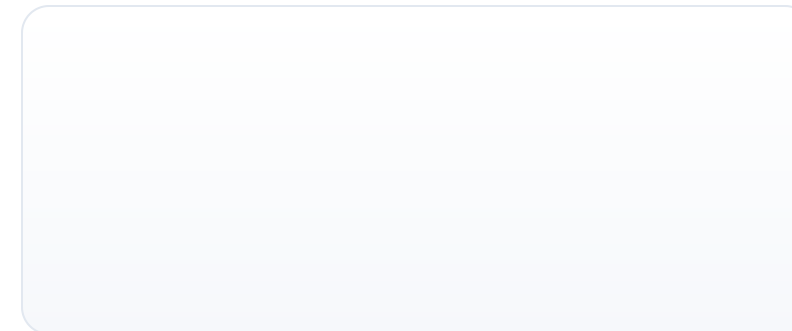
ARCTIC · GRADIENTS & ELEVATION



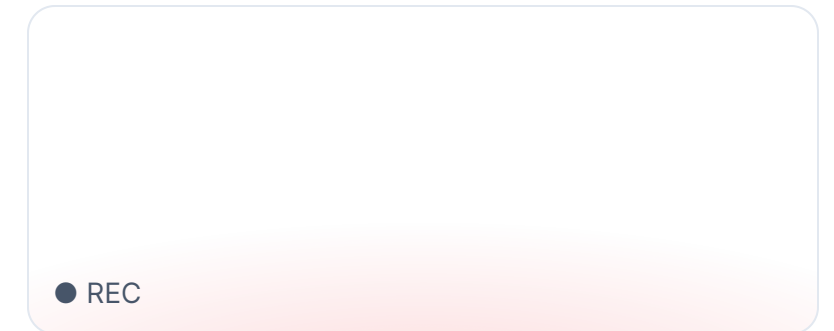
Identity · cyan → violet



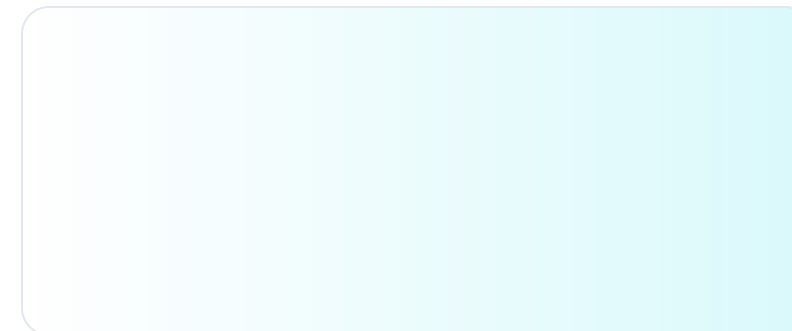
Spotlight



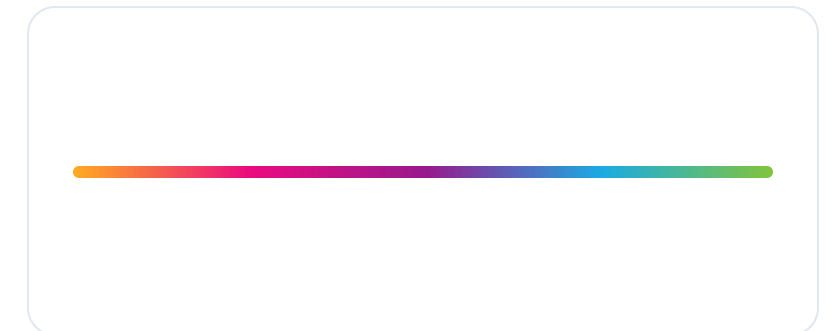
Surface



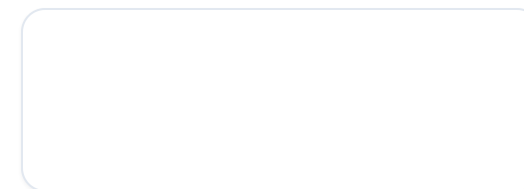
Recording edge glow



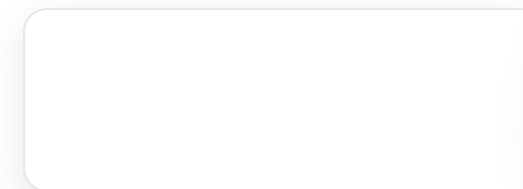
Accent subtle



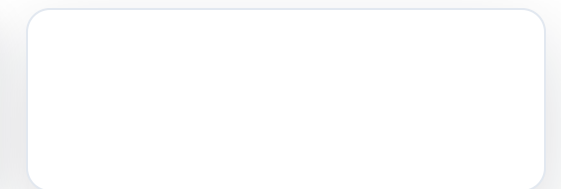
Spectrum · the five logo hues, ≤ 6 px



e1 · cards



e2 · raised



overlay · menus, dialogs

MIGRATION PATH

• PROPOSED

From today’s tokens to the proposed ones, one key at a time.

EXISTING KEY	EXISTING DARK / LIGHT	PROPOSED TOKEN	PROPOSED DARK / LIGHT	WHY	RISK
Brush.BackgroundPrimary	#0B0D11 / #F4F5F7	bg.app	#09111D / #FFFFFF	Navy-tinted dark; white-first light	Low
Brush.Surface	#13161C / #FFFFFF	surface.layer1	#142633 / #FFFFFF	Same role, new values	Low
Brush.Accent	#22CBDD / #0A8FA0	brand.primary	#18DCE8 / #087C88	Brighter dark; light now passes 4.5 : 1	Low
Brush.TextOnAccent	#03191C / #FFFFFF	brand.on-primary	#04141A / #FFFFFF	Fixes light button label 3.85 → 5.1 : 1	Low
Brush.TextMuted	#6C7583 / #78818F	fg.muted	#8398A7 / #667182	Fixes 3.9–4.2 : 1	Low
Brush.BorderNormal (inputs)	#272D36 / #D5DAE1	border.control	#527188 / #8191A8	Inputs reach 3 : 1; cards keep border.subtle	Medium — visible
Brush.Success / Warning / Error	see audit	status.*	see tokens	Light variants darkened to ≥ 4.5 : 1	Low
Brush.Recording	#F2555A / #E5383E	rec.active	#F3686C / #DC1D23	Passes on every text layer	Low
(new)	–	brand.secondary*	#7C5CFF ... / #6941C6	Creative accent: export state, Smart Tracking identity	Additive

1 · Add

Merge
avalonia/CapIT.Brand.Proposed.axaml
as new Brand.* keys beside the current
ones.

2 · Alias

Point one Brush.* key at its Brand.*
brush at a time; review in both themes.

3 · Verify

Re-run the UI snapshot harness for all
pages in both themes; compare against
this book.

4 · Retire

Remove old values only after every
screen is signed off. No production
styling was changed in this pass.

THEME BEHAVIOUR

Switching themes must never touch a recording.

Theme is presentation state. In v3.13.1 it lives in `AppSettings.Theme` and `App.ApplyTheme`, which only sets Avalonia's `RequestedThemeVariant`. The recording engine (`CapIT.Infrastructure.Windows`) contains no reference to theme at all — switching mid-recording only repaints brushes.

• EXISTING Verified

A search of the infrastructure project for “Theme” finds nothing. The floating recording controller is themed like any other window and is never part of the captured frame.

Manual & system

- Options: System default · Light · Dark (existing).
- “System default” follows the Windows app mode (existing).
- Proposed: the toggle in the title bar shows the *resolved* theme, not the setting.

Persistence

- Stored in `settings.json` beside other preferences (existing).
- Applied before the first window is shown, to avoid a flash of the wrong theme.
- The standalone editor (`--review`) reads the same preference.

Transitions

- Proposed: 180 ms cross-fade of surfaces; none under reduced motion.
- Never animate the live preview, meters or the REC indicator.
- No re-initialisation of capture, audio or encode.

Correct variants

Icons use `currentColor`, so they follow the theme. The logo uses the stacked-reversed lockup on Midnight and the standard one on Arctic; the colour symbol is unchanged in both.

High-DPI

Strokes scale with icon size (existing). Hairlines are 1 px at 100 % and stay 1 device-independent px at 125–200 %; verified renders were produced at 125 % scaling.

Semantic colour

Components reference semantic tokens only. A component that needs a raw hex has found a missing token.

TYPEFACE

• EXISTING

Inter

Inter is the interface typeface (bundled via Avalonia.Fonts.Inter, SIL Open Font License 1.1), with Segoe UI Variable Text and Segoe UI as fallbacks. Cascadia Mono, then Consolas, sets timers, shortcuts and code. One family keeps the product calm; hierarchy comes from size, weight and space.

Aa

Light 300

Aa

Regular 400

Aa

Medium 500

Aa

SemiBold 600

Aa

Bold 700

Application type scale

• EXISTING

ROLE	SIZE PX	WEIGHT	OTHER
Page title (Display)	28	600	letterSpacing -0.5
Title	20	600	letterSpacing -0.25
Section heading	16	600	–
Card title	14	600	–
Body	13	400	–
Row title	13	500	–
Secondary / description	12.5	400	lineHeight 18
Caption	11.5	400	–
Overline	10.5	600	letterSpacing 0.8, case upper

STACKS

Inter, Segoe UI Variable Text, Segoe UI, sans-serif
Cascadia Mono, Consolas, Courier New, monospace

Brand headline, UI, body: all Inter. No second display face is proposed.

EDITORIAL SCALE · FOR THE BOOK, WEBSITE AND MARKETING

● PROPOSED

hero
120/700 · 1.0

Capture with intention.

display
72/700 · 1.04

Make every recording count.

h1
48/650 · 1.1

From screen to story

h2
32/600 · 1.18

Smart Tracking follows the action

h3
24/600 · 1.25

Record. Refine. Share.

h4
20/600 · 1.3

Review & Export workspace

subtitle
22/400 · 1.45

A camera that glides toward your cursor and caret, then eases back out.

bodyLarge
18/400 · 1.6

Cap-IT keeps source selection, live preview, recording, effects and export in one place.

body
15/400 · 1.6

Trim, compose, add text or a device frame, then keep the MP4 or export a GIF.

caption
12/400 · 1.5

Original recording preserved · edits save automatically

overline
11/600 · 1.2

CAPTURE · SMART TRACKING · AUDIO

Sizes in px on a 1920-wide canvas; line-heights are unitless. Negative tracking tightens as size grows (−0.04 em at 120 px, 0 at 16 px). Capitalisation: sentence case everywhere except overlines (uppercase, +0.14 em) and the product name.

NUMERICS, CODE, FALLBACK AND LANGUAGE

Details that keep type honest.

Numeric displays

00:12:04

Recording timer — tabular figures, SemiBold (existing “timer” style).

1920 × 1080

Resolution, frame rate and bitrate use tabular figures so columns never jitter.

Code & shortcuts

```
dotnet build CapIT.sln  
dotnet run --project src\CapIT.Desktop
```

Ctrl **Shift** **D** toggle drawing

Responsive behaviour

- Application text does not scale with window width; layout reflows instead.
- Headlines may wrap to two lines, never truncate.
- Single-line values truncate with an ellipsis and a tooltip.

Localisation

- Inter covers Latin, Greek and Cyrillic. For Sinhala, Tamil, CJK and other scripts the interface falls through to Segoe UI Variable / Segoe UI and then Windows system font fallback — verify rendering per language before shipping it.
- Allow ~30–40 % text expansion in buttons and rows; never size a control to its English label.
- Dates, numbers and file names follow the system locale.

Accessibility

- Body text ≥ 13 px in the app (12.5 px secondary, 11.5 px captions are for supporting text only).
- Muted text is held to 4.5 : 1 in the proposed tokens.
- Honour Windows text scaling; no fixed-height text containers.
- Do not redistribute fonts other than Inter (OFL) and Cascadia Mono (OFL); both licences travel with the source folder.

SPACING, GRID, RADIUS, HEIGHT

• EXISTING

A 4 px base, an 8 px rhythm.

Spacing scale

Space.1	4
Space.2	8
Space.3	12
Space.4	16
Space.5	20
Space.6	24
Space.8	32
Space.10	40
Space.12	48

4 · 8 · 12 · 16 · 20 · 24 · 32 · 40 · 48. Views use these tokens; ad-hoc values are not allowed.

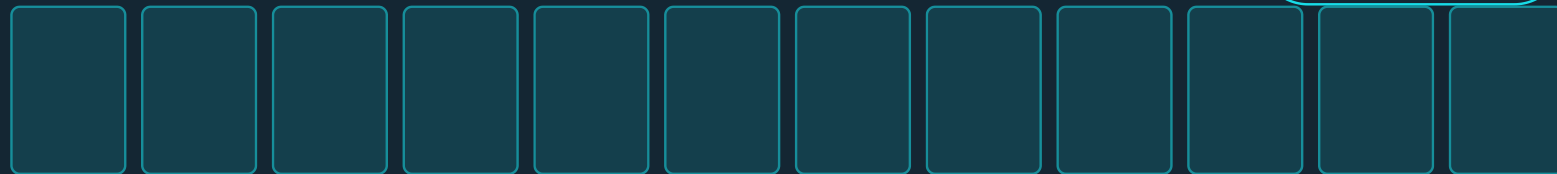
Corner radii



Cards use Large (12), controls Medium (8), pills 999. One radius per nesting level; never mix radii on adjoining edges.

Editorial 12-column grid

• PROPOSED



For this book and marketing layouts: 96 px margins, 24 px gutters, 12 columns on a 1920 canvas; baseline 8 px.

Control heights

small · 30

default · 36

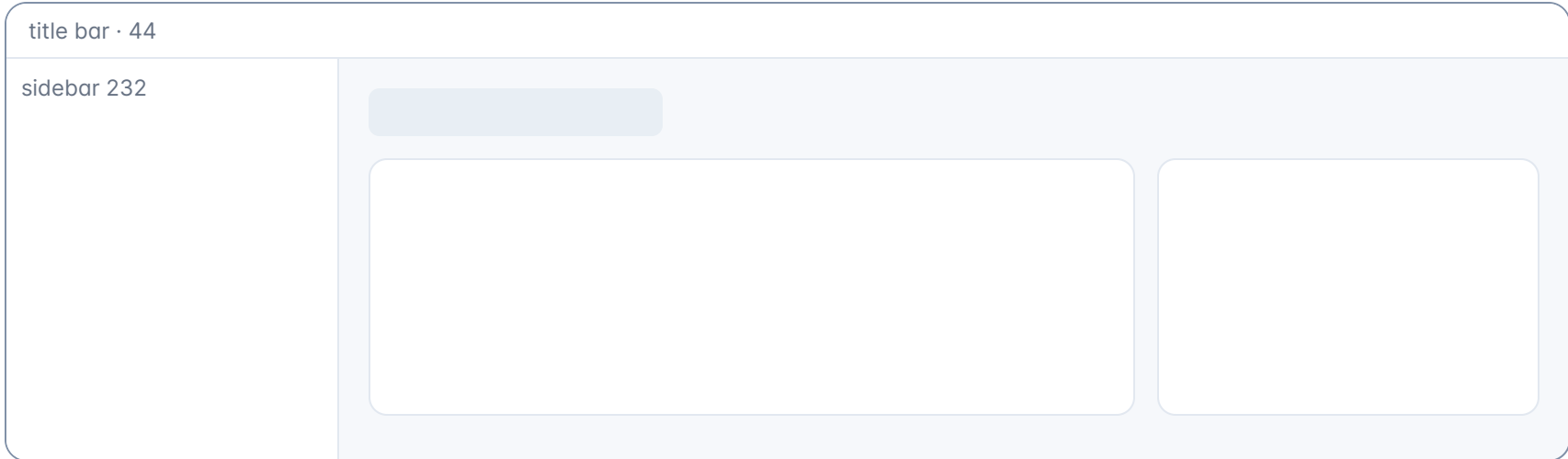
large · 44

Small 30 · Default 36 · Large 44 · Title bar 44 · Nav item 36 (shown at 135 %).

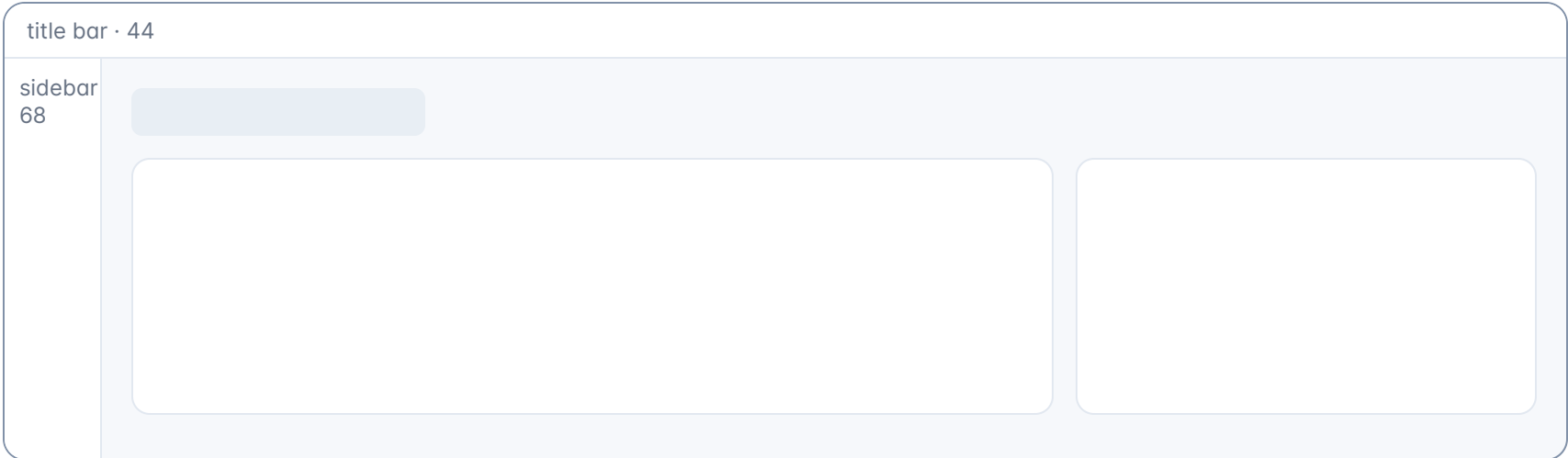
WINDOW LAYOUT, SCALING, MINIMUM SIZES • EXISTING

One shell. Two sidebar widths.

Expanded — sidebar 232 px



Compact — sidebar 68 px (icons only)



Metrics

Page content max	1440
Form width	880
Inspector	340
Control column	240
Page padding	32 28 32 40
Card padding	20 · compact 16

Window sizes

Main · default	1360 × 860
Main · minimum	1024 × 640
Review · default	1440 × 900
Review · minimum	960 × 600

From `MainWindow.axaml` and `ReviewWindow.axaml`.

Breakpoints

Compact	< 1280
Default	1280–1599
Wide	1600+

Sidebar auto-compacts in the compact band. High-DPI: layout in device-independent px; reference captures at 125 %.

Proper alignment

Content left edges align to the 32 px page padding; labels and values sit on the same 8 px baseline grid; icons centre on text x-height.

Improper alignment

Mixed paddings (e.g. 18 / 22) inside one card; controls of different heights in one row; centred text next to left-aligned labels.

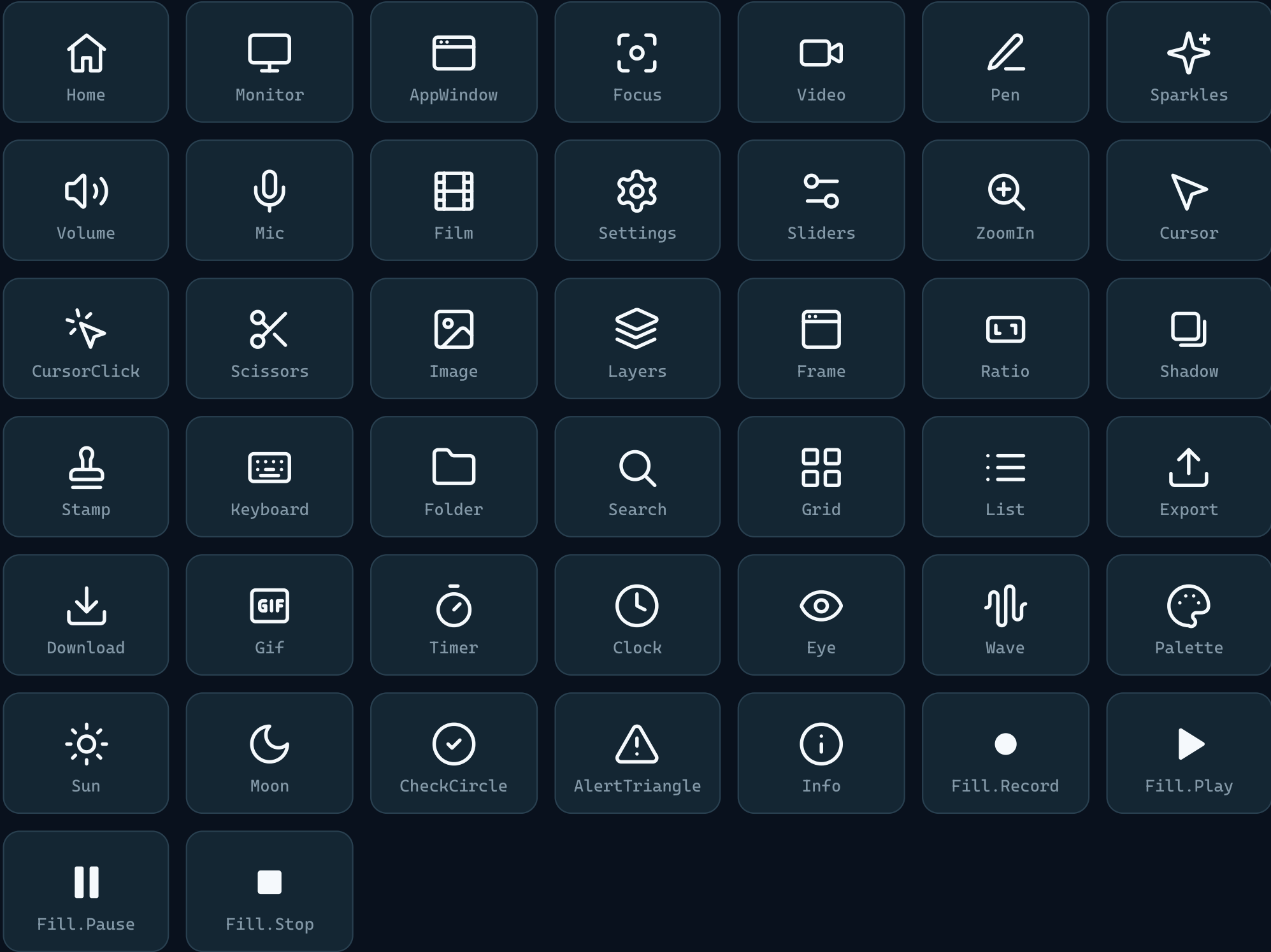
ICONOGRAPHY

• EXISTING

One family, drawn on a 24 px grid.

87 icons in `Styles/Icons.axaml`: round-capped, round-joined outline strokes at 1.75 px on a 24 × 24 grid (Lucide-compatible). Strokes scale with the icon, so a 14 px and a 24 px icon share optical weight. Record, play, pause and stop are the only solid glyphs.

Stroke	1.75 px · round cap / join
Optical bounds	20 px live area · 2 px padding
Corner treatment	2–3 px radius
Sizes	14 · 16 · 18 · 20 · 24



ICON STATES & FEATURE ICONS

Colour follows meaning, not decoration.

States — Arctic



Same icon on Midnight

Usage rules

- **Outlined** for navigation and commands; **filled** only for transport (record, play, pause, stop).
- Default colour is secondary text; the active item uses the brand accent; disabled uses the disabled foreground.
- Pair every icon-only button with a tooltip and an accessible name.
- Icons inherit text colour (`currentColor`) so themes need no icon variants.
- Feature colours (below) tint the icon chip, never the label.

Feature icons • EXISTING icons · colours are proposed (chapter 11)



Capture
Icon.Monitor



Smart Tracking
Icon.Focus



Audio
Icon.Volume



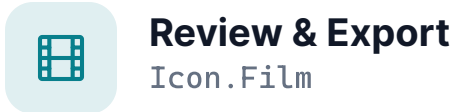
Webcam
Icon.Video



Effects
Icon.Sparkles



Annotations
Icon.Pen



Review & Export
Icon.Film



Recordings
Icon.Film



Settings
Icon.Settings

BRAND GRAPHIC LANGUAGE

Frames, focus and motion.

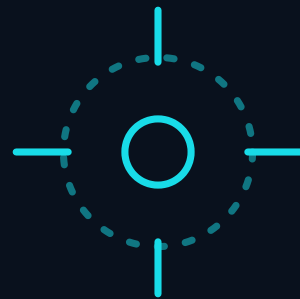
• PROPOSED

Original devices drawn from what the product does: framing a region, following it, and keeping time. Built from the interface's own 1.75–4 px round-capped stroke so they sit comfortably next to icons.



Capture brackets

The frame around anything captured.



Focus target

Where the camera is aiming.



Viewport frame

The crop the camera will show.



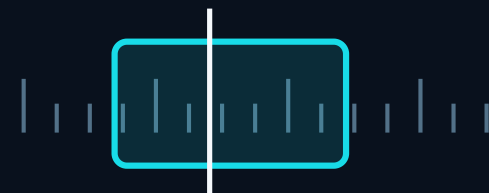
Recording indicator

Dot + label + timer. Never colour alone.



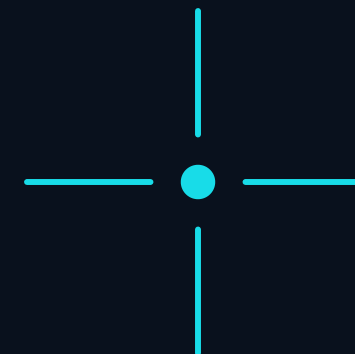
Camera path

Eased path A → B; dotted = history.



Timeline geometry

Ticks, selection, playhead.



Precision crosshair

Alignment and measurement.



Layered frames

Composition depth. The page grid behind is the 9th device: ≤ 55 % opacity.

GRAPHIC LANGUAGE IN USE

Density, background and restraint.

LEVEL 0
Quiet

Application surfaces. No decoration. The interface is the content.

LEVEL 1
Framed

Dialogs, empty states, chapter pages. One bracket or one focus mark.

LEVEL 2
Expressive

Marketing and covers. Grid, glow, brackets, trail — never all at full strength.

Do

- Use at most two devices per composition.
- Keep brackets at a 4 : 3–16 : 9 ratio; they should look like a capture frame.
- Let the grid fade out toward the content.

Don't

- Add decoration behind running text or UI.
- Animate brackets in the product UI (reserve for onboarding and marketing).
- Use the logo's five hues as a gradient fill; the spectrum strip is ≤ 6 px.

MOTION IDENTITY

Cap-IT is a motion product. Its motion is calm and exact.

01

Purposeful

Motion explains a change; it never decorates.

02

Smooth

Eased in and out; no abrupt starts.

03

Predictable

The same action always moves the same way.

04

Responsive

Feedback begins within 80–120 ms of input.

05

Accessible

Reduced motion removes travel, not feedback.

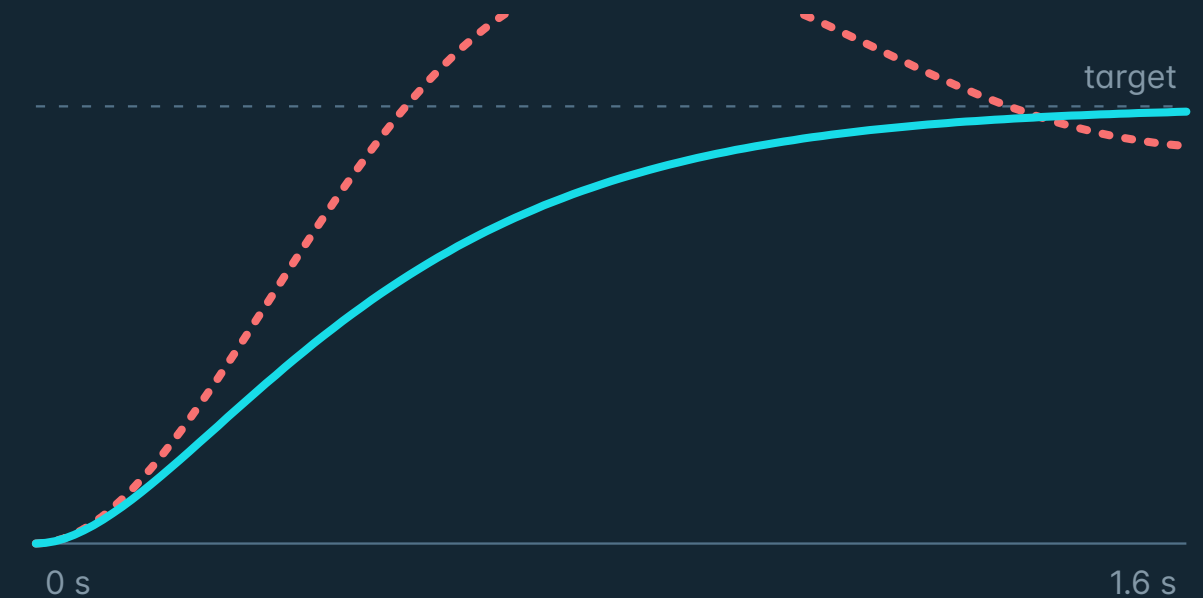
06

Performance-conscious

Transform and opacity only; never animate layout in a recording.

Smart Tracking camera

• EXISTING



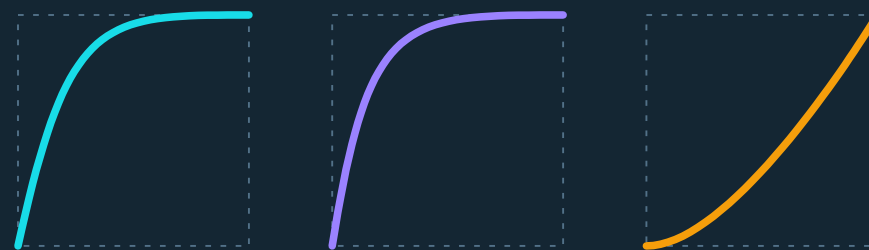
Critically damped (solid): fastest approach with no overshoot.

Underdamped (dotted, shown for contrast only): sails past the target and swings back — never used. In/out smooth times 0.50 s / 0.75 s, pan 0.32 s; framerate-independent.

DURATIONS

120_{fast} 180_{normal} 220_{slow}
ms · existing Duration.*

EASING (PROPOSED)



standard · enter · exit

CubicEaseOut is the existing curve for entrances.

MOTION SPECIFICATIONS

• PROPOSED

Interface motion vs rendered camera motion.

INTERACTION	MS	EASING	PROPERTIES	DIST. PX	SCALE
Hover	120	standard	background-color, border-color	—	—
Press	80	standard	background-color, scale	—	0.98
Focus ring	120	standard	opacity	—	—
Tab switch	180	standard	opacity, translateX	8	—
Sidebar collapse	220	standard	width (232 → 68)	164	—
Dropdown	160	enter	opacity, translateY	6	—
Dialog enter	200	enter	opacity, translateY	8	—
Dialog exit	140	exit	opacity	—	—
Toast	220	enter	opacity, translateY	10	—
Record start	180	standard	indicator opacity, scale 0.8 → 1	—	—
Export progress	220	standard	width (determinate)	—	—
Smart Tracking camera	500	camera	crop rectangle (rendered video, not UI)	—	—

Two kinds of motion

Interface motion uses eased curves, ≤ 220 ms, and only transform and opacity. **Camera** motion lives in the recorded video: a critically damped spring on the crop rectangle, with no overshoot, using real elapsed time so it stays smooth when frames arrive unevenly.

Reduced motion

Replace travel and scale with a 0–80 ms opacity change. Keep every state change; remove only the journey. Smart Tracking’s camera is a recording feature chosen by the user, so it is not suppressed by this setting.

Sharp text in motion

Move whole pixels at rest; allow sub-pixel translation only during the move. Never scale text up from below 1× — start at 1× and scale down.

MIDNIGHT

Buttons and their states

• PROPOSED

Primary	DEFAULT	HOVER	ACTIVE		
	• Start recording	• Start recording	• Start recording		
	FOCUS	DISABLED			
	• Start recording	• Start recording			
Secondary	DEFAULT	HOVER	ACTIVE		
	Choose source	Choose source	Choose source		
	FOCUS	DISABLED			
	Choose source	Choose source			
Tertiary	DEFAULT	HOVER	ACTIVE	FOCUS	DISABLED
	Cancel	Cancel	Cancel	Cancel	Cancel
Danger	DEFAULT	HOVER	ACTIVE	FOCUS	DISABLED
	Delete	Delete	Delete	Delete	Delete
Sizes	Small 30	Default 36	Large 44		
Icon · record	⚙️	⏸️	• Record	📤 Export video	

Primary uses brand.primary with brand.on-primary (≥ 4.5 : 1 in both themes). Focus is a 2 px ring with a 2 px offset.

ARCTIC

• PROPOSED

Primary	DEFAULT	HOVER	ACTIVE		
	• Start recording	• Start recording	• Start recording		
	FOCUS	DISABLED			
	• Start recording	• Start recording			
Secondary	DEFAULT	HOVER	ACTIVE		
	Choose source	Choose source	Choose source		
	FOCUS	DISABLED			
	Choose source	Choose source			
Tertiary	DEFAULT	HOVER	ACTIVE	FOCUS	DISABLED
	Cancel	Cancel	Cancel	Cancel	Cancel
Danger	DEFAULT	HOVER	ACTIVE	FOCUS	DISABLED
	Delete	Delete	Delete	Delete	Delete
Sizes	Small 30	Default 36	Large 44		
Icon · record	⚙️	⏸️	• Record	📤 Export video	

Specimens are drawn from the proposed tokens on the existing geometry (36 px controls, 8 px radius). Shown at 132 %.

MIDNIGHT

PROPOSED

Inputs and selection controls

DEFAULT

HOVER

FOCUS

ERROR

DISABLED

NUMERIC

DROPDOWN

Automatic

SEGMENTED

152430 FPS60

SLIDER

SWITCH

CHECKBOX

LABEL + VALUE

Frame rate
30 FPS

DROPDOWN OPEN

Automatic (best available)
NVIDIA NVENC
AMD AMF
Software (H.264)

Control outlines use border.control (≥ 3 : 1). Switch and slider fills use brand.primary.

ARCTIC

PROPOSED

DEFAULT

HOVER

FOCUS

ERROR

DISABLED

NUMERIC

DROPDOWN

Automatic

SEGMENTED

152430 FPS60

SLIDER

SWITCH

CHECKBOX

LABEL + VALUE

Frame rate
30 FPS

DROPDOWN OPEN

Automatic (best available)
NVIDIA NVENC
AMD AMF
Software (H.264)

Specimens are drawn from the proposed tokens on the existing geometry (36 px controls, 8 px radius). Shown at 132 %.

MIDNIGHT

Sidebar and title bar

● PROPOSED

SIDEBAR

CAPTURE

Home

Capture

Smart Tracking

Webcam

Annotations

MEDIA

Recordings

REAL APP (EXISTING)

CAPTURE

Home

Capture

Smart Tracking

Webcam

Annotations

Effects

Audio

TITLE BAR

Cap-IT / Smart Tracking

● Ready

● Record

Active item: selected wash + 3 px accent bar + accent icon — three cues, not colour alone.

ARCTIC

● PROPOSED

SIDEBAR

CAPTURE

Home

Capture

Smart Tracking

Webcam

Annotations

MEDIA

Recordings

REAL APP (EXISTING)

CAPTURE

Home

Capture

Smart Tracking

Webcam

Annotations

Effects

Audio

TITLE BAR

Cap-IT / Smart Tracking

● Ready

● Record

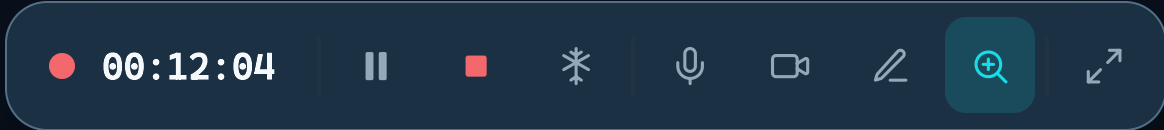
Specimens are drawn from the proposed tokens on the existing geometry (36 px controls, 8 px radius). Shown at 132 %.

MIDNIGHT

• PROPOSED

Recording controls, status, meters

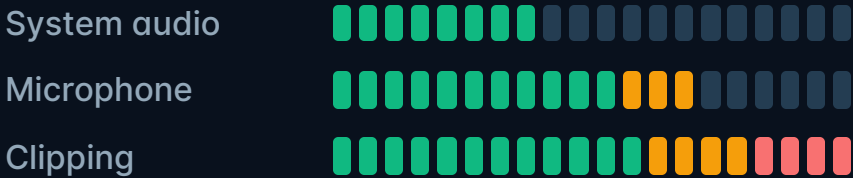
FLOATING RECORDING CONTROLLER · NEVER APPEARS IN THE RECORDING



STATUS — ICON + LABEL, NEVER COLOUR ALONE



AUDIO LEVEL METERS

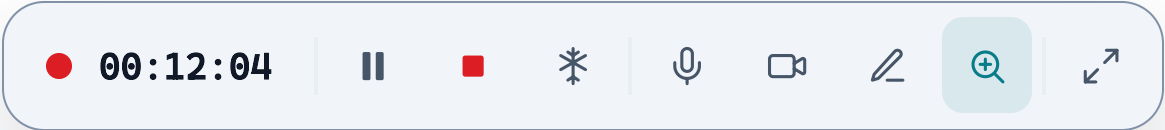


The controller follows the shipped layout (grip + timer · transport · live toggles · show app).

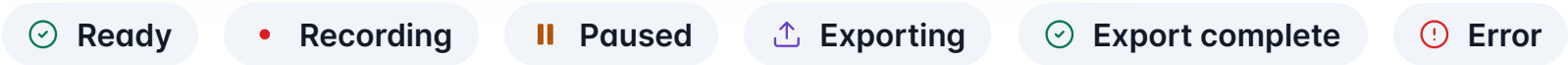
ARCTIC

• PROPOSED

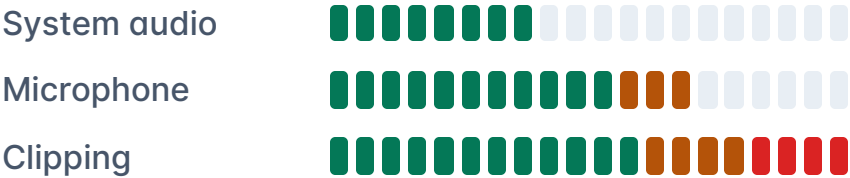
FLOATING RECORDING CONTROLLER · NEVER APPEARS IN THE RECORDING



STATUS — ICON + LABEL, NEVER COLOUR ALONE



AUDIO LEVEL METERS



Specimens are drawn from the proposed tokens on the existing geometry (36 px controls, 8 px radius). Shown at 132 %.

MIDNIGHT

Cards, overlays, notifications

• PROPOSED

SOURCE SELECTION CARDS



Display 1
1920×1080 · Primary



Window
One app, wherever it is

TOOLTIP

Freeze the screen image

CONTEXT MENU

Open recording
Show in folder
Delete

DIALOG

Delete this recording?

The video and its edits are moved to the Recycle Bin.

Cancel Delete

NOTIFICATIONS

✓ Export complete · Open folder

⚠ Hardware export failed — try Software (H.264)

i Original recording preserved · edits save automatically

ARCTIC

• PROPOSED

SOURCE SELECTION CARDS



Display 1
1920×1080 · Primary



Window
One app, wherever it is

TOOLTIP

Freeze the screen image

CONTEXT MENU

Open recording
Show in folder
Delete

DIALOG

Delete this recording?

The video and its edits are moved to the Recycle Bin.

Cancel Delete

NOTIFICATIONS

✓ Export complete · Open folder

⚠ Hardware export failed — try Software (H.264)

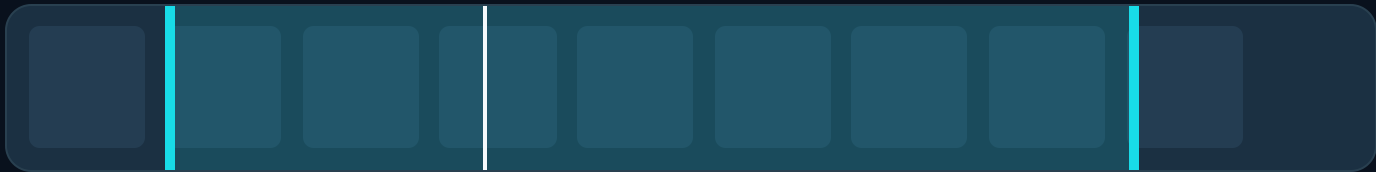
i Original recording preserved · edits save automatically

MIDNIGHT

PROPOSED

Timeline, progress, empty/loading/error

TIMELINE · TRIM HANDLES · PLAYHEAD



🔍 Zoom region at playhead

0.00

6.00

PROGRESS · EXPORT



LOADING · SKELETON



EMPTY

No recordings yet
Your first capture will appear here.

ERROR

Couldn't open this video
Check the file and try again.

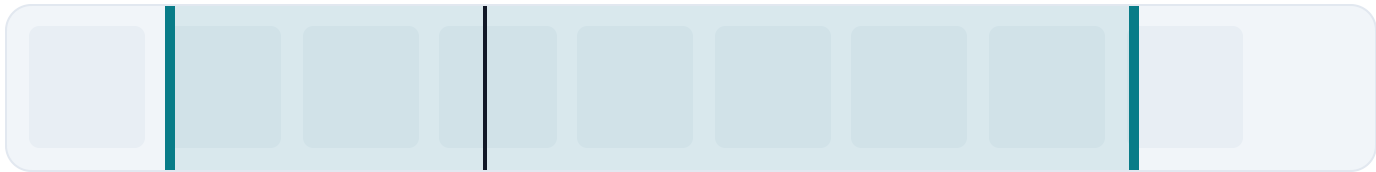
Try again

Skeletons shimmer only when motion is allowed; otherwise they are static.

ARCTIC

PROPOSED

TIMELINE · TRIM HANDLES · PLAYHEAD

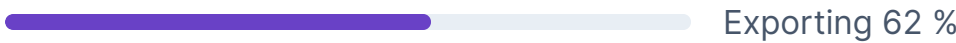


🔍 Zoom region at playhead

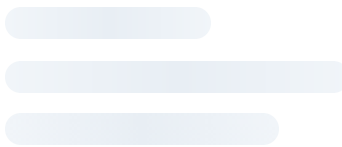
0.00

6.00

PROGRESS · EXPORT



LOADING · SKELETON



EMPTY

No recordings yet
Your first capture will appear here.

ERROR

Couldn't open this video
Check the file and try again.

Try again

Specimens are drawn from the proposed tokens on the existing geometry (36 px controls, 8 px radius). Shown at 132 %.

FEATURE IDENTITY SYSTEM

Nine areas, one family.

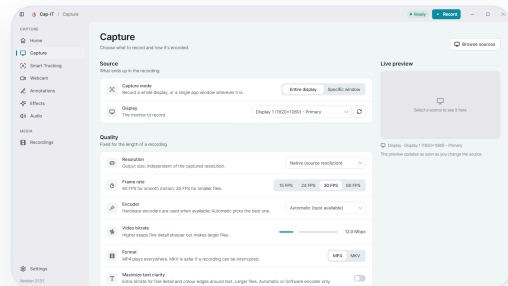
Each feature gets an icon (from the existing set), a colour for its icon chip, a one-sentence benefit and a line of its own microcopy. Feature colours are drawn from the logo's own hues plus brand cyan and violet; they tint chips and small markers only, and stay subordinate to the master brand.

● EXISTING

screens & names

● PROPOSED

colours & microcopy emphasis

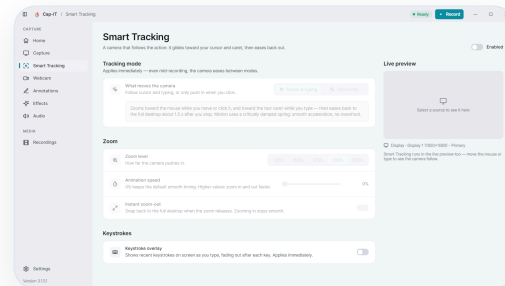


Capture

Pick exactly what gets recorded — a display or a single window.

“Choose source”

● #18DCE8 · ● #087F8C

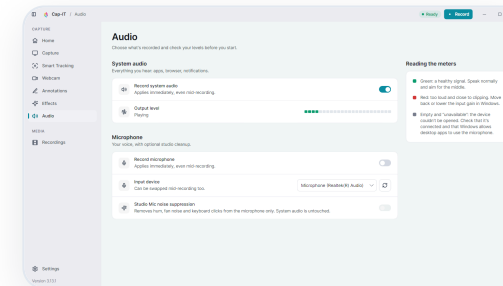


Smart Tracking

A camera that follows your cursor and caret, then eases back out.

“A camera that follows the action”

● #7C5CFF · ● #6941C6

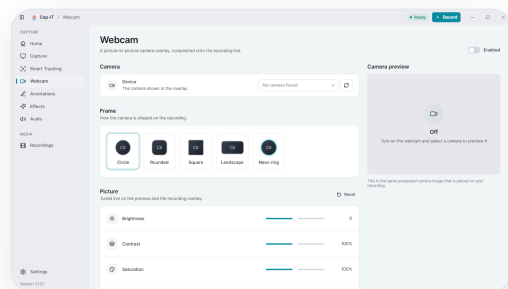


Audio

See system and microphone levels before you press record.

“System audio · Microphone”

● #85C536 · ● #4E7F0C

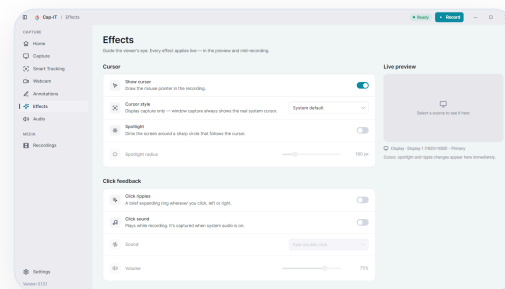


Webcam

Put yourself in the frame with a picture-in-picture template.

“Picture-in-picture”

● #EA0B7F · ● #C4046A

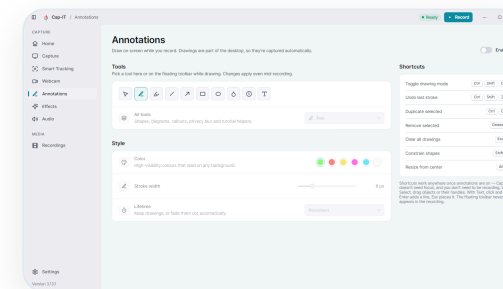


Effects

Spotlight, click ripples and click sounds that make actions readable.

“Make every click visible”

● #FFAA21 · ● #A15F00

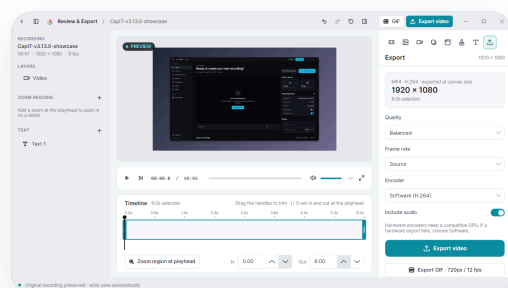


Annotations

Draw over your desktop while you record.

“Draw while you record”

● #6AA8FF · ● #2567D6

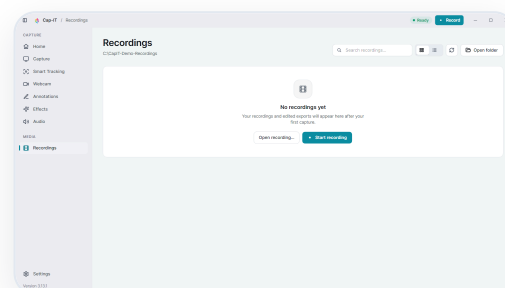


Review & Export

Trim, compose and deliver an MP4 or GIF without leaving the app.

“Original recording preserved”

● #18DCE8 · ● #087F8C

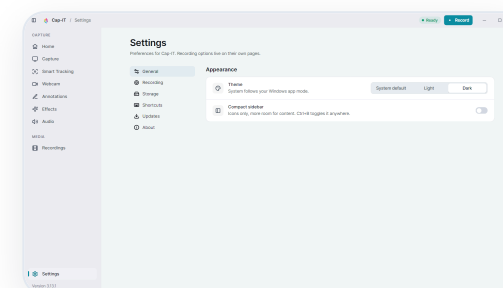


Recordings

Find any recording by name, date or thumbnail.

“Search recordings”

● #93A8B9 · ● #475569



Settings

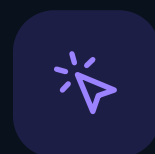
Preferences, theme and update behaviour.

“Settings”

● #93A8B9 · ● #475569

SIGNATURE FEATURE • EXISTING

A camera that follows the action.



01

Interaction

You move, click or type.



02

Focus

The camera picks the cursor — or the text caret while you type.



03

Smooth reframing

A critically damped spring eases in, pans and eases back out — no overshoot.

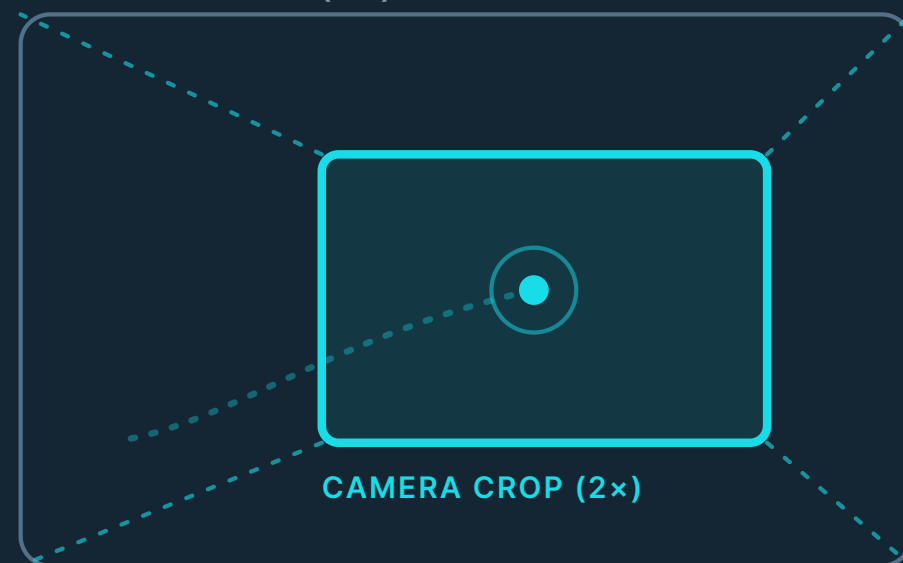


04

Clear communication

The viewer sees exactly what you are talking about.

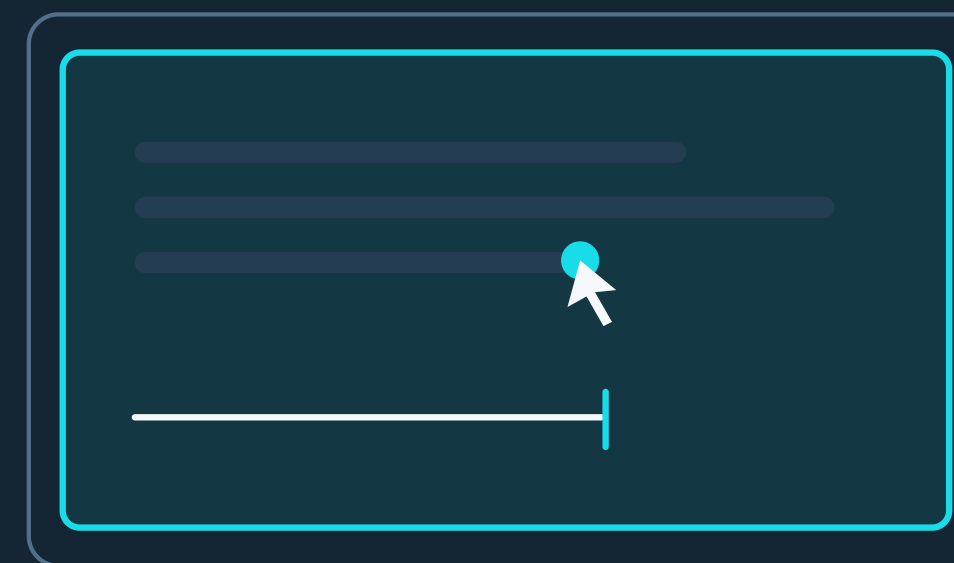
FULL DESKTOP (1×)



CAMERA CROP (2×)

cursor / text caret

WHAT THE VIDEO SHOWS



follows, eases in, eases back out

SMART TRACKING IN THE PRODUCT

EXISTING

Behaviour you can describe in one breath.

Zoom levels	125 · 150 · 175 · 200 · 300 %
Triggers	Cursor movement, clicks and typing — or clicks only
Zoom in	0.50 s smooth time
Zoom out	0.75 s · or instant
Pan	0.32 s smooth time
Release	1.5 s idle · 2.5 s after a click
Dead zone	12 % of the crop before the camera re-aims
Speed	0–50 % faster, live, even mid-recording

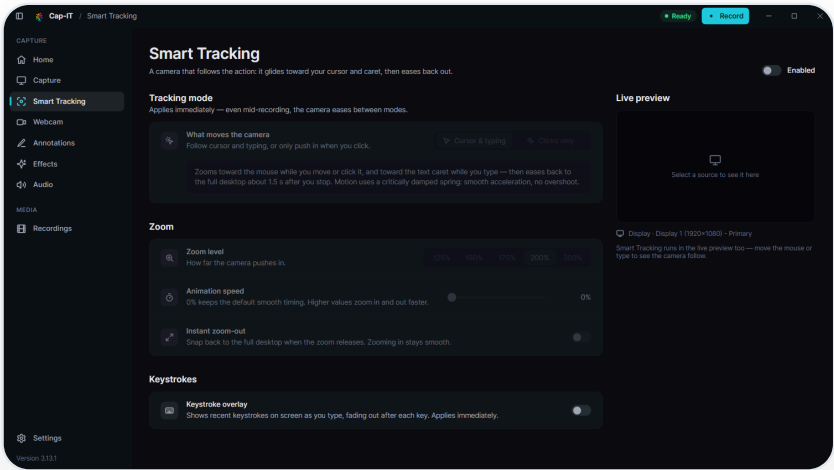
From VideoCaptureService.cs and the Smart Tracking page. Camera motion is computed from real elapsed time, so it stays smooth when frames arrive unevenly.

What has and has not been verified

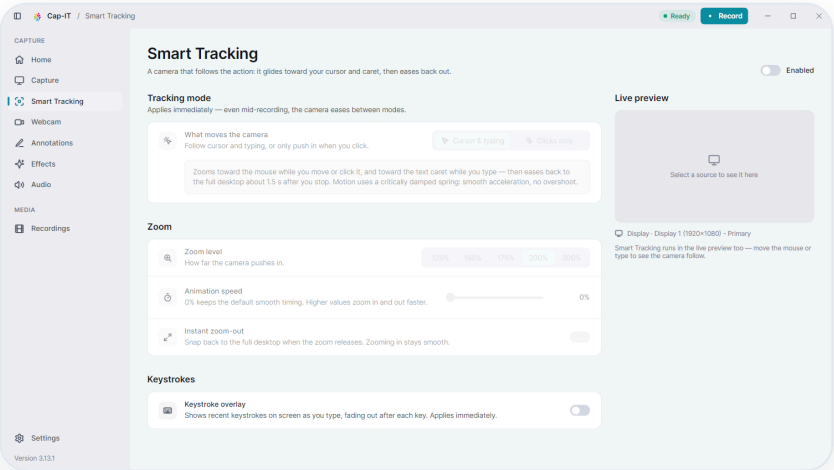
EXISTING

The recording-continuity work for Smart Tracking (timeline, tearing, encoder stalls) is documented in docs/SMART-TRACKING-RECORDING-FIX.md with measurements from one machine (AMD integrated GPU, 1080p). This book makes no performance claim beyond it. **Still open:** a literal “cut section” was not reproduced; the audio tail can end up to ~0.8 s short; text sharpness while zoomed is not measured; 1440p, 4K, NVENC and QSV are untested.

REAL SCREENS



Midnight



Arctic

Microcopy (existing)

- “A camera that follows the action: it glides toward your cursor and caret, then eases back out.”
- “Applies immediately – even mid-recording, the camera eases between modes.”
- “Motion uses a critically damped spring: smooth acceleration, no overshoot.”

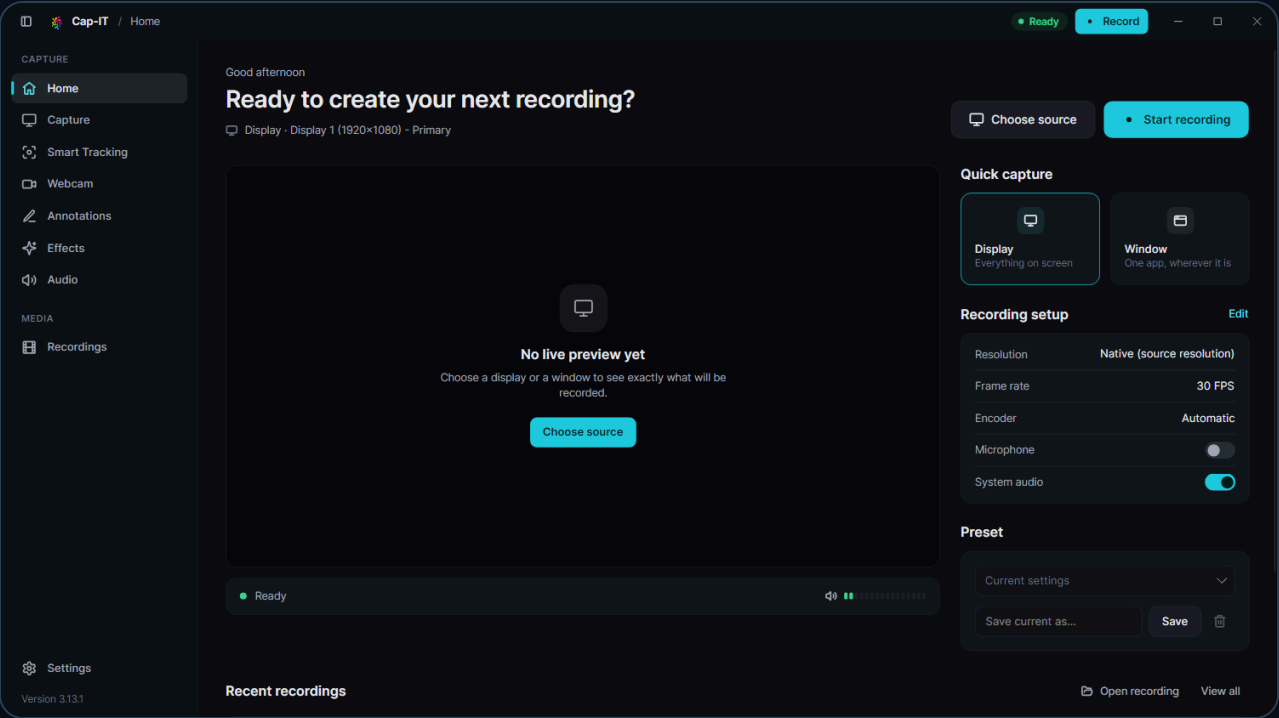
DARK | LIGHT

● EXISTING

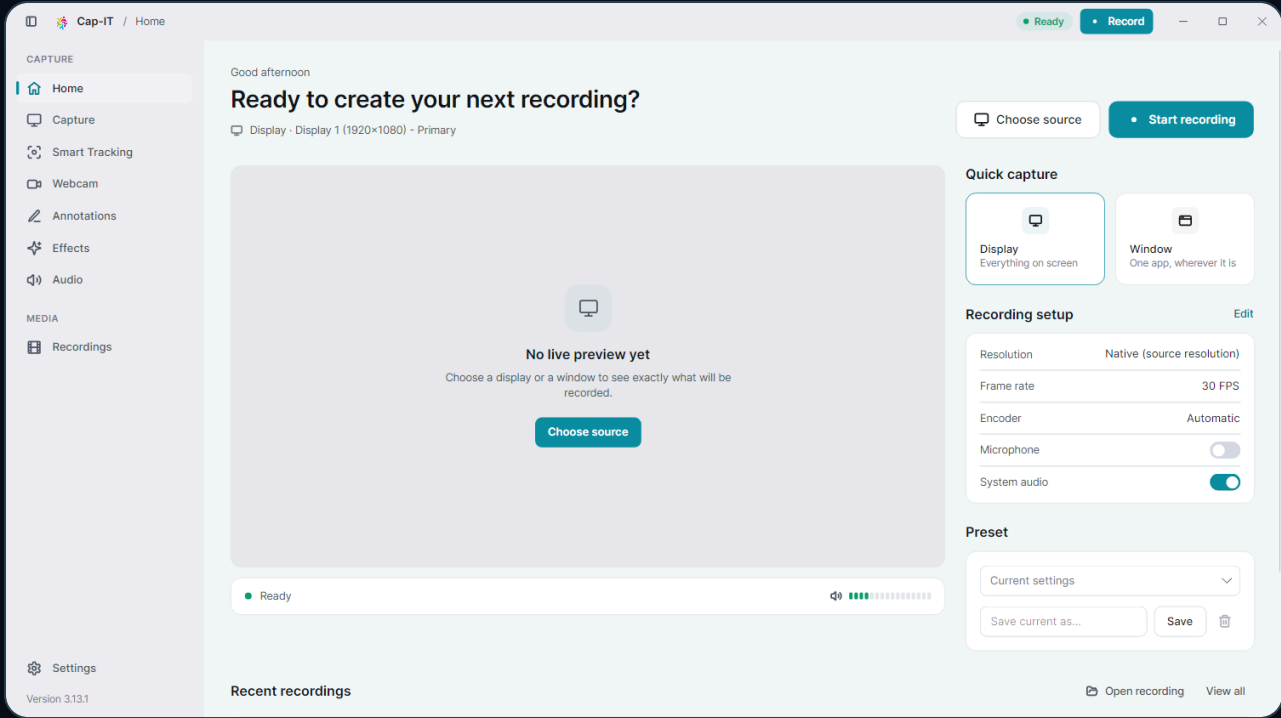
Rendered by the application's own snapshot harness (v3.13.1, 1500×840 / 1280×720) with a clean demo configuration.

Home

The dashboard: one obvious action, the source and the setup.



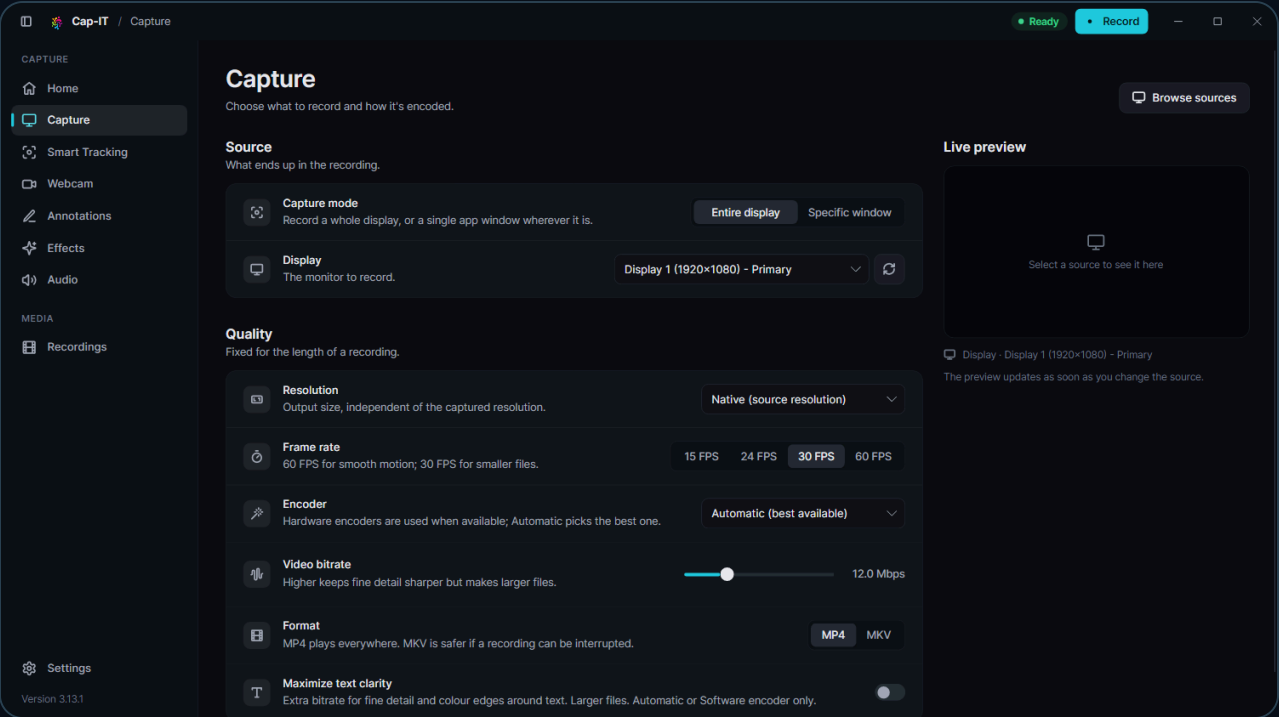
Midnight · real render



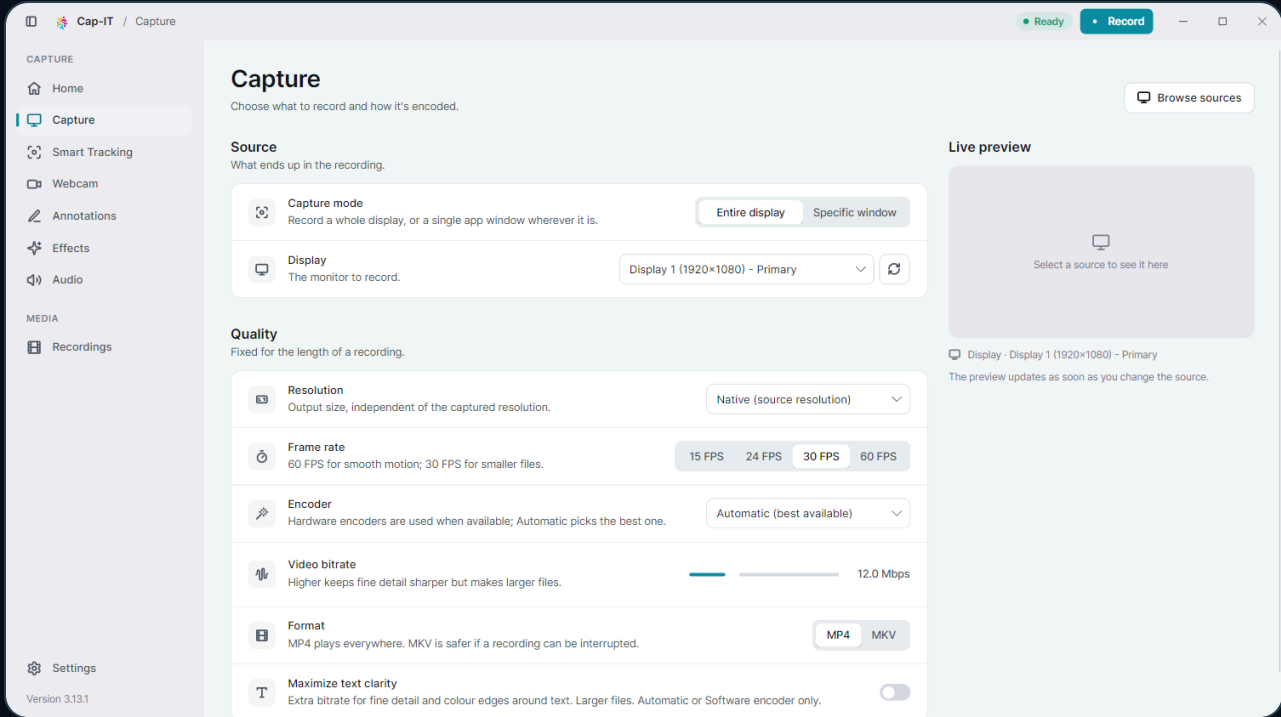
Arctic · real render

Capture

Source, quality, encoder and format.



Midnight · real render

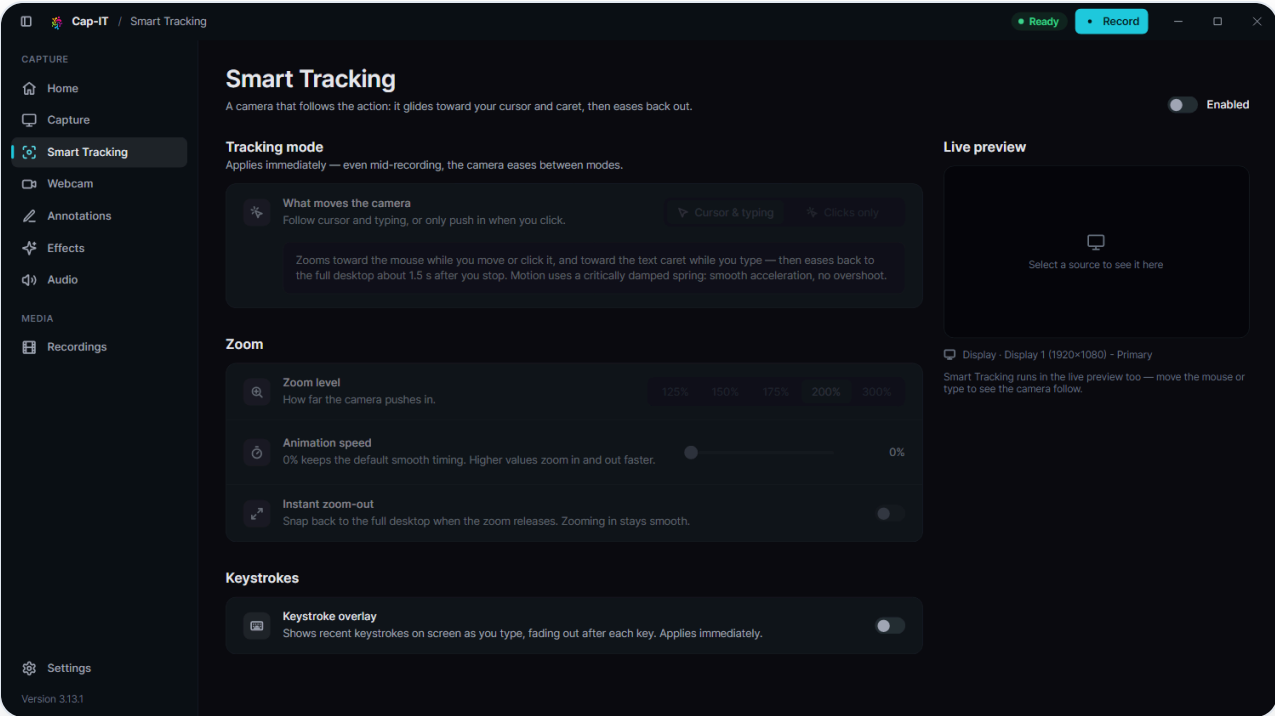


Arctic · real render

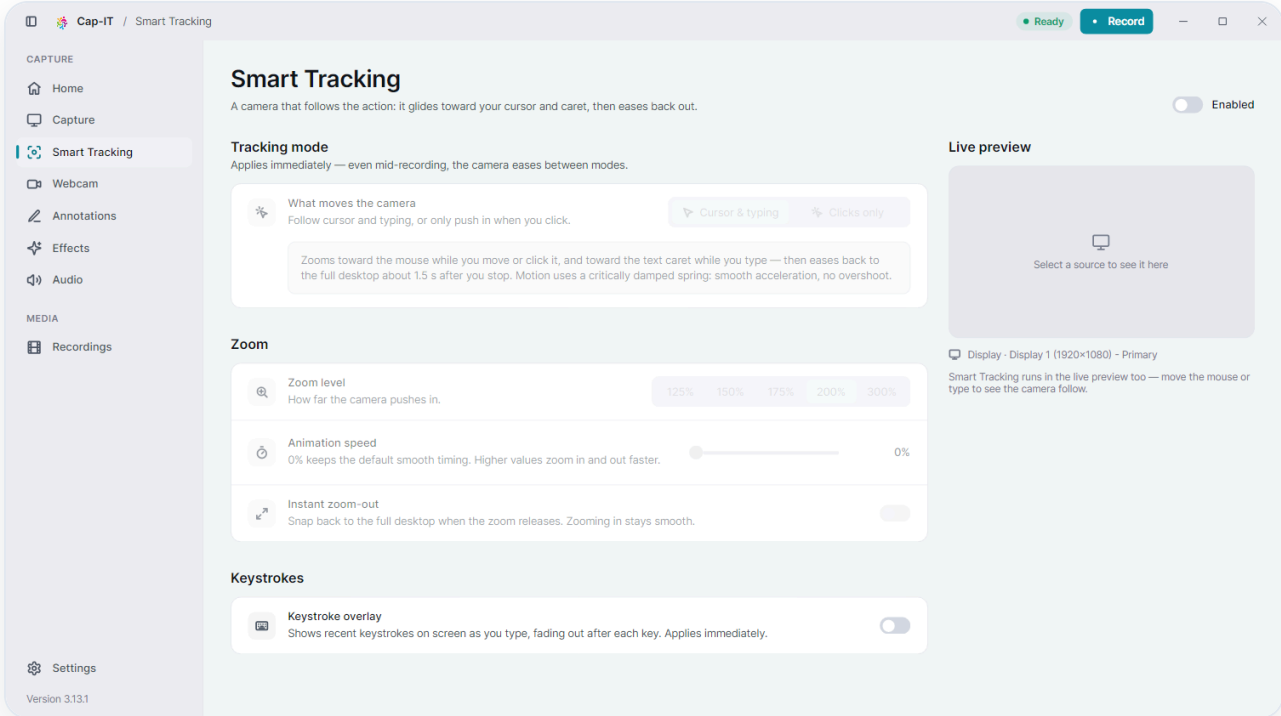
DARK | LIGHT **EXISTING** Rendered by the application’s own snapshot harness (v3.13.1, 1500×840 / 1280×720) with a clean demo configuration.

Smart Tracking

Mode, zoom level, speed, keystrokes.



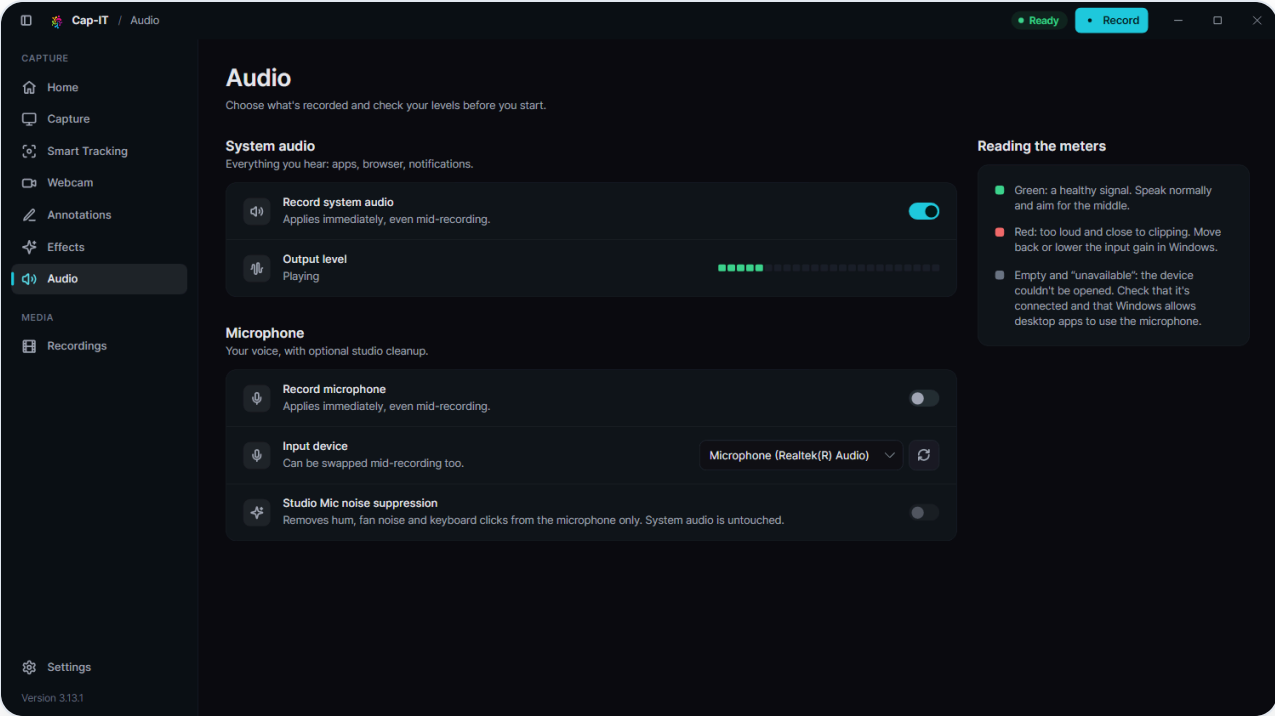
Midnight · real render



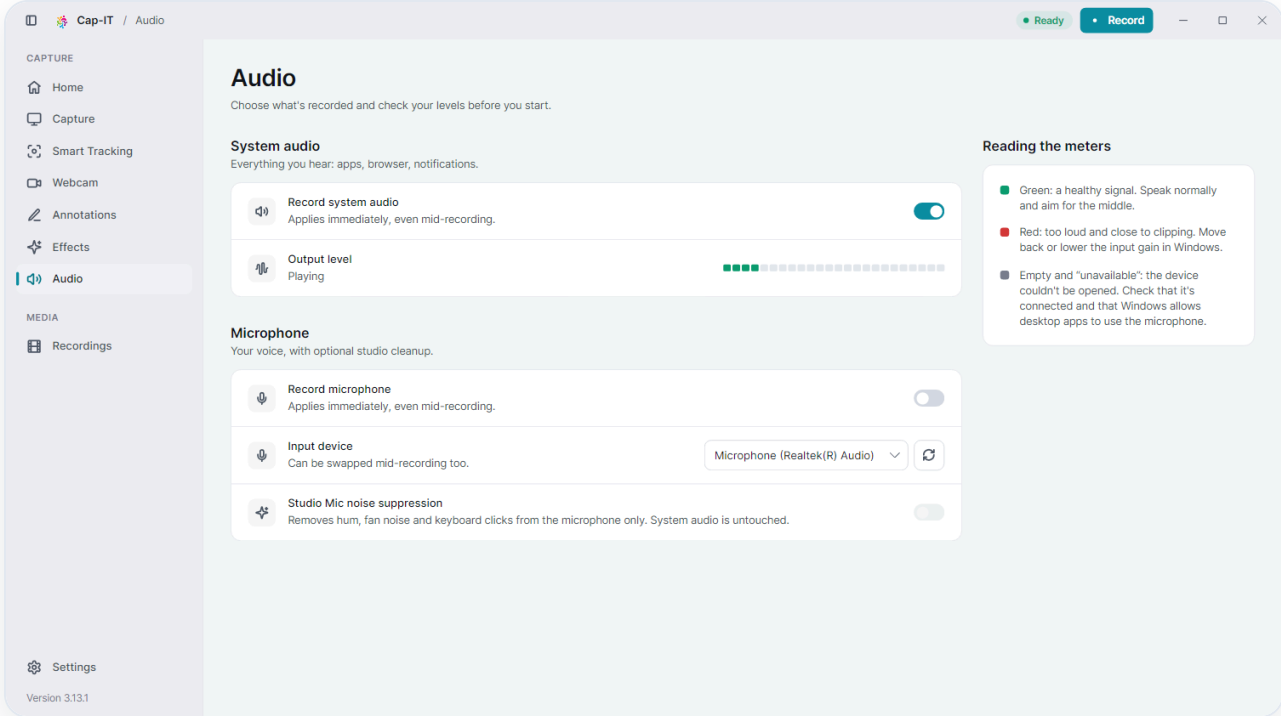
Arctic · real render

Audio

System audio and microphone with level meters.



Midnight · real render

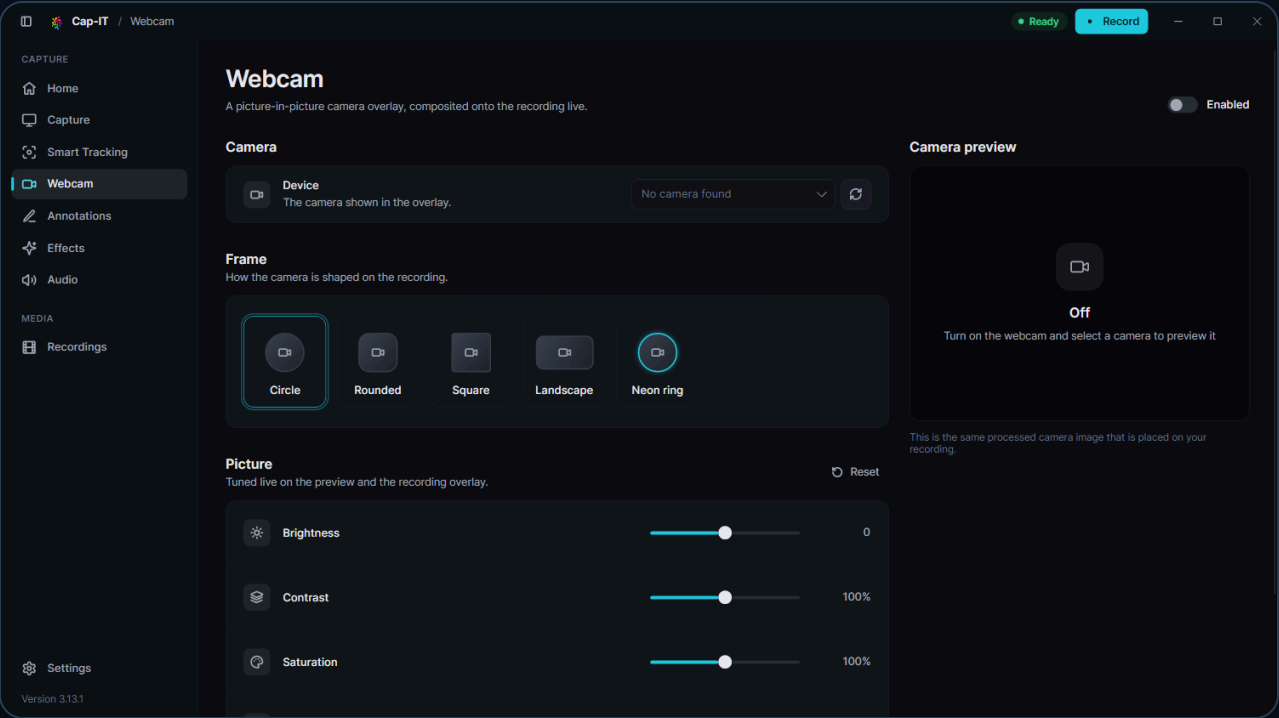


Arctic · real render

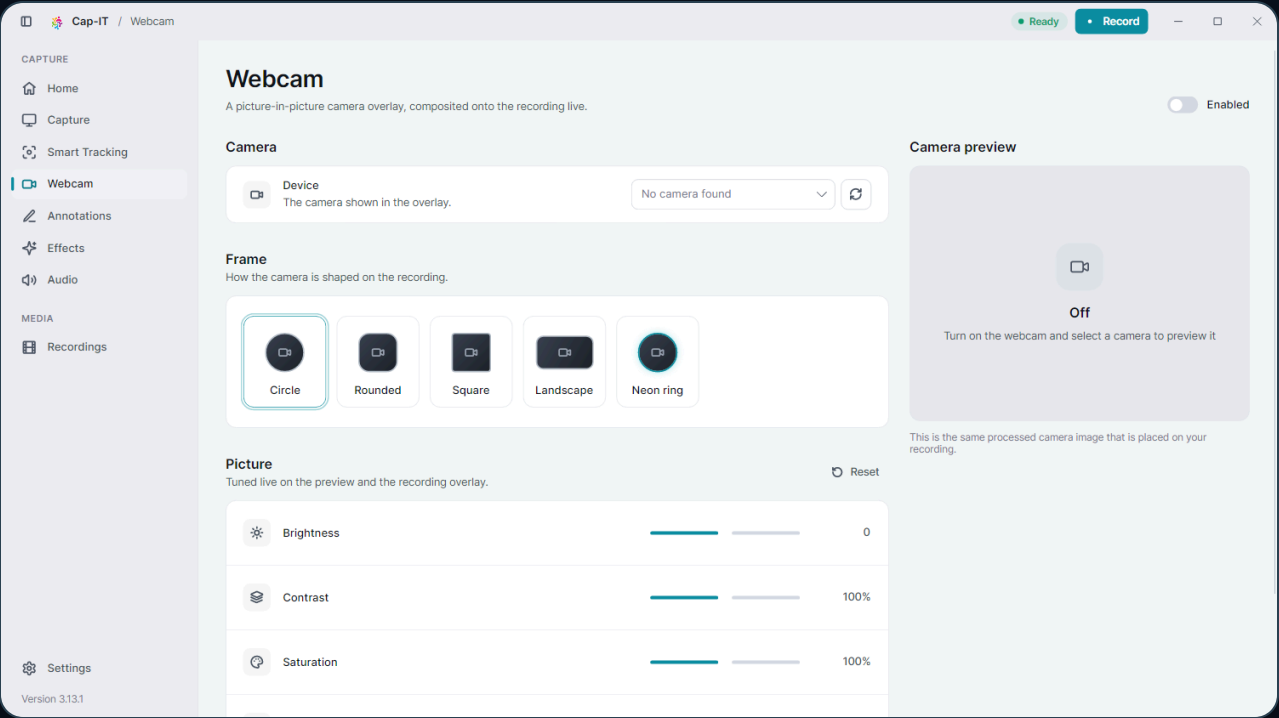
DARK | LIGHT **EXISTING** Rendered by the application’s own snapshot harness (v3.13.1, 1500×840 / 1280×720) with a clean demo configuration.

Webcam

Picture-in-picture templates and picture tuning.



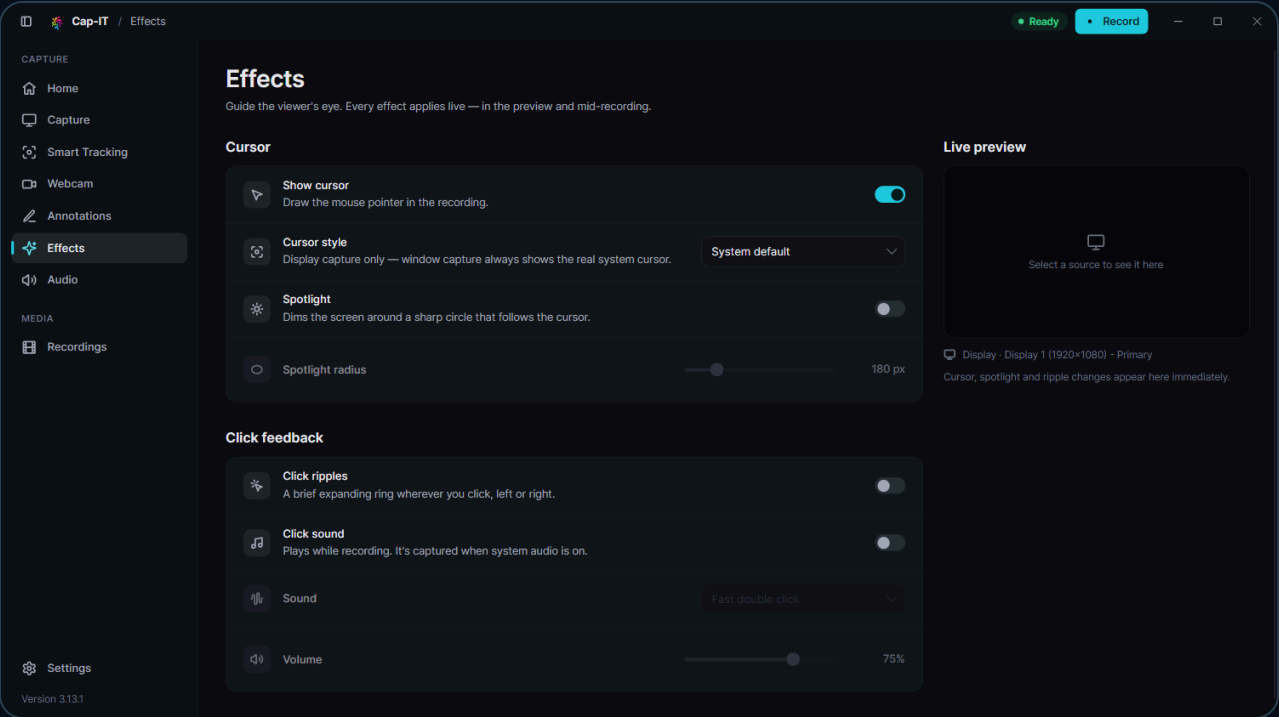
Midnight · real render



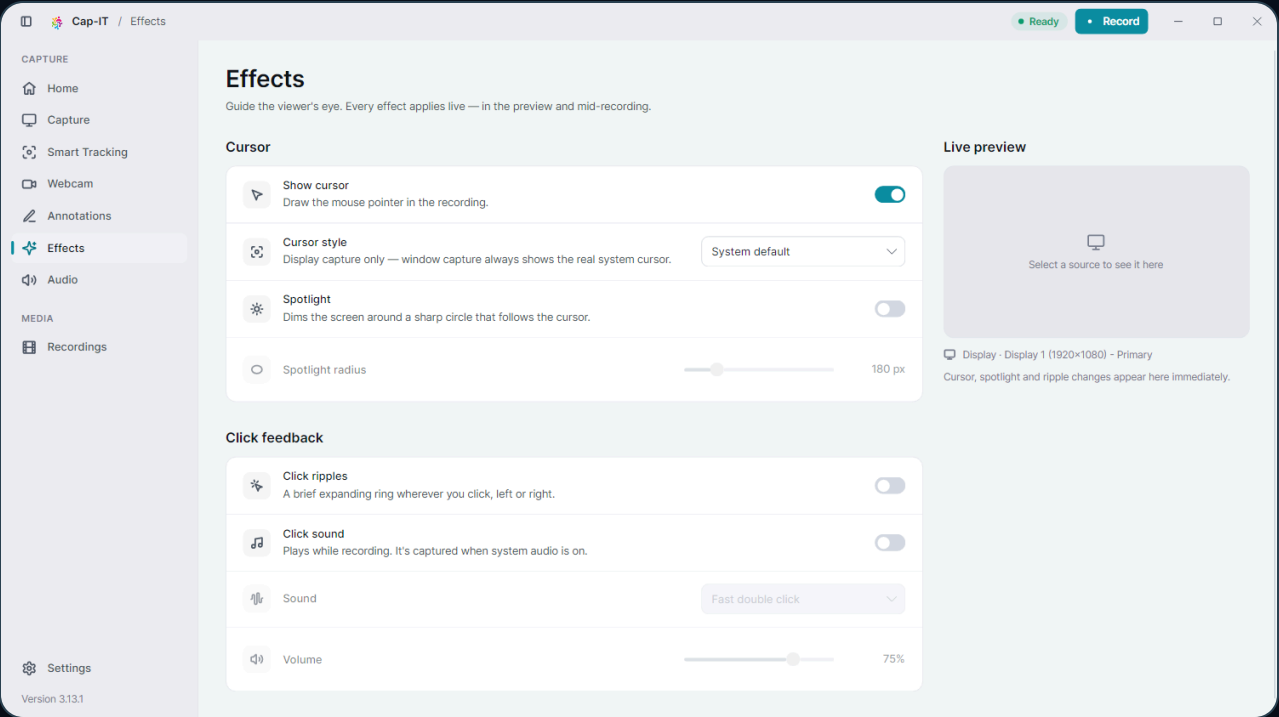
Arctic · real render

Effects

Spotlight, click ripples and click sounds.



Midnight · real render

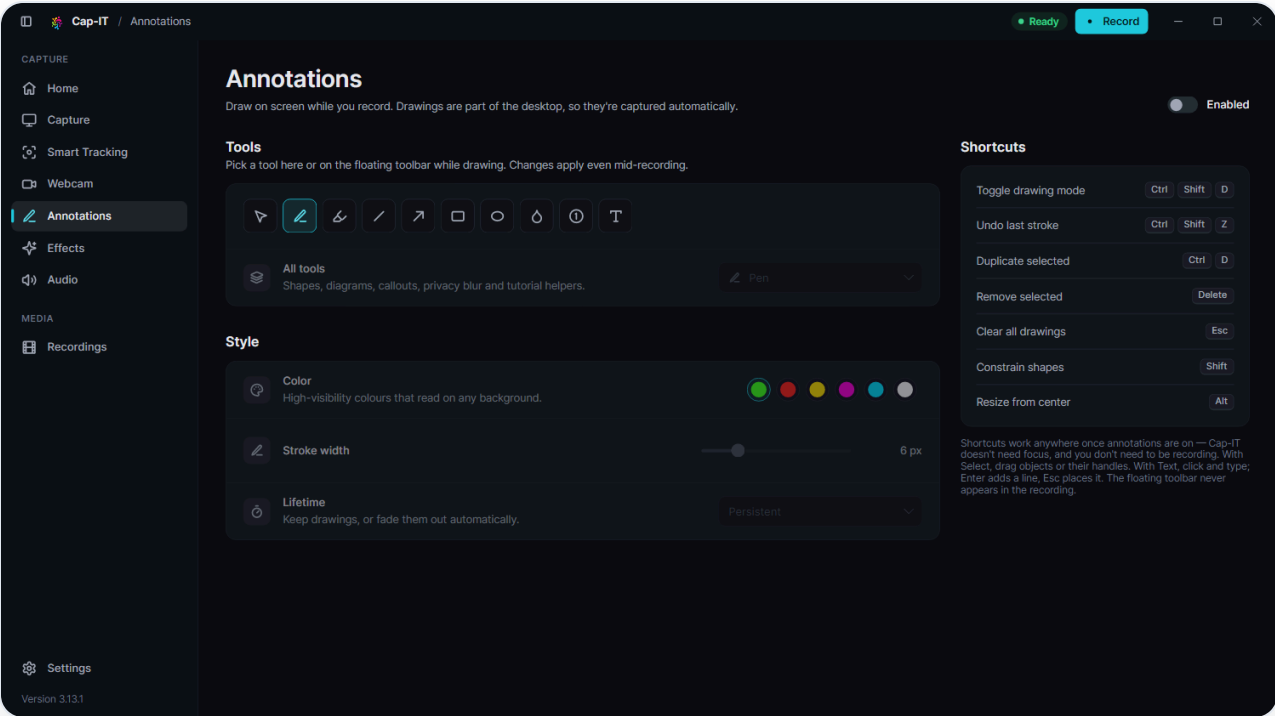


Arctic · real render

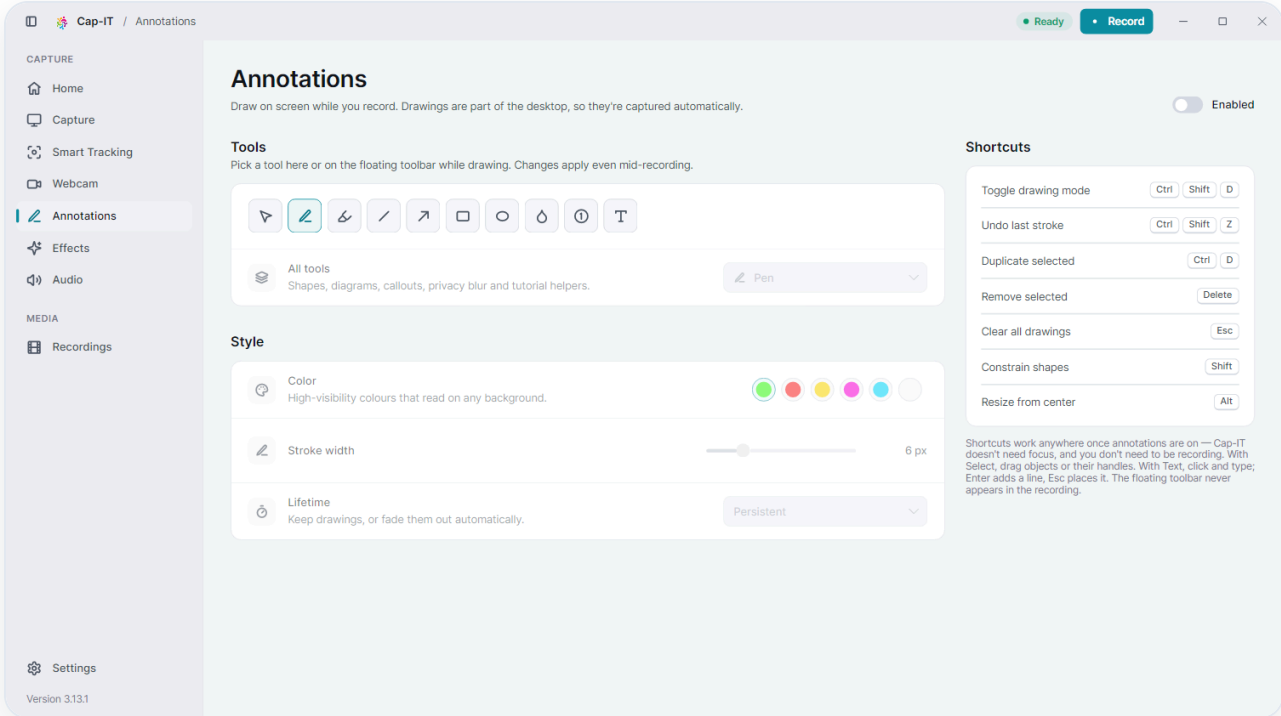
DARK | LIGHT | **EXISTING** Rendered by the application’s own snapshot harness (v3.13.1, 1500×840 / 1280×720) with a clean demo configuration.

Annotations

Tools, style and global shortcuts.



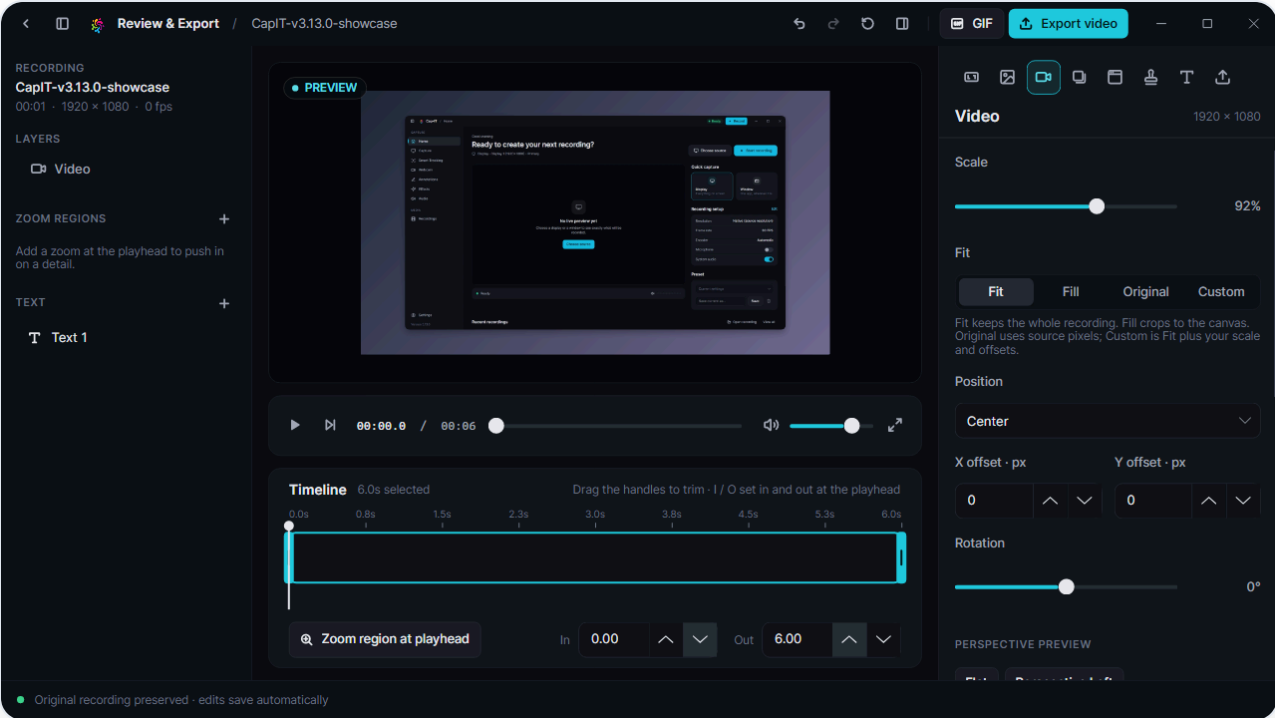
Midnight · real render



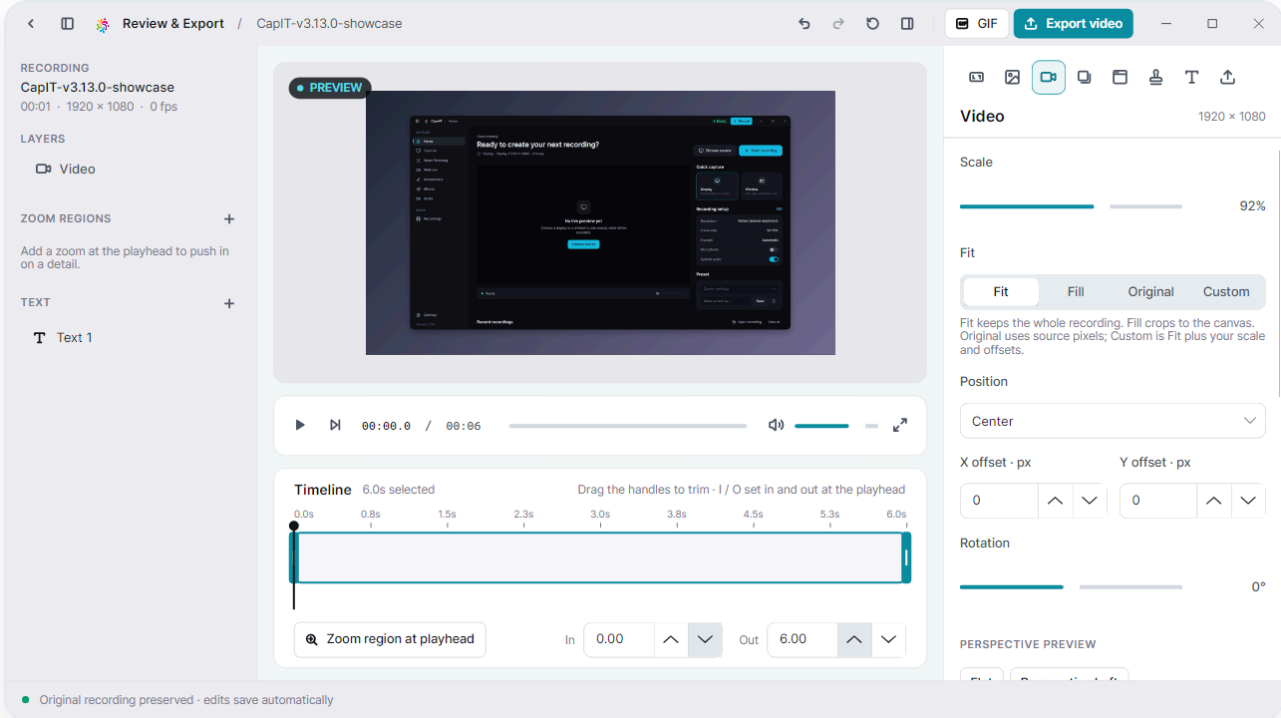
Arctic · real render

Review & Export

Preview, trim timeline, zoom regions, inspector.



Midnight · real render

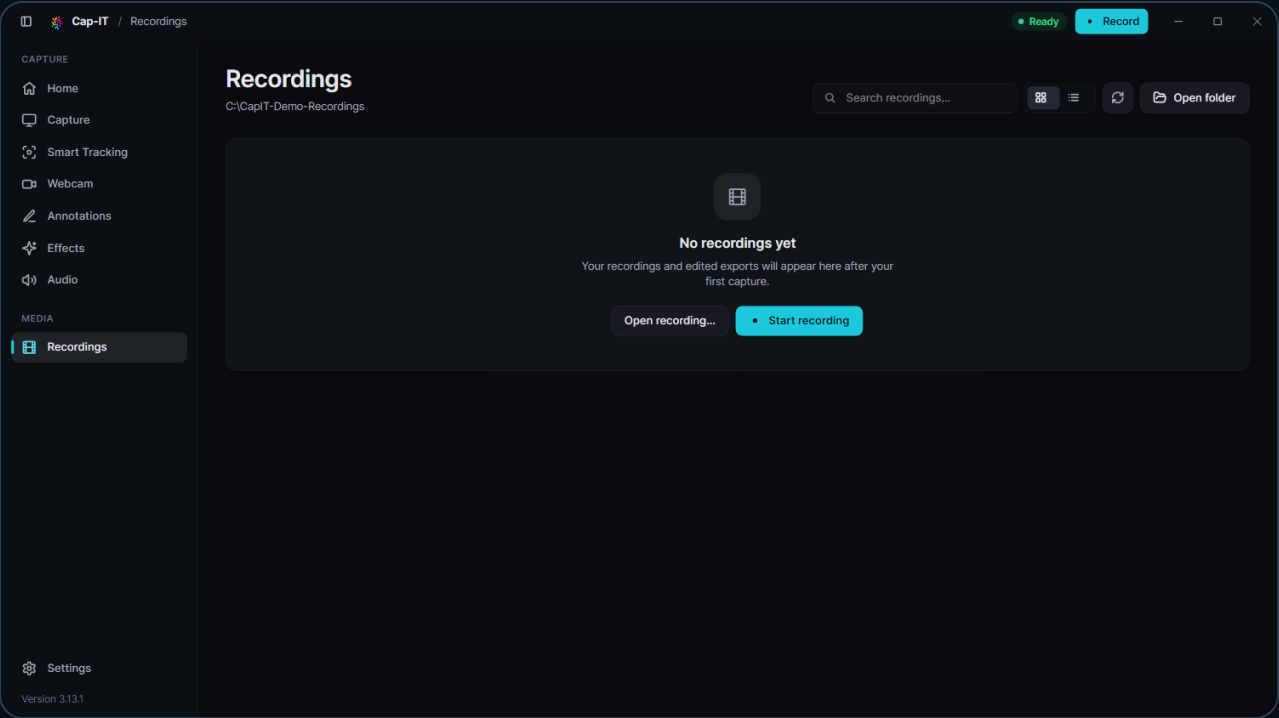


Arctic · real render

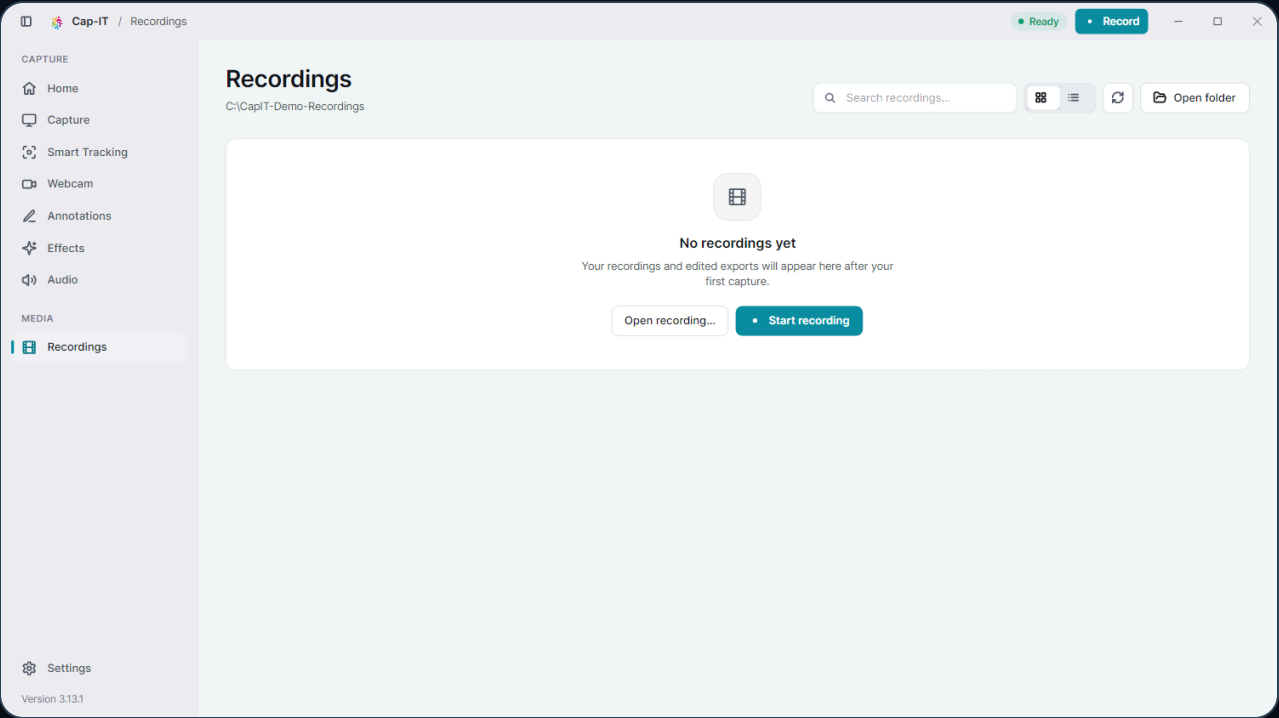
DARK | LIGHT **EXISTING** Rendered by the application’s own snapshot harness (v3.13.1, 1500×840 / 1280×720) with a clean demo configuration.

Recordings

Search, thumbnails, grid and list.



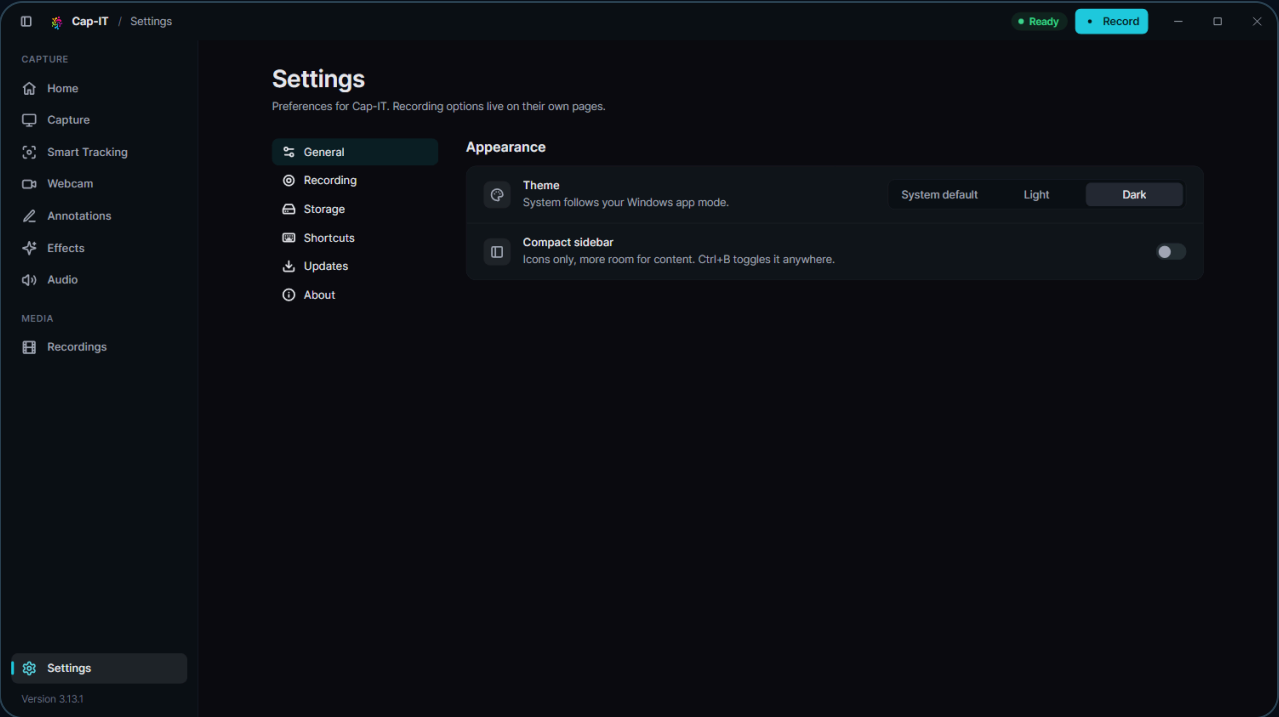
Midnight · real render



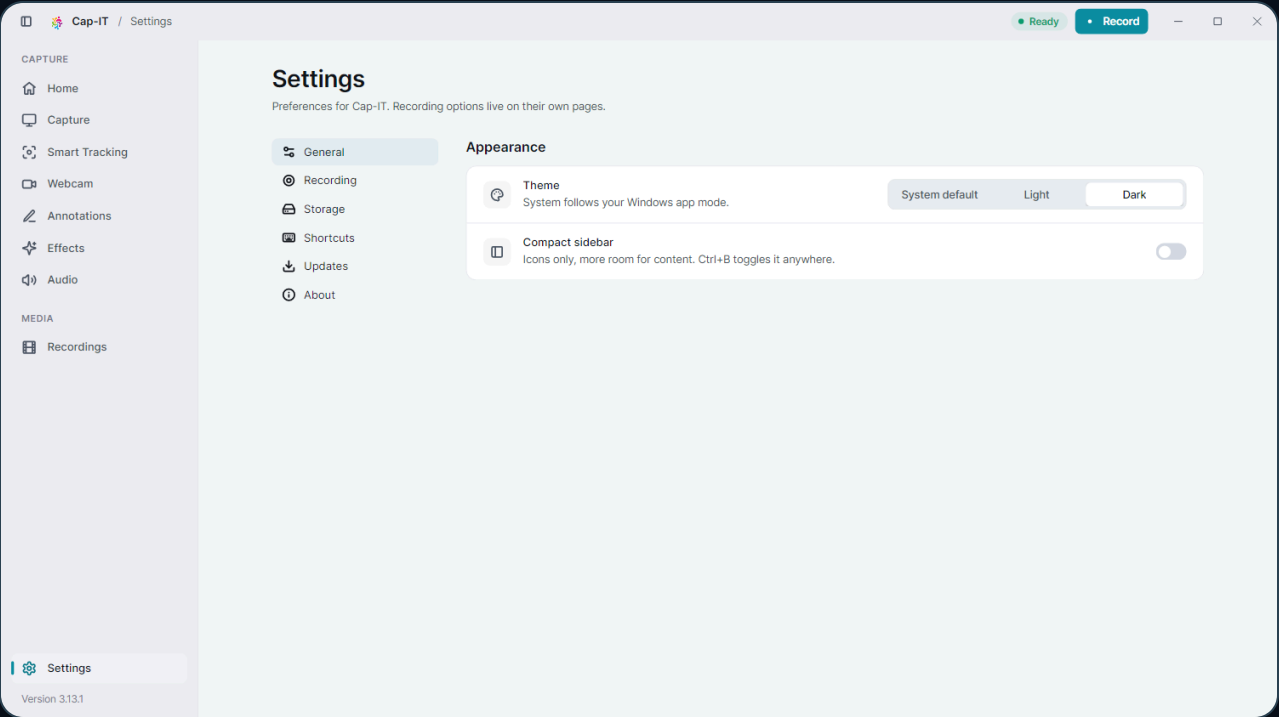
Arctic · real render

Settings

General, recording, storage, shortcuts, updates.



Midnight · real render

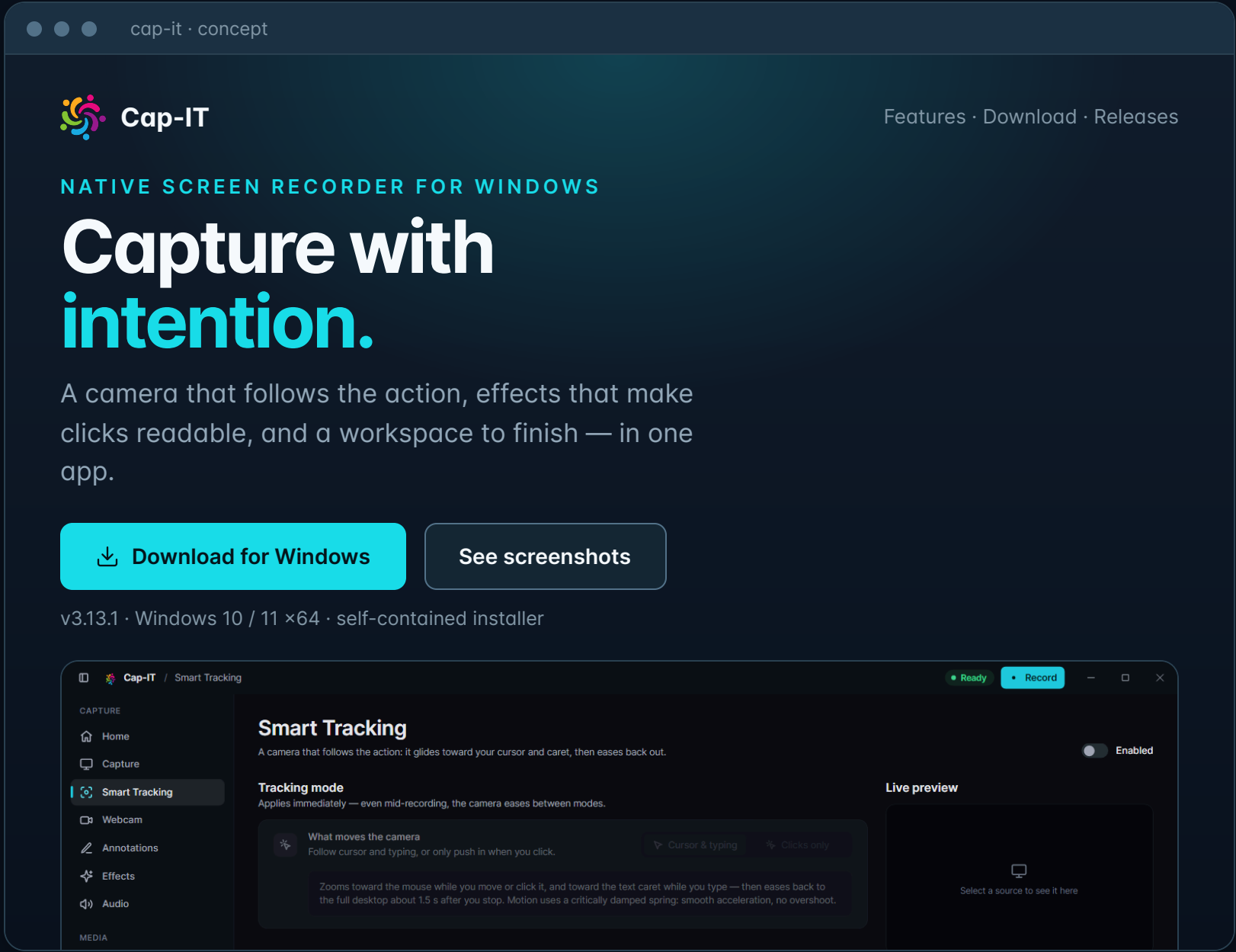


Arctic · real render

MIDNIGHT

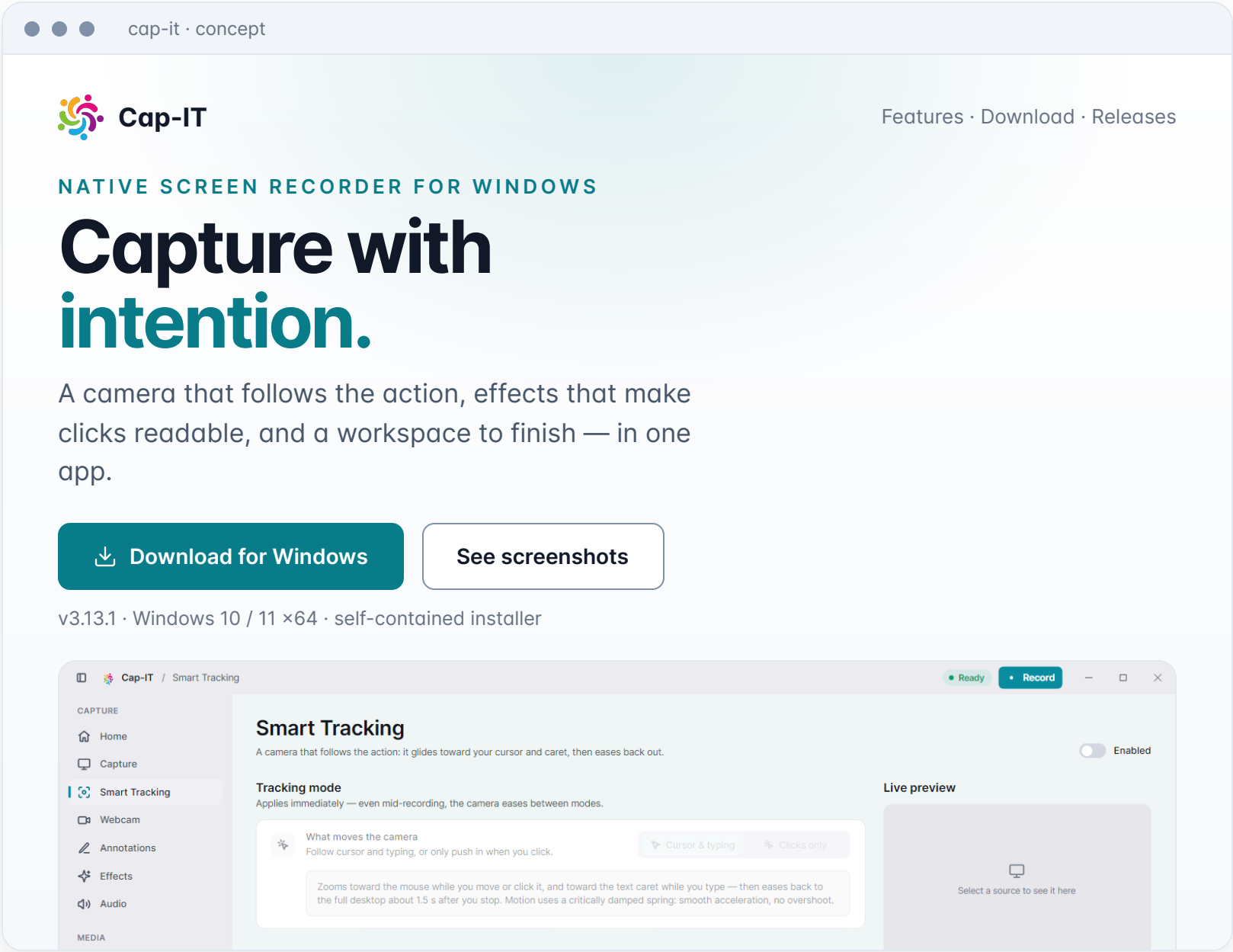
PROPOSED

Official website hero — concept



ARCTIC

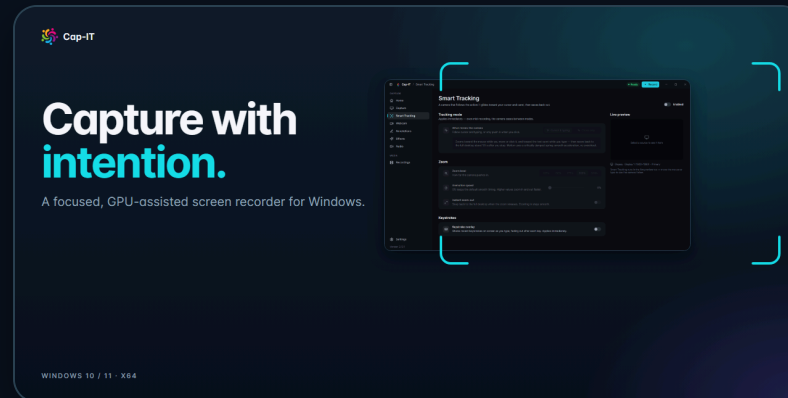
PROPOSED



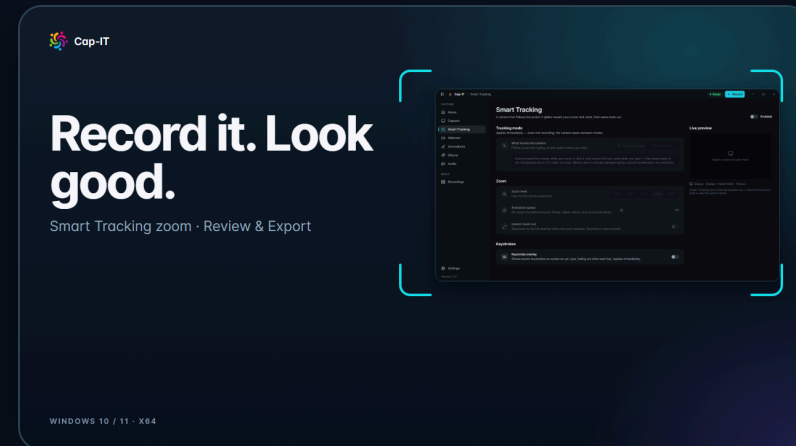
Concept composition from the proposed tokens and a real screenshot. No website exists in the repository.

MIDNIGHT

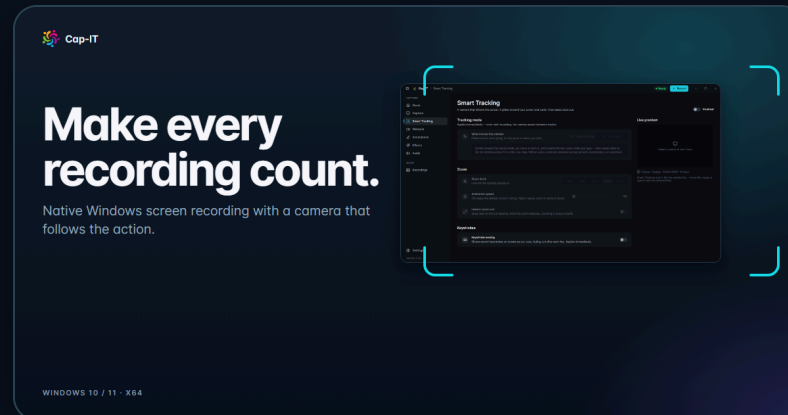
• CONCEPT



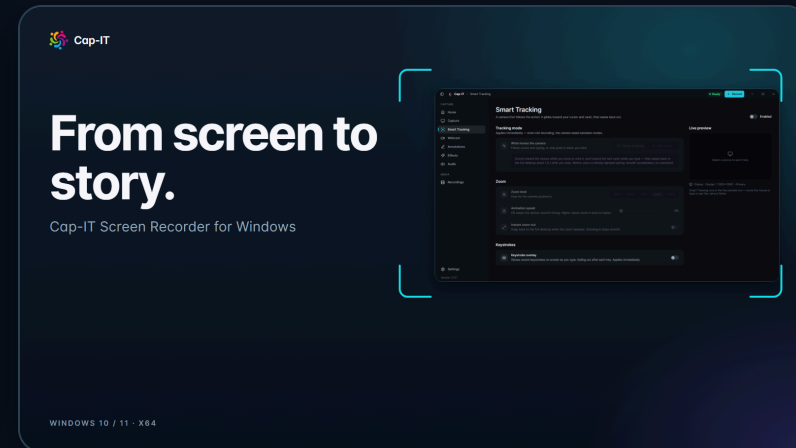
GitHub social preview · 1280 × 640



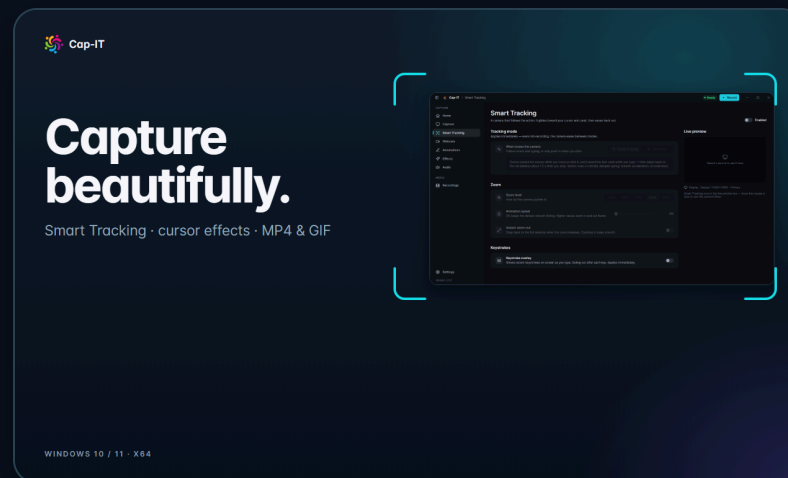
YouTube thumbnail · 1280 × 720



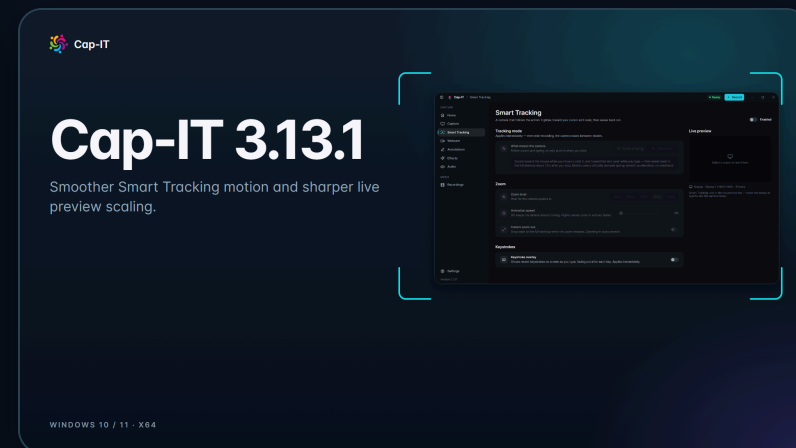
LinkedIn · 1200 × 627



X / Twitter · 1600 × 900



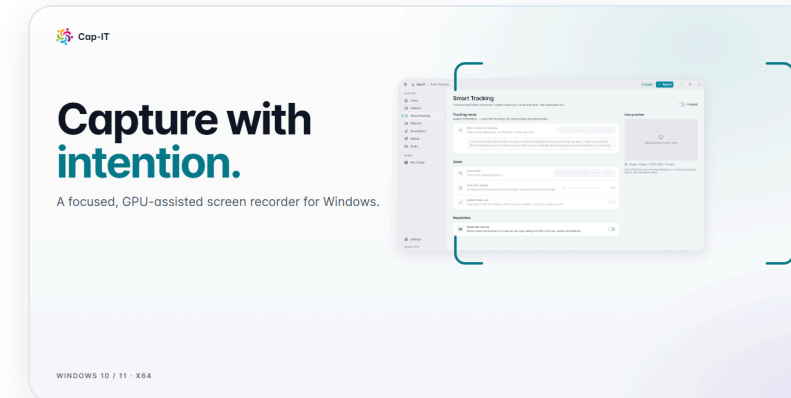
Product Hunt gallery · 1270 × 760



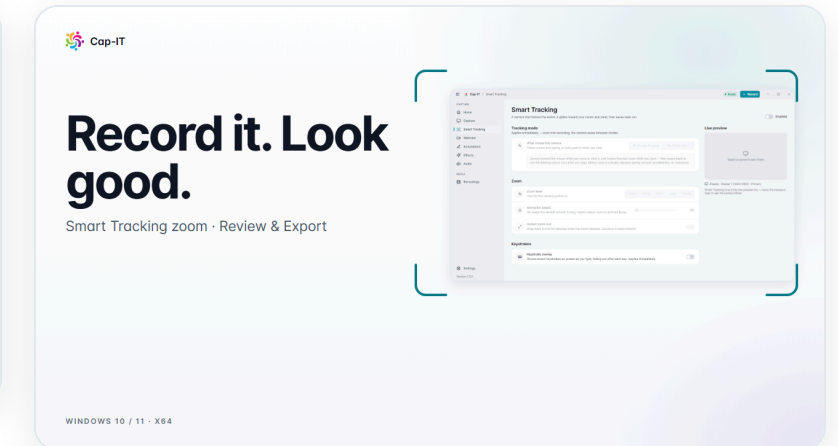
Release announcement · 1920 × 1080

ARCTIC

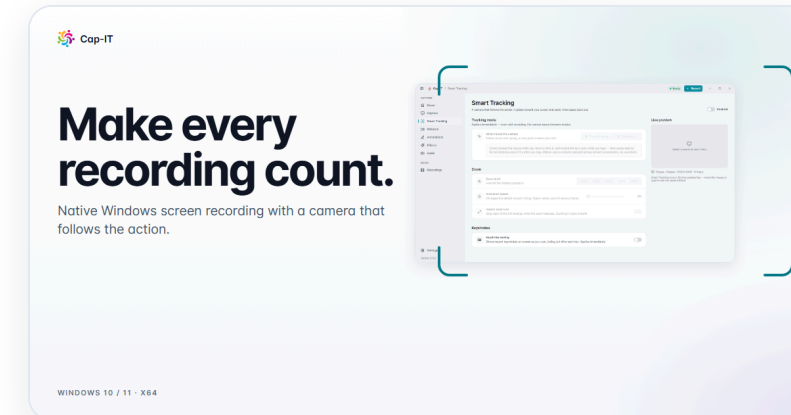
• CONCEPT



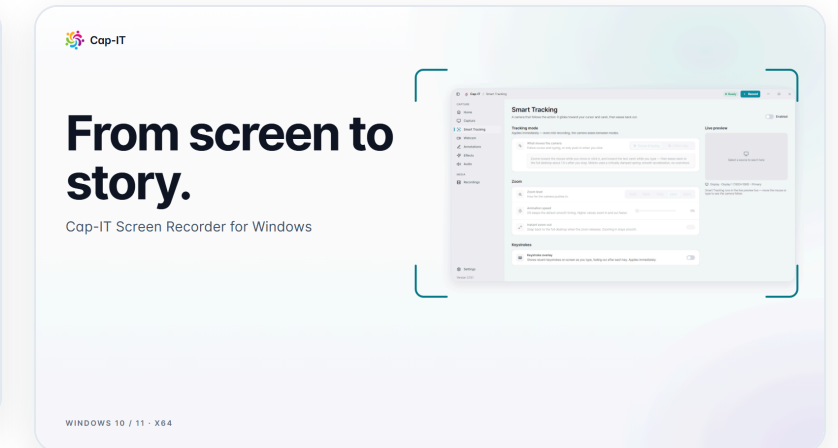
GitHub social preview · 1280 × 640



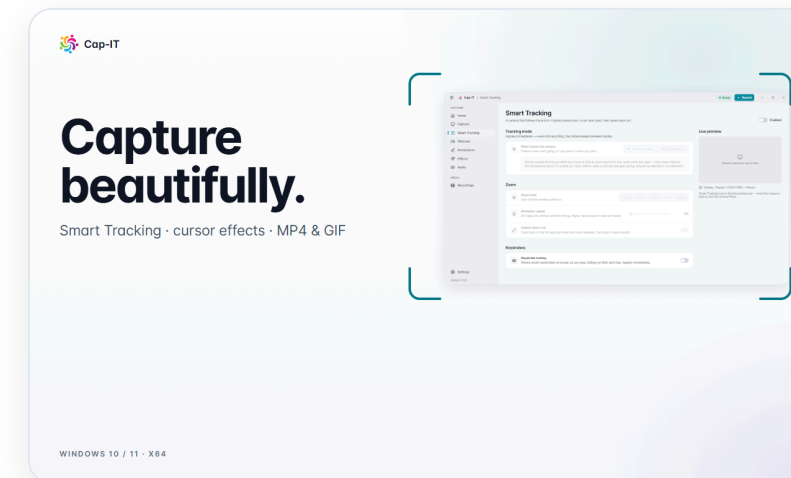
YouTube thumbnail · 1280 × 720



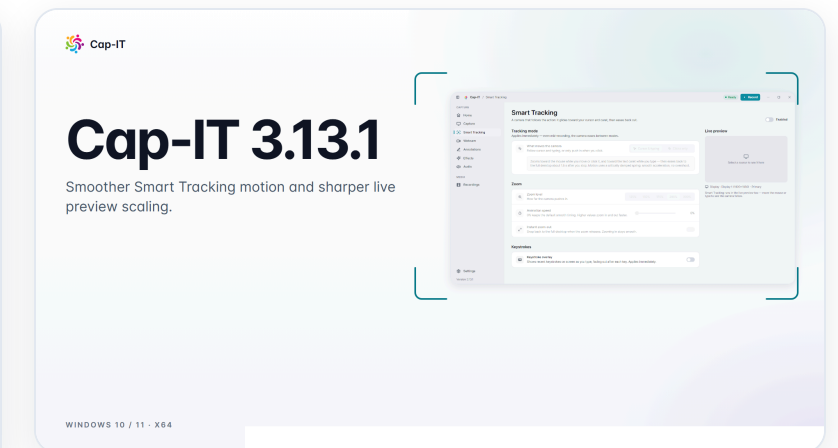
LinkedIn · 1200 × 627



X / Twitter · 1600 × 900



Product Hunt gallery · 1270 × 760



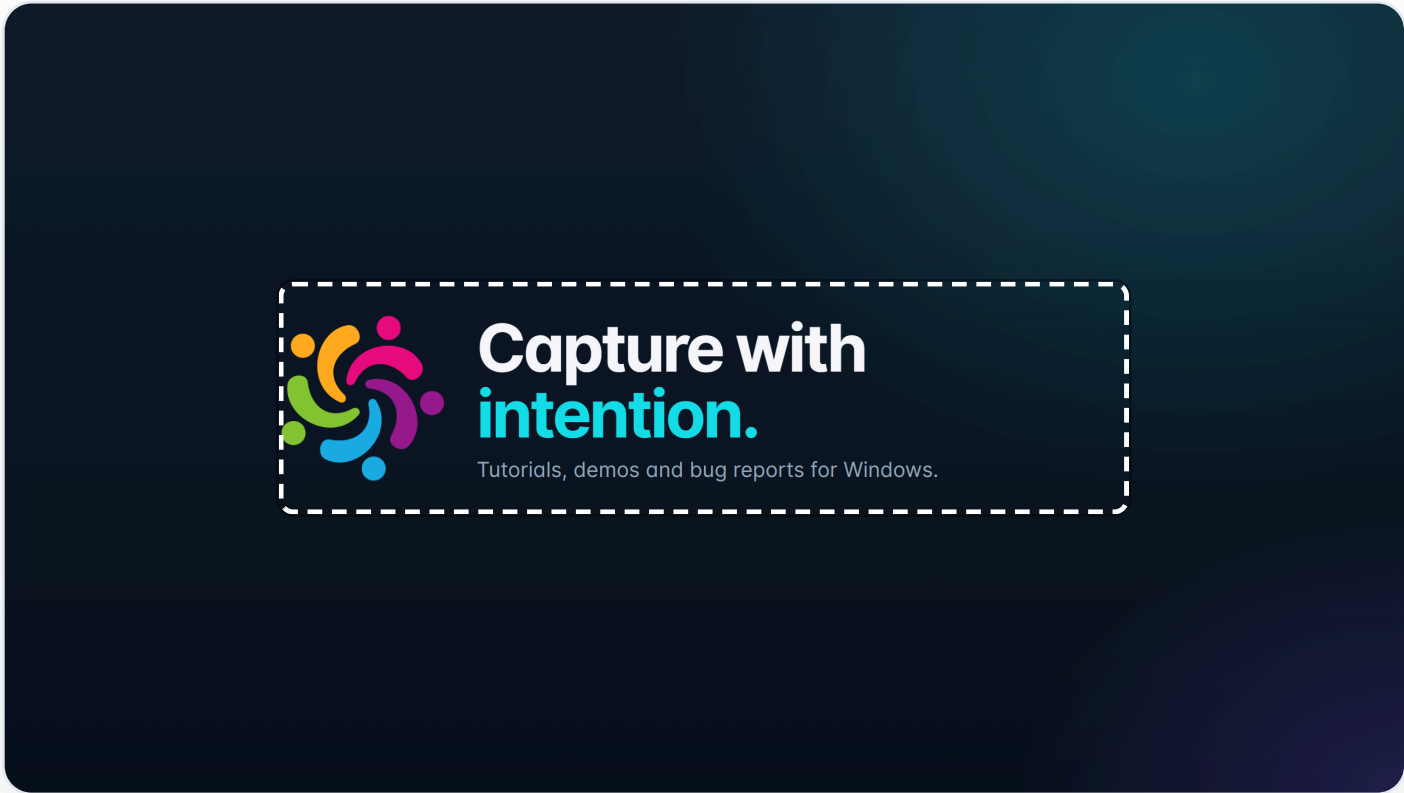
Release announcement · 1920 × 1080

PLATFORM SIZES & SAFE AREAS

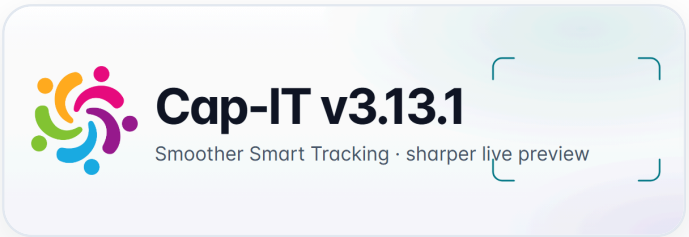
One system, many canvases.

ASSET	DIMENSIONS	RATIO	SAFE-AREA NOTE
GitHub social preview	1280 × 640	2 : 1	Keep 40 px margin; text left, product right
YouTube thumbnail	1280 × 720	16 : 9	Keep clear of the duration badge (bottom-right)
YouTube channel banner	2560 × 1440	16 : 9	Safe area 1546 × 423, centred — TV and desktop crop the rest
LinkedIn image	1200 × 627	1.91 : 1	Avoid text near the edges
X / Twitter image	1600 × 900	16 : 9	Edges may be cropped in feeds
Instagram portrait	1080 × 1350	4 : 5	Keep key content in the central 1080 × 1080
Product Hunt gallery	1270 × 760	1.67 : 1	First image is the thumbnail
Email header	1200 × 400 (shown 600 × 200)	3 : 1	Text as live HTML where possible; alt text always
Desktop wallpaper	3840 × 2160	16 : 9	Left third reserved for icons
Installer artwork	Inno Setup wizard images	—	Concept; the script uses only the icon today
Documentation cover	1920 × 1080	16 : 9	Same layout as the tutorial title card

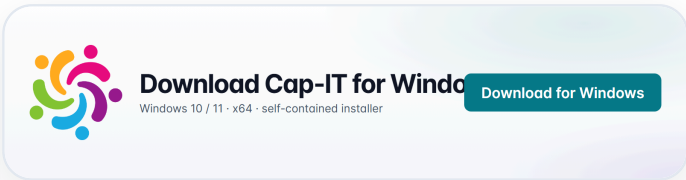
Dimensions are common platform guidance at the time of writing and change; confirm before publishing. Every size is a ready template in Cap-IT-Brand-Assets/templates/, in both themes.



YouTube banner with the 1546 × 423 safe area outlined.



Email header



Download banner

VOICE & TONE

A calm professional who respects your time.

Clear

Say the thing once, in the order it happens.

Confident

State what Cap-IT does. No hedging, no hype.

Helpful

Tell people what to do next.

Precise

Real numbers and real names; never “blazing fast”.

Modern

Plain, current language. No jargon for jargon’s sake.

Human

Written by a person for a person.

Professional

Warm, not chatty.

Preferred vs avoided, by moment

MOMENT	SAY	AVOID
Onboarding	Ready to create your next recording?	“Welcome to the ultimate recording experience!”
Recording	Ready · Recording 00:12:04	“You’re live! Crushing it!”
Editing	Original recording preserved · edits save automatically	“Don’t worry, we’ve got your back.”
Exporting	Export complete · Open folder	“Boom! Your masterpiece is ready.”

• EXISTING

“Say” lines are the application’s own copy; “avoid” lines are illustrative.

Avoid

Exaggerated hype, unsupported claims (“fastest”, “zero lag”), buzzwords, robotic phrasing, unexplained jargon.

Prefer

Verbs first, sentence case, one idea per line, the real feature name, a next step.

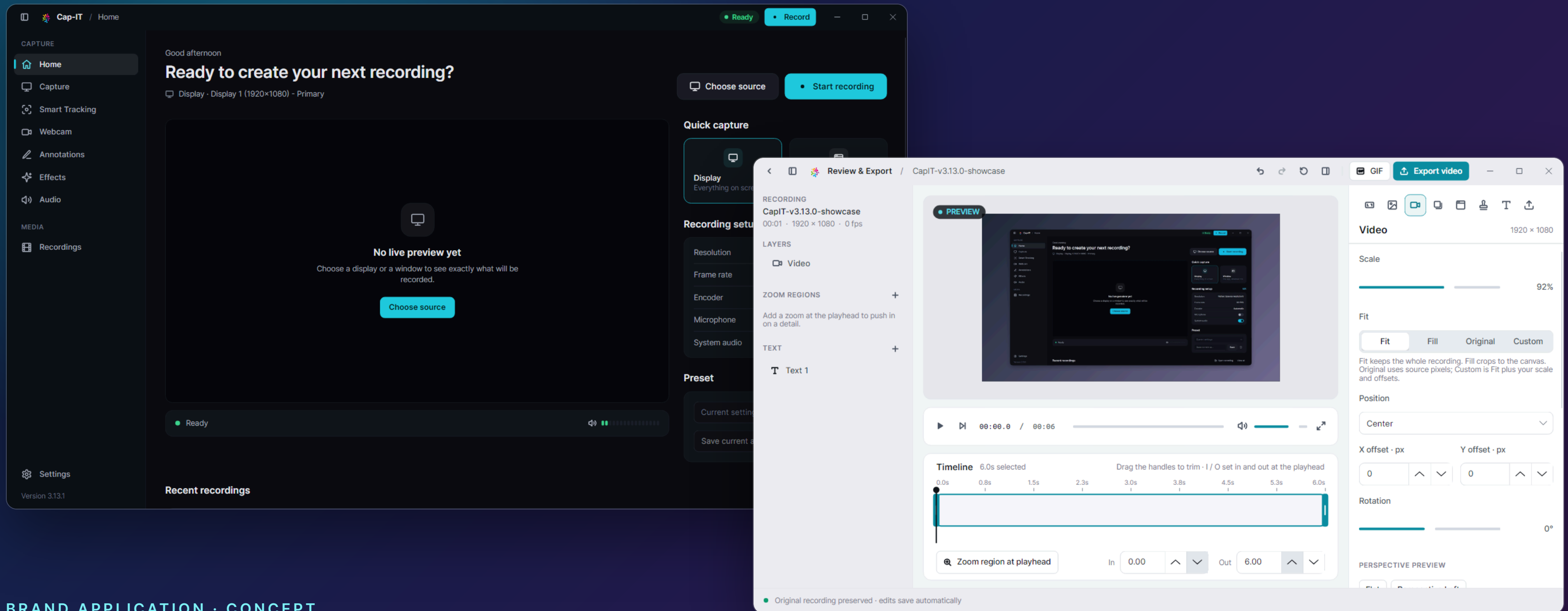
MESSAGING EXAMPLES

• PROPOSED

Ten places the voice has to hold.

WHERE	PREFERRED	AVOID
Homepage headline	Capture with intention.	The most powerful screen recorder ever built.
Short description	A focused, GPU-assisted screen recorder for Windows.	Revolutionary AI-powered capture solution.
Feature description	A camera that follows the action: it glides toward your cursor and caret, then eases back out.	Next-gen cinematic hyper-zoom technology.
Tooltip	Freeze the screen image — audio and timer keep recording.	Click to freeze!
Settings help	Hardware encoders need a compatible GPU. If a hardware export fails, choose Software.	Hardware encoding may not work for some users.
Error message	Couldn't open this video. Check that the file still exists, then try again.	Error 0x80004005. Operation failed.
Export complete	Export complete. Open folder	Success!!! 🎉
Update announcement	Cap-IT 3.13.1 is available. Update now installs it and reopens Cap-IT.	A new version is ready! Don't miss out!
Release note	Smoother Smart Tracking motion and sharper live preview scaling.	Various improvements and bug fixes.
Support reply	Thanks — could you share your Windows version, the capture target and a short description of what happened?	Please provide more information.

Lines that already ship (tooltip, settings help, export button, release note) are quoted from the application and the README. Others are proposed wording in the same voice; no unsupported claim is made in any “preferred” line.



BRAND APPLICATION · CONCEPT

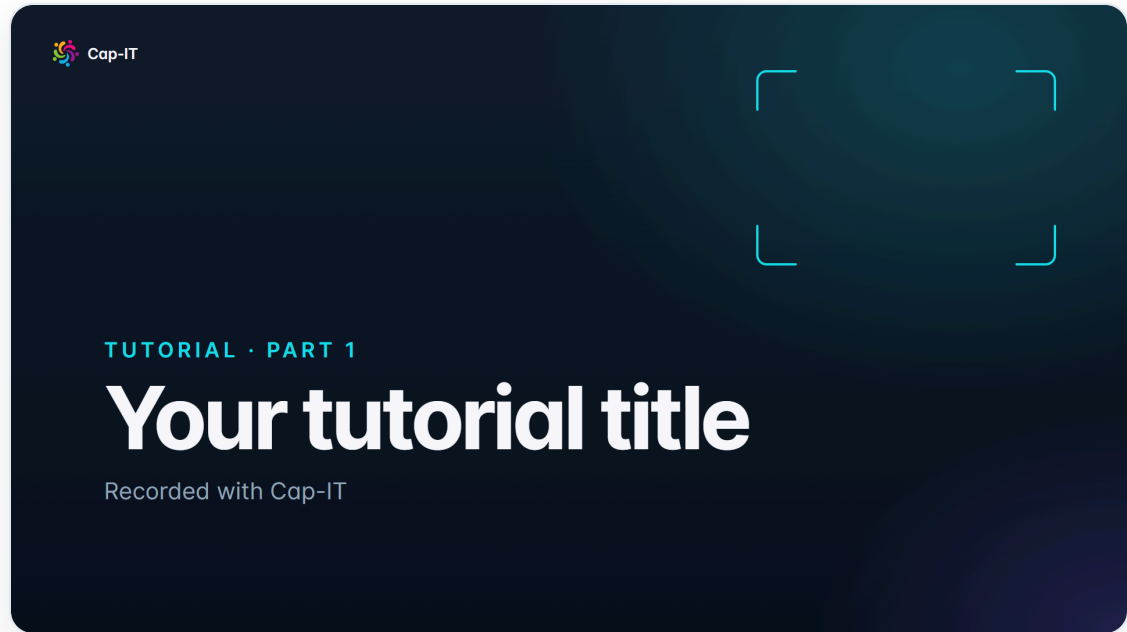
The app, in both themes.

Real application renders on a desktop backdrop. Dark: Home. Light: Review & Export.

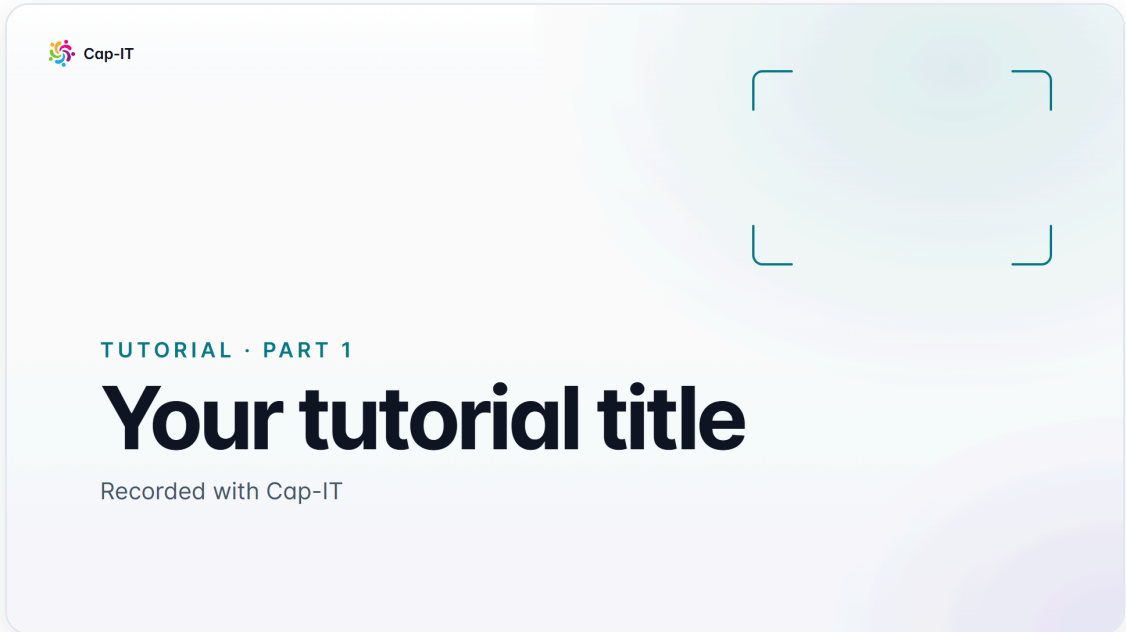
VIDEO, RELEASE AND DOCUMENTATION

• CONCEPT

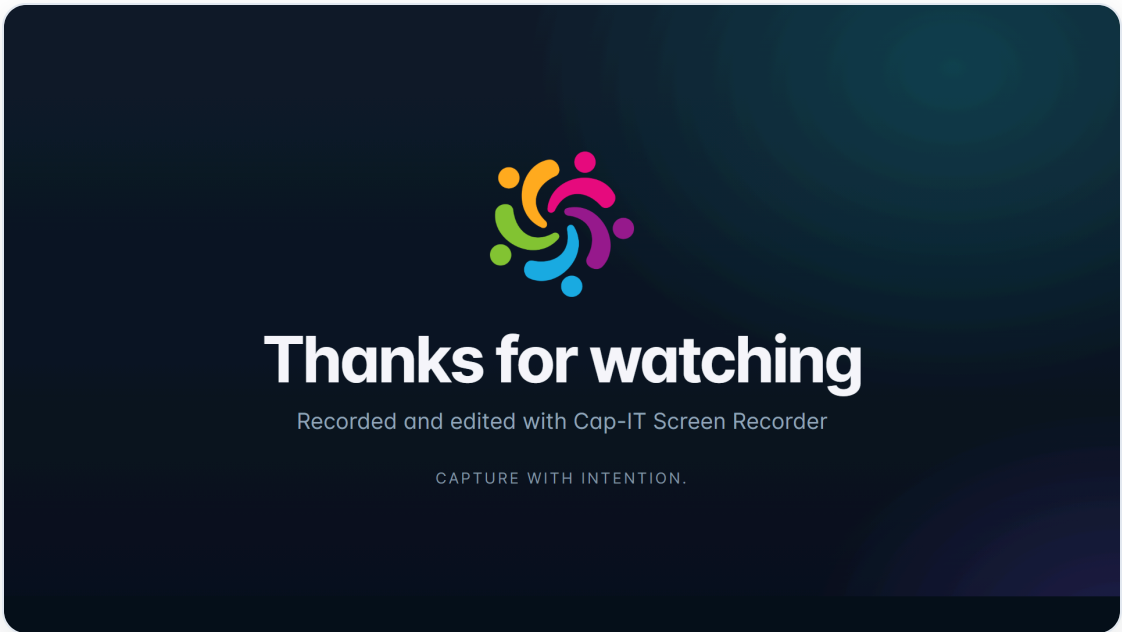
Tutorial cards, outros and the export watermark.



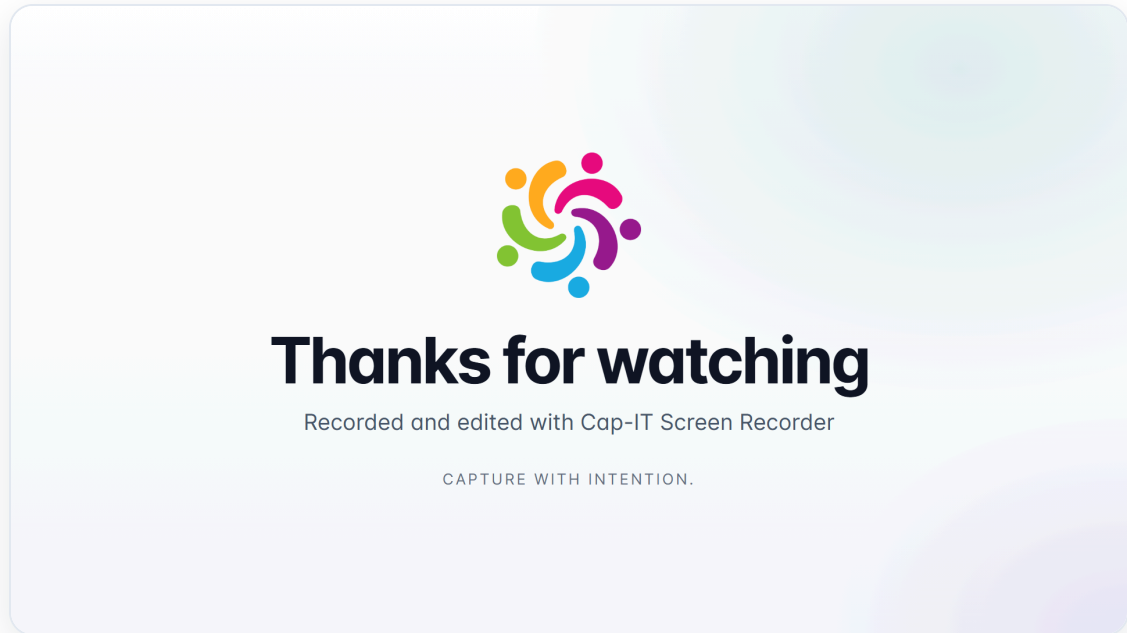
Tutorial title card · dark



Tutorial title card · light



Video outro · dark



Video outro · light

Export watermark

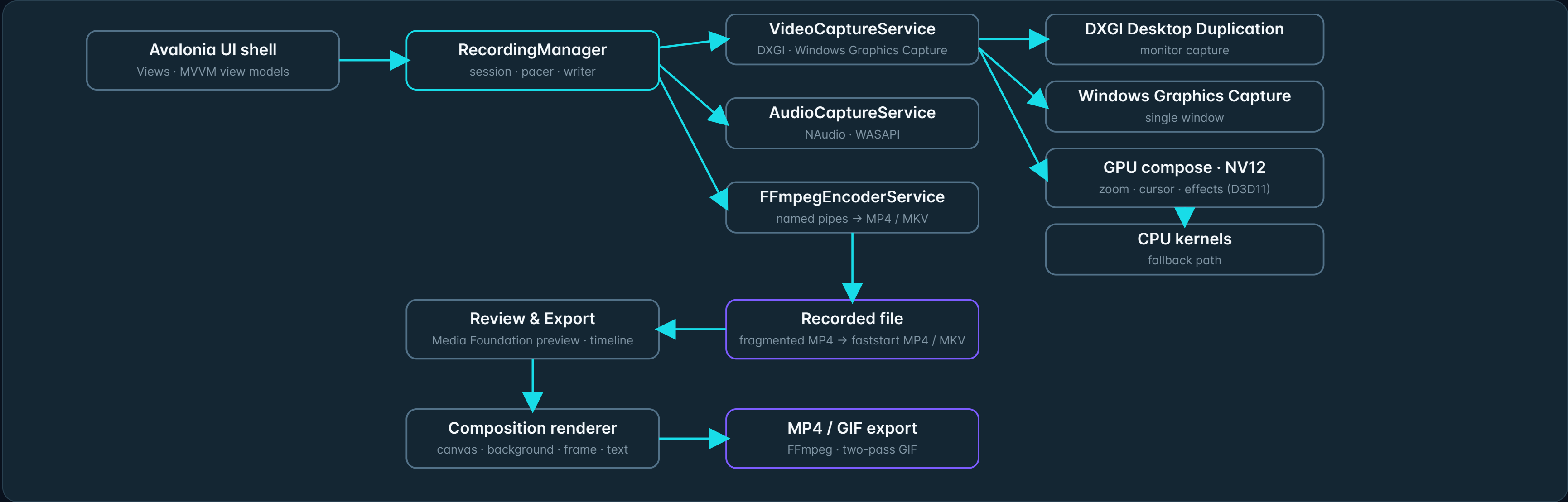
Optional, bottom-right, 4 % of frame height, 55 % opacity plate.
The editor already supports image watermarks; this is a suggested default.

Documentation & gallery

Docs use the Arctic theme by default and the editorial scale; each page opens with an overline, a Level 0–1 graphic and a real screenshot in a 12 px-radius frame. The v3.13.0 gallery is regenerated with the snapshot harness whenever a page layout changes.

TECHNICAL OVERVIEW • EXISTING

How a recording becomes a finished video.



- C# / .NET 8
- Avalonia UI 11
- CommunityToolkit.Mvvm
- Microsoft.Extensions.DependencyInjection
- DXGI Desktop Duplication
- Windows Graphics Capture
- Vortice.Direct3D11 / DXGI
- NAudio · WASAPI
- FFmpeg
- Media Foundation
- GDI / GDI+
- Win32 input hooks

Current architecture, drawn from the README and the source. Monitor capture composes on the GPU when the device supports it and otherwise on the CPU kernels; window capture uses Windows Graphics Capture. No future architecture is proposed in this book.

PLATFORM, VERSION & DISTRIBUTION

• EXISTING

Windows 10 / 11, x64, one installer.

Positioning

- Windows 10 version 2004 (build 19041) or later, 64-bit; Windows 11 recommended.
- Self-contained installer: no separate .NET runtime, Windows App SDK runtime or manual FFmpeg set-up.
- Adds a Start Menu entry and an optional desktop shortcut; uninstalling does not remove recordings.

Releases & updates

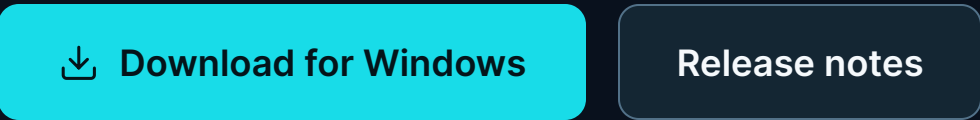
- Published through GitHub Releases.
- The app checks on startup and while open. **Update now** downloads the installer, waits for the app to close, installs and relaunches.
- The version string comes from `Directory.Build.props` (3.13.1 at the time of writing) — never hard-code “latest” in artwork.

Version badges

• V3.13.1 • LATEST • BETA

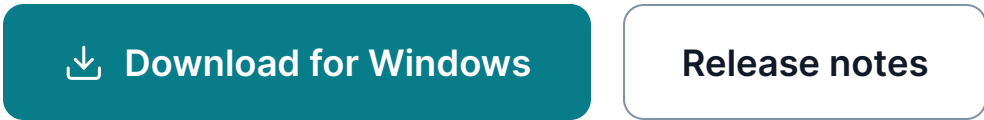
Outlined pill, uppercase, 13 px. Colour comes from the label's meaning: current, new, pre-release. Always a text label.

DOWNLOAD BUTTON · MIDNIGHT



44 px, 8 px radius, label ≥ 14 px SemiBold; version and OS under the button in muted text.

DOWNLOAD BUTTON · ARCTIC



Teal #087C88 carries a white label at 5.1 : 1 (the shipped light button is 3.85 : 1 — see chapter 04).

Release announcement styling

Headline = product + version. One sentence of what changed, in plain words. One real screenshot. Footer: platform line. Template: `templates/*/release-announcement.png` (shown in chapter 14). Release notes follow the voice rules in chapter 15.

ACCESSIBILITY & CONSISTENCY

What is specified, and what is verified.

AREA	REQUIREMENT	STATUS
Text contrast	Normal text ≥ 4.5 : 1, large ≥ 3 : 1	● Proposed tokens verified by build gate
Control boundaries	≥ 3 : 1 for inputs and toggles (SC 1.4.11)	● border.control passes; shipped borders do not
Keyboard focus	2 px ring, 2 px offset, brand colour (11 : 1 on Midnight, 4.5 : 1 on Arctic)	● Specified; focus visuals not audited in the app
Colour independence	Every status pairs colour with an icon or label	● Specified and shown in chapter 10
Reduced motion	Travel and scale removed; feedback kept	● Specified; app support not verified
Text scaling	No fixed-height text containers; allow 30–40 % growth	● Specified; not tested
Screen readers	Name every icon-only button (AutomationProperties.Name) where the framework supports it	● Not verified in the app
High-DPI	Layout in device-independent px; strokes scale with size	● Renders verified at 125 %
Theme contrast	Both themes pass independently	● Proposed: yes · Shipped: see audit
Touch targets	Desktop app: 30–44 px controls; use Large (44) for touch	● Informational

● verified or measured in this pass · ● specified here but not verified in the running application. Quality checklist: run the snapshot harness in both themes, review focus states with the keyboard only, and re-run `build_tokens.py` after any colour change.

MIDNIGHT

• PROPOSED

Accessible states in both themes

FOCUS VISIBILITY

Start recording

Choose source

Recording_2026

STATUS NEVER BY COLOUR ALONE

• Recording

⏸ Paused

⚠ Error

✓ Done

MUTED TEXT, HELD TO 4.5 : 1

Captions, placeholders and timestamps remain readable.

DISABLED (EXEMPT, NEVER THE ONLY CUE)

Export video

Locked

ARCTIC

• PROPOSED

FOCUS VISIBILITY

Start recording

Choose source

Recording_2026

STATUS NEVER BY COLOUR ALONE

• Recording

⏸ Paused

⚠ Error

✓ Done

MUTED TEXT, HELD TO 4.5 : 1

Captions, placeholders and timestamps remain readable.

DISABLED (EXEMPT, NEVER THE ONLY CUE)

Export video

Locked

Specimens from the proposed tokens. Disabled controls also carry a tooltip that says why.

BRAND GOVERNANCE

Who owns what, and how it changes.

Ownership & versioning

- **Owner:** the repository maintainer (ChamathDilshanC). Contributors propose; the owner approves.
- **Brand version:** this book is 1.0 and uses semantic versioning: patch = fixes, minor = additions, major = identity change.
- **Product baseline:** v3.13.1. Each release re-checks the screenshots and tokens.
- Assets are named `capit-<thing>--<variant>--<size>` and are never edited in place — a new file gets a new variant name.

Approved logo versions



Existing: stacked lockup, symbol. Derived: reversed lockup, monochrome.
Proposed (pending approval): horizontal lockup, app-icon plates.

Tokens

Source of truth is `Styles/*.axaml` for what ships and the two theme JSON files for what is proposed. `build_tokens.py` regenerates them and fails if contrast regresses.

Screenshots

Regenerate with the app's snapshot harness (Debug, both themes) and a demo configuration whenever a page changes. Keep the previous version folder as an archive, as `v3.6.0` is.

Release artwork

Use the templates; headline = product + version; one real screenshot; both themes where the channel allows a choice.

CHANGE REVIEW & RULES

Four steps to change the brand.

01

Propose

Open an issue with the reason, a before/after and the affected tokens or assets.

02

Measure

Run the token build; every pair must pass. Re-render the UI in both themes.

03

Review

Owner reviews in a pull request; recording code is reviewed separately from brand work.

04

Publish

Bump the brand version, update the book and assets, note it in the release.

Do

- Use semantic tokens; add a token before adding a hex.
- Show both themes whenever you show a component.
- Label anything that is not shipped (proposed / concept).
- Keep the original recording promise in every export flow.

Don't

- Redraw, recolour or re-proportion the logo.
- Invert the dark palette to get a light one.
- Claim performance, compatibility or features that are not verified.
- Mix brand changes into recording-pipeline commits.

PROVENANCE & LIMITS

What this book is built on, and what it is not.

- **No vector master.** The repository holds only PNG logo artwork; every variant is derived from it. Request the original vector files before print production.
- **Wordmark is tiny** (2.4 % of the symbol height) — a horizontal lockup is proposed because of it.
- **Proposed ≠ shipped.** The Midnight / Arctic palettes are recommendations; the application’s colours are unchanged.
- **Not verified:** app support for reduced motion, screen readers and text scaling; light-theme focus visuals; non-Latin script rendering.
- **Recording pipeline untouched.** The Smart Tracking work and its limits are in docs/SMART-TRACKING-RECORDING-FIX.md; audio tail, zoomed text sharpness and broader continuity tests remain a separate validation pass.

Package contents

Cap-IT-Brand-Book.pdf	68 pages · 16:9
Cap-IT-Brand-Guidelines.md	editable specification
Cap-IT-Brand-Tokens.json	spacing · type · motion · features
Cap-IT-Dark-Theme.json	36 proposed + 45 shipped
Cap-IT-Light-Theme.json	36 proposed + 45 shipped
Cap-IT-Brand-Assets/logo	14 PNG + ico
Cap-IT-Brand-Assets/app-icon	18 PNG + ico
Cap-IT-Brand-Assets/icons	87 SVG (the app's own)
Cap-IT-Brand-Assets/screenshots	34 real renders
Cap-IT-Brand-Assets/templates	26 PNG · both themes
avalonia/CapIT.Brand.Proposed.axaml	not referenced by the app
source/	HTML, Python builders, fonts (OFL)



Precision in capture. Clarity in communication. Creativity in presentation.